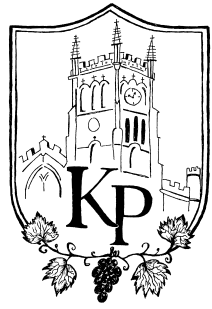
BAPTISMAL REGENERATION OF ELECT INFANTS

Cornelius Burges

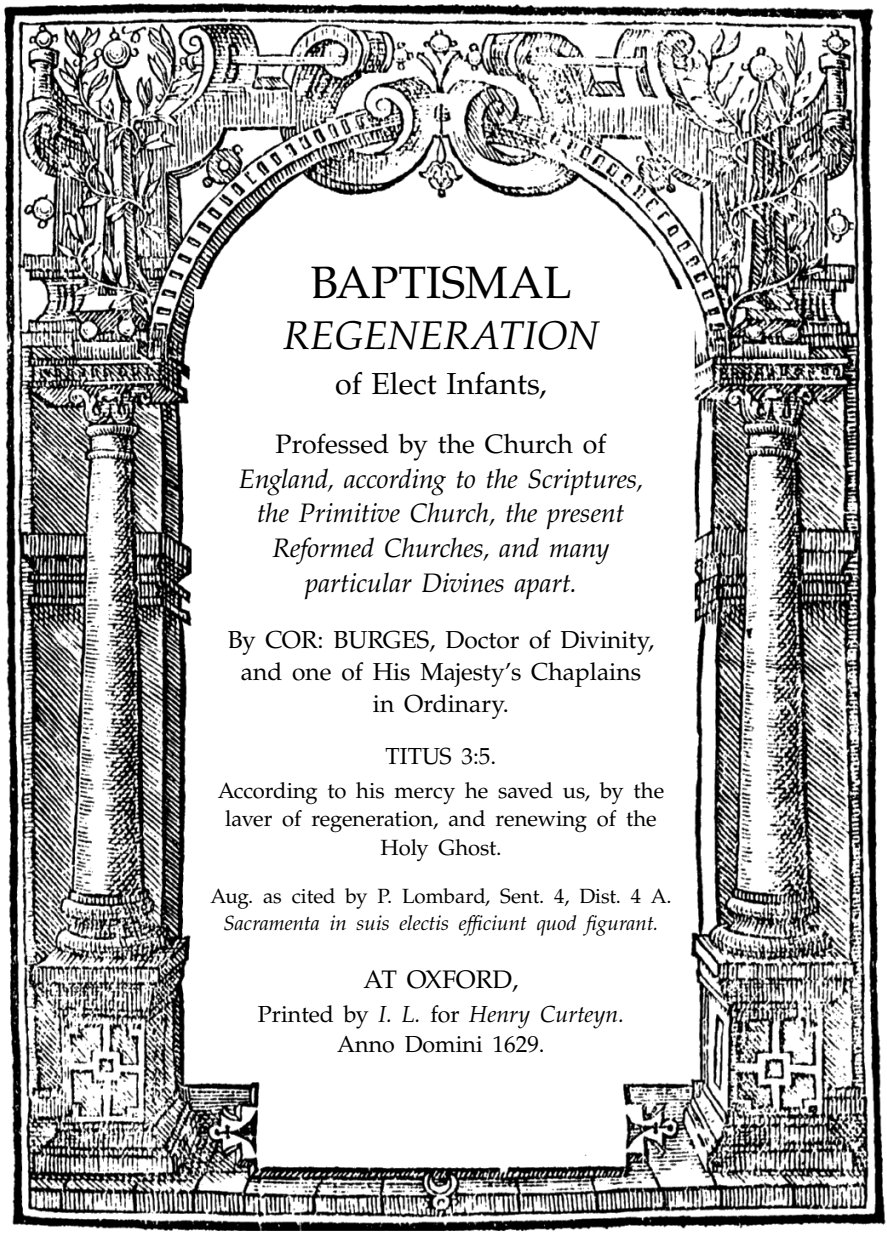
1629

Edited by Cheston Sartell

A modern spelling edition
Originally printed at Oxford by I. Lichfield for Henry Curteyn, 1629.



Kidderminster Press



BAPTISMAL
REGENERATION
of Elect Infants,

Professed by the Church of *England, according to the Scriptures, the Primitive Church, the present Reformed Churches, and many particular Divines apart.*

By COR: BURGES, Doctor of Divinity, and one of His Majesty's Chaplains in Ordinary.

TITUS 3:5.

According to his mercy he saved us, by the laver of regeneration, and renewing of the Holy Ghost.

Aug. as cited by P. Lombard, Sent. 4, Dist. 4 A.
Sacramenta in suis electis efficiunt quod figurant.

AT OXFORD,
Printed by *I. L.* for *Henry Curteyn.*
Anno Domini 1629.

TO THE RIGHT HONORABLE FRANCIS, LORD RUSSELL, BARON OF THORNHAUGH, EARL OF BEDFORD, AND LIEUTENANT OF DEVONSHIRE.

MY LORD,

It is a practice too common in this scribbling age, under pretense of respect, to send worthless and empty pamphlets abroad in great men's liveries. Which comes to pass, partly because children of the brain, how deformed soever, are held so precious by the parents, that they think themselves not sufficiently graced, unless they procure some noble person to be the godfather; and partly because such slimy comets, although they make a great blaze, cannot move themselves without the help of the moon, or of some greater star to whirl them about the world, with more ease and hope. This hath brought much dishonor to many an honorable Maecenas; it being like a rich sumpter cloth upon a collier's sack. Hence wise men grow afraid and unwilling to read their names in print; and the best deserving authors are forced to the irksome pains of a nauseous apology, when they do (with praise) perform a duty.

For my part, I dare not put myself into the rank of best deservers; nor to boast anything of my present performance. Howbeit, thus much I will take upon me to affirm, that mine aim (next unto common benefit) is your service; and, that the subject which I here present, is not unworthy of either the best man's labor,[1] or the choicest patron.

The following treatise endeavors to lay open and make good the efficacy of sacred baptism, in respect of regeneration; in which the greatest ought more to rejoice than in the greatest prerogatives on earth. This is that which (if they belong to the covenant) makes them members of Christ, children of God, and heirs of that kingdom which is above.

[1] *Est autem ea quaestio cum difficilis & plena controversiae tum digna quae tractetur & explicetur diligenter, Whitak de sacram controv. de Bapt. question 4, cap. 5*

The whole, for manner of prosecution, is polemical:[2] yet useful, and such for substance as the Fathers in the Council of Orleans, under Charles the Great, thought fit to commend to the care of all ministers of every degree, as being necessary to be diligently and fully explained unto the people. Therefore, I hope, I shall not be censured by judicious men to trouble the world with an impertinent discourse, which might, in that regard, disparage your Lordship's name, that it humbly craves leave to bear.

And to say truth, to whom else should it repair, either to do its first homage, or to get under Covert-Baron, but to your Honor, heretofore the heir, now the master of that ancient, noble, and much honored family, to which I was, and ever will be a faithful and humble servant; not, in expectation, but only in thankful acknowledgment of what I have already received, and of what other my fellow-servants do, in your honorable service, still enjoy.

It cannot be unknown to such as know me, how much I stand obliged to your noble predecessors, the late Earl and Countess of Bedford, now with God. Nor can any man be so ignorant as not to see cause why this public testimony of my continued gratitude due to that house should, by all rights, be laid at your feet, in whom all the perfections and excellencies of true nobility do so eminently meet, to make you highly honored in the eyes and hearts of all that are able to value true desert, as being one that not only holds up the honor, but adds to the glory of all your famous progenitors, who have derived to you that illustrious dignity you now possess.

The good Lord, who hath brought you hitherto, be with you, your noble lady, and your numerous, amiable, and much-promising progeny, in all things, always. He grant you length of days, increase of all true honor, the riches of grace, and the crown of glory. So prayeth still

Your Lordship's most devoted servant in Christ Jesus,
COR: BURGES.

---

[2] *De baptismo & mysterio sanctae fidei, unus quisq; Archiepiscopus suos suffraganeos diligenter studioseq; admoneat, quatenus per studium sacrae lectionis imbuti, & de mysterio sanctae fidei, & de Sacramento baptismatis, unu quisq; illoru, in propria parochia perfecte studioseq; presbyteros, & universum populum docere, & instruere non negligat concil. Arelat. cap. 3 sub car. mag. A. 813 tom.3 Concil. Par. 1 Sect. 2 pag. 188 edit. Biniana, 1618.*

TO THE READERS

I will not tediously preface touching either the occasion of this treatise, which we may find in the first chapter; or any particular else that may be passed over without prejudice to you, or me. I have only these things whereof to advertise you, before you enter on the book itself.

1. I am certainly informed that some, having intelligence of my purpose of publishing this work (which is the sum of sundry lectures delivered in mine own *charge)*,[3] *spare not to give out that this is not the same which I preached. I cannot but wonder at their confidence and uncharitableness, forasmuch as I am sure that, at the time of making such their proclamation, they neither saw one line of my book, nor knew what it contains. Only in general, some of them have heard it by judicious and eminent divines to be pronounced orthodox; which, it seems, doth not a little trouble them, because they have divulged the contrary of my sermons. However they, by this, make it appear beforehand that they are resolved not to permit this tract to go without a scratched face, so soon as their nails can come at it. I am therefore constrained, for defense thereof, to avouch that I can (if need require) make it good by above 500 witnesses, that I have been so punctual in setting down in this book the main position which I first delivered, that I have put it into the very same terms formerly used, without the least variation. I willingly confess that in the prosecution of the point I have here added some things by way of further illustration; and some also for more ample confirmation; and pressed some objections further than the straits of time would then admit. And if for this I be to blame, let wise men judge.*
2. *Whereas most of the objections produced and answered in this treatise have been first urged upon me in private conference, or sent me in writing by sundry friends, whose worth I reverence and whose love I much affect, notwithstanding their dissent from me in this particular; I must crave leave to profess and protest before him that knoweth all things, that my aim is not so much as in my secret thoughts to despise or disparage any of them hereby, but only to set down their arguments, that thereby occasion might be taken more thoroughly to discuss this subject. It is true that I have sometimes made use of the same phrases first used by my*

[3] St. Magnus, London.

friends to me; yet I desire them to take notice that I have only weighed their arguments impartially in the balance of reason and truth, without the least glance upon any of their persons. And if I could have been ascertained that none but they would ever have lighted on the same objections, I could as willingly have suppressed them, as I do the names of the objectors. But because what friends do object in love, others may also press to the prejudice of this truth, I have made bold to make those arguments thus public, that their mouths may be stopped who else might happen to urge the same with violence and passion enough, and think them unanswerable, if there should no answers be sent out to meet them. For their sakes therefore have I thus presumed on my friends (whom I earnestly desire still to hold dear unto me), hoping they will not bethink it to the public good, nor hold themselves disparaged hereby, but rather rejoice that they have been a means of a more exquisite debate of this point, whereby the truth may be better known.

3. *I have a request to all that shall vouchsafe to make use of this book, that they will be at the pains to read over the whole, or forbear to censure it by any piece thereof that they may happen to cast their eye upon. For, in a point of controversy, wherein method requires only explication in one part, confirmation in another, refutation in another, and often references from one part of the discourse unto other places thereof, for avoiding of confusion and tedious repetitions, it is impossible to receive full satisfaction by reading any one piece only, how satisfactory soever it may prove when it is considered altogether, and when the rest is perused and weighed as well as that branch on which hasty and forward censurers do sometimes pass a sharp and heavy sentence. If you peruse the first part of this book only, without the residue, you may perhaps object divers things and remain unsatisfied, because you go not on to the latter part wherein all such objections, together with answers to them, do present themselves in their proper ranks. On the contrary, if you look only on the latter part to see how the main objections be answered, you may sometimes haply stick (through your own fault) at some of the answers, because I take sundry things for granted which you may doubt of till you have read the former part, wherein the same things are proved at large, and to which, in my answers, the rules of method often compel me to refer you. Farewell.*

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Basil
Hieronymus
Augustine

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Wolfgang Musculus
Augustin Marlorat
David Pareus
Daniel Chamier
Hieron Zanchius
Francis Junius
Martin Bucer
Lambert Daneau
Gerardus Vossius

Confessions of Churches:

Helvetica
Belgica
Argentinensis
Saxonica
Palatini
Scoticana
Gallicana and Genevensis
Augustana
Wirtembergica

Foreign Divines:

John Calvin

English Divines:

Bishop Jewel
Dr. Fulke
Dr. White, Bishop of Norwich
Dr. William Ames
Mr. Thomas Rogers
Mr. Henry Ainsworth
Dr. Whitaker
Dr. Davenant, Bishop of Salisbury
Dr. Daniel Featly
Mr. Richard Hooker
Mr. Thomas Taylor, Doctor of Divinity

CHAPTER I. The Introduction, Declaring the Occasion and Necessity of This Treatise.

There is no ordinance set up by Christ in his Church more useful and comfortable to a Christian, throughout the whole course of his militant condition, than *sacred baptism*, "the laver of regeneration and of the renewing of the Holy Ghost," (Titus 3:5). Nor is there any fountain which the archenemy of mankind, hath more endeavored to trouble and corrupt with multiplicity of poisonous errors, than that which is, "set open" to all, "the inhabitants" of spiritual "Jerusalem, for sin and for uncleanness," (Zechariah 13:1).

For proof of this, I shall not need to thrust any man's head so much as within the door of that Augean stable of popish absurdities. We have too many instances elsewhere. Some advance baptism too high. Others depress it as much too low. There are they that hold it so absolutely necessary, as that none can be saved without it. On the contrary, there are they that in scorn call it elementish water. Others, that think it is a thing indifferent, and deny it to infants, notwithstanding that, "to them belongs the kingdom of God," (Mark 10:14). Others that make it a bare sign and badge to distinguish the members of the visible Church from the rest of the world, some, in terms, yield it to be somewhat more; yet deny to it all present efficacy, in and upon infants, ordinarily, in the act of administration. Some grant an efficacy, but such is equally communicated to all infants that are outwardly baptized. Some admit the efficacy of it to remission of sin in elect infants, but, any present work of the Spirit, to regeneration in them, they either flatly deny, or refuse to acknowledge. Against all these errors, and particularly against the last, the Church of England hath justly opposed herself in her *Public Doctrine*, for the defense of this I have taken on myself this difficult province. The occasion is this.

In the course of my ministry, in my own cure, I was lately[4] cast upon this point*: viz*. "That all elect infants, do, ordinarily, in baptism, receive the Spirit of Christ, to seize upon them for Christ, and to be in them as the root and first principle of regeneration, and future new-

[4] In Hilary Term, 1627.

ness of life."[5] This is the way I spoke (as then I expressed myself) with reference *only* unto such infants as do not die in infancy, but live to years of discretion, and then come to be effectually called, and actually converted by the ordinary means of the word applied by the same Spirit to them, when and how he pleases. As for the rest of the elect, who die infants, I will not deny a further work, sometimes in, sometimes before baptism, to fit them for heaven.

For this, I am peremptorily censured and condemned by many, as guilty, not only of Arminianism, but even of direct popery, and of teaching a doctrine of devils. To make good what they have done, they lay to my charge sundry passages, as branches of my position, which, not only in stating the question, but also in its prosecution, I often disclaimed as errors in very express terms. They know this well enough; and it hath been made manifest to some of their faces by others also. However, they owing me a spite for something else, (as by the effect appears) take no notice of their willful mistakes, that which they have once reported, they are resolved to maintain it; therefore they do not cease to pursue me with clamors, slanders, and revilings without end or measure. No protestation of my own, either public or private, no apologies made by my friends, are able to shelter me from their virulent darts which daily fly in my face wherever I am.

This alone is a sufficient cause of publishing this treatise, that I may purge myself of these odious crimes so unjustly imputed. He that being a minister is not careful to uphold his necessary reputation among the people of God, as well as to keep a good conscience towards God, is both cruel to himself, and injurious to his Master.[6] His ministry must needs be of less esteem, if not despised outright, who shall allow himself to be proclaimed *guilty* of error and heresy; and see his good name hung up in chains by the giddy multitude, even before his own doors, and he doth not endeavor in a necessary and temperate manner to declare himself innocent, when he is well able to plead, "not guilty" to the indictment.[7]

[5] *Vid.* Hooker, lib. 5, sect. 60.

[6] *Nobis enim necessaria est vita nostra, aliis fama nostra, Aug. De Bono Viduit.*

[7] *Mihi sufficit conscientia mea, vobis necessaria est fama mea. Idem, ad Frat. in Erem.*

If any man shall say, "It is a man's honor to pass by offenses," and therefore it would have been far better to have endured a while, with patience, the tongues of intemperate men, than in this way to have spread the cause before the whole world. Would this course be more likely to exasperate, rather than to satisfy or mollify such as have appeared in opposition against me? To such a person my answer is this: if the wrong had not trenched so much on the credit of my ministry (which ought to be as dear unto me, as any man's is to him) or if I had been handled in a way which was only private, by private men, I could willingly have born all the reproach and infamy that is laid upon me, without complaining, but not without bewailing with a bleeding heart, the strange pride and insolence of such spirits as dare in this way to willfully traduce any minister of Christ.

That which hath embarked on me in this public action is of more importance than the maintaining of my own innocence against the murmur of private persons: yes there are many weighty causes concurring to put on me a necessity of doing something in this kind. If any shall take occasion here to be more exasperated, it shall be only his own fault. I hope I shall so manage this work, that it shall evidently appear to all godly, judicious, temperate men, that I nowhere give any cause of offense to any peaceable Christian; but endeavor only, in a modest and humble manner, to clear and maintain a biblical *truth*, and to give all satisfaction that I may, unto such as love truth better than victory.

Briefly, the causes chiefly inducing me to send these papers unto the press, are these *three:*

1. The just defense of the public doctrine of our Church, which hath been by some, on this occasion, publicly opposed so far as they durst. For, how freely various ministers rail against this position (and that publicly too) notwithstanding that this truth is so clearly consonant to the *Liturgy* and *Public Catechism* of the Church in which we live, is too well known. Piercing my sides therefore they have ignored and wounded our common mother, who suffers in the cause, much more than myself, or than any particular either doth or can.

2. I find that sundry, sober, and well affected Christians are often puzzled, and at a loss in this particular, for want of information; yes in danger to be drawn unaware to some type of schism; not unlike those, "200 men that followed Absalom, in the simplicity of their hearts, not knowing anything," (2 Samuel 15:11) of his conspiracy. Therefore, for their sakes it is very requisite that this point should be thoroughly searched into, and made public. This is not a quarrel about goat's hair; nor so poor a business as should deserve (in a pulpit) to be compared to the action of a famous general that levies a strong army, draws them out into the field, sets them in order for battle, and raises a great expectation of some honorable exploit, which in conclusion proves to be no other than, "the breaking of an eggshell."[8]
3. Nor was there ever such need of opening this truth unto the people, as now: because, never since the heresies of the sacramentarians and Anabaptists were hissed out of the Church of Christ, were men so violent against it, and so impatient of contradiction. They cry out, "What use, what use of such doctrine? Whether doth it tend?" I think they should be able to answer themselves, without help. Is it nothing to a Christian, in time of a violent temptation, when he hath lost all sight of his Savior, to be assured that even in his baptism he received the Holy Ghost as an, "anointing that shall abide with him forever?" Is the, "consolation of God a small matter," unto a Christian parent, that in obedience to Christ, and in faith in his promises, hath presented this child to the sacred laver,[9] where the Holy Ghost hath seized upon him for Christ, so as, whether he lives or dies, he may conceive good hope that Christ hath taken the charge of his child, and will provide all things needful for it, and give it both grace and glory? "What a comfort (a

[8] Scomma. That great Athanasius was of another opinion, when he placed this very question (how one may know whether he received the Spirit in baptism?) among those which he terms: Questions necessary and useful for all Christians to be acquainted with. In titulo Libri Quaest. ad Antioch. princ. tom. 2.

[9] *Quam enim suave piis animis, non verbo tantum, sed oculari etiam spectaculo certiores fieri tantum se gratiae apud patrem caelestem obtinere, ut posteritas sua illi curae sit? Hic enim videre est ut providentissimi erga nos patris familias personam suscipiat, qui ne post mortem quidem nostram, sollicitudinem nostri deponit quin liberis nostris consulat ac prospiciat. Calvin, Instit. l.4 cap.16 sect.ult.*

learned writer saith[10] on Titus 3:5 making it one use of this very doctrine) is it for a father to see his child washed with the blood of Jesus Christ? Cleansed from sin? Set into the visible Church, yes, into the body of Christ, in the right use of his sacrament? In which a parent ought more to rejoice, than if he could make it heir of the world."

All these considered, I appeal to any understanding man, whether I have no cause to publish my labors upon this subject, out of duty that I owe to the Church of Christ; and whether (considering how little is done in this kind) it is not worth the best search, and greatest labor of the most able divines in the kingdom, to clear this point in full, for the edification and comfort of pious and peaceable Christians.[11]

What I have performed in this work, I humbly offer to be freely censured by the more judicious, who truly and indeed are both willing and able to maintain the public doctrine of this Church already established. I will not take on me to tie all men, or any man, to my private opinions. I know that the learned may without blame, dissent from each other in many things, so long as they do not obtrude them on others, nor trouble the peace of the Church thereabout. However, if this work of mine is a private opinion, I renounce it, and crave pardon of the whole Church of God for troubling the world with such a toy. But, if it appears to impartial judges to be able to weigh it in the balance of the sanctuary, to be a truth and such a truth as the whole Church of England is as much engaged in, as myself, then I trust that then it shall find acceptance with all sober men; and, by God's blessing, prove profitable to *all* that in humility and love, desire and endeavor to embrace the truth. As for others, I shall pass them by with *pity*, and prayer that they may at length come again to themselves.

[10] Mr. Thomas Taylor.

[11] I am sure Dr. *Whitaker was of this mind, Tract. de Sacram. controv. de Bapt:* quest.4 c.5 *in principio*. Where speaking of the efficacy of baptism in infants: he has these words: *Est autem ea quaestio cum difficilis & plena controversiae, tum digna quae tractetur, & explicetur diligenter.* This is a question that is both difficult and full of controversy, and such also as is worthy to be handled and carefully opened.

CHAPTER II. The State of the Position.

I do not want to trouble the reader with any discourse touching on the name or definition of baptism; nor yet with the efficacy of baptism touching remission of sin, which I willingly admit. Let us now fall upon the state of the position touching on the *efficacy* of this ordinance, Upon the elect, concerning regeneration. I shall have occasion to declare myself in the other particulars, as I pass along.

There is no term in our position needing explication except two, the terms of the *Spirit* and of *regeneration*. By *Spirit*, I do not mean only, "grace wrought" by the Spirit; but the Holy Ghost dwelling in every true Christian and working grace. However I consider this Holy Ghost, not essentially, nor personally as the third Person of the Trinity, but, *operatively* as the Spirit of Christ communicated from him to all his members, to unite them to himself, and to be in them the first principle, and as it were the soul of spiritual life. It is the Spirit himself, and not his graces that first knits us to Christ.[12] Graces are effects of the union, not the bond itself. Nor can some of those things which are attributed to the Spirit dwelling in a Christian possibly be applied to any created gift or grace infused, but only to the Holy Ghost *himself*. For example, our Savior's speaking of that Comforter which he would, after his departure, send to his disciples to dwell *in* them, saith that, "…when he is come he will reprove the world of sin, of righteousness, and of judgment," (John 16:8) which must needs be the act of a person, not of a created inanimate gift. And in verse 13, "…whatsoever he shall hear, that shall he speak, and he will show you things to come, He shall glorify me, for he shall receive of mine, and shall show it unto you." In brief, no place of Scripture can be produced, wherein *the Holy Ghost* is stated only for grace wrought or bestowed, and not for its author. I am not ignorant that some modern writers hold otherwise. But saving their judgments, I cannot but follow the fathers, and soundest schoolmen, who soundly maintain this truth. I will not

[12] 1 Corinthians 12:13.

trouble my reader with heaps of authors.[13] I only pray the learned to consider well, whether admitting of this exposition of such texts of holy writ as mention the dwelling of the Holy Ghost in a Christian, *viz*. that by the Holy Ghost is meant only, "grace wrought or working," doth not (unawares) give some countenance to the heresy of the *pneumatomachists*. I am sure that Saint Augustine[14] was wont to prove the Godhead of the Holy Ghost by this very argument, that we are said to be his, "Temples;" and he, to dwell in us.

The other word to consider is of *regeneration*. I take this word to be of all sense, which life, according to the Scriptures, I distinguish into *initial* and *actual*. For as in the natural, sometimes the soul which is usually called the form by which and sometimes the *esse*, the being itself of such a creature animated by his soul, is described as *life*; as that learned Zanchius well observes.[15] So it is in the spiritual life whereof we are now to treat. And upon this foundation it is that we rightly build our present distinction, which hath clear footing also in the sacred volumes of eternal truth.

1. *Initial* (which we may also term *seminal* or *potential* life,) I call that which consisteth in participation of the Spirit of Christ, as the form of this spiritual life. It is the Spirit being the first principle of regeneration, by whom the first seed and its foundation is laid in a Christian. And this is life as it were as the *root*, like the first principles of reason laid up in the rational soul, before it hath actually enabled the body to move, and act rationally. And of this, Junius saith acutely,[16] our Savior spoke in John 3 more clearly to our purpose as that of the Apostle, "The Spirit is life, because of righteousness," (Romans 8:10) where the Spirit which is the cause of life, is placed for life itself. And by the *Spirit* is meant, not the reasonable soul, but the Holy Ghost; if Calvin (and before him Chrysostom and Ambrose, after him Peter Martyr) hit right on in

[13] Of this see more in de Nat. Dei. lib.2 cap.6 Question 2 & 3. As also in my learned and much honored friend Mr. Downham. Christ warf: part.4 lib.1 cap.3 Choquet Lillan De gra. Sanctific. Tom,1 lib.1 disp.1 ca.4.

[14] Cont. Serm. Arrianorum, cap. 20 & cap. 29; Cont. Maxim. lib. 1 & lib. 2, cap. 11 & lib. 3, cap. 21, & alibi passim.

[15] De Nat Dei. lib.2 cap.5 quest.1

[16] De Paedobapt. thes.7

his exposition,[17] of which for my part (after serious pensitation, of all that any have said to carry it to another sense) I make no question about it.

2. *Actual*, I call that which consists properly in the very spiritual being itself actually produced in a Christian, by the Spirit bringing him forth a new man in Christ, in the ordinary course of regeneration of such as live to years. By this he is enabled actually to believe, repent, *etc*., "Likewise ye, reckon yourselves to be dead indeed unto sin: but alive unto God through Jesus Christ our Lord," (Romans 6:11). So also see Galatians 2:20 and elsewhere.

To distinguish this into several other members I further illustrate it in this *way:*

The former of these is as the transplantation of a tree into new soil; the latter, as drawing the fatness of the soul into the tree; causing it to shoot up, spring, blossom, and bear fruit. The former, Junius saith,[18] is as the transplanting of a man out of the first Adam, into the second, the later, as his drawing virtue from him, and living by it. The former is as the, "stretching of Elisha" upon the dead child, the first time, whereby the, "flesh of the child waxed warm," but as yet it moved not;[19] the latter is as his, "stretching himself upon it the second time," which caused it to, "sneeze seven times and to open his eyes."[20] The former of these is like unto the first, "incubation" or, "resting of the Spirit upon the face of the waters, while the earth was yet without form, and void," (Genesis 1:2) the latter, as the production of each particular creature, afterwards in his kind, time, and order, appointed of God, when it pleased him to speak the word. The Spirit, "rested upon the waters," from the beginning; yet the creatures were not presently produced *by* the Spirit. They came forth in their due time and place, when God gave his fiat and not before.

This distinction laid as a ground, will of itself, bear us out in this conclusion, *"There may be even in order of time a communicating of the*

[17] *Gal. in loc. Vocabulo spiritus ne intelligas, sed regenerationis spiritum quem vitam appellat Paulus.*

[18] *Ibid. Hac regenerantur infantes electi, cum Christo inseruntur, & obsignatio sit iis dum baptizantur.*

[19] 2 Kings 4:34.

[20] Verse 35.

Spirit of grace, as a principle of future newness of life, before any ordinary actual infusion of actual or habitual graces, by which a man, on his part, actually makes a declaration of it, by a thorough change of his heart and life, as a new man in Christ."

This being granted, touching on the ordinary means of a manifestation conferring on us and confirming to us the Spirit of grace, I add further a second conclusion, which is this: "The first ordinary and certain means by which we, that descend of Christian parents, have any initial regeneration begun in us, and do ordinarily, receive and come to be ascertained of the Spirit of Christ, for this end, that he may produce in us future actual spiritual life, is the first ordinance of Christ that we partake of: in other words, *baptism."*

This is our first certain and manifest initiation into Christ, (Romans 6) and receiving of the Holy Ghost, in the ordinary way of divine dispensation; by means (Acts 2:38) and our engrafting into the body of Christ, (1 Corinthians 12:13). So also the *27th Article of our Church* saith.[21] This is the block at which so many have stumbled. This is the Arminianism, popery, and doctrine of devils that I am charged with. This therefore is the point I am now to labor in, after I have stated it somewhat more distinctly and fully for its effecting, I must first more punctually set down the following points.

1. How far all that are not papists, Lutherans, or Arminians agree with me in this.
2. What are the differences between me and some others that though they hold neither with papists, nor Arminians, yet dissent with me?

The things on all hands agreed upon are these:

1. That some infants may and do receive the Spirit to unite them unto Christ, *before* baptism. The question here is only of the first certain reception of it, by *external ordinary means* applied.
2. That baptism is understood as the whole ordinance, consisting of the inward grace, as well as of the outward sign.
3. That there is as much efficacy in baptism unto remission of sin, as to regeneration; although we are now to treat only of the latter.

[21] This article is urged and opened in the next chapter.

4. That the Spirit is not given to all, but to the elect only.
5. That the outward element doth not have in it any physical force, either by virtue of the consecration, institution, or administration to confer the Spirit to any at all: but the Spirit is communicated immediately from *Christ* himself, *when the sacrament is administered*, if then it is at all conferred.
6. That God both may and doth even in baptism bestow the Spirit upon some infants that live and come to an older age, as well as on some that die in infancy.

The differences, then, are only two; which will be most briefly discerned in these 2 queries.

1. Whether the communication of the Spirit to infants from Christ himself, for the first apparent engrafting into his body, and to be in them as the first seed and principle of regeneration, in the ordinary course of regenerating such, as after baptism, do continue to live to an older age, or what some call the "age of discretion," and are ordinarily *in* the baptism of the elect?
2. Whether the former, being granted, it also follows that all the elect ordinarily receive him *before*, or *after*, and not *in* baptism, are to be held to receive the Spirit in an extraordinary, and not in the ordinary course of divine dispensation of it?

I hold the affirmative in both of these questions and determine them in the following way*: viz.*,

"It is most agreeable to the institution of Christ, that all elect infants that are baptized, (unless in some extraordinary cases) ordinarily receive from Christ, the Spirit in baptism, for their first solemn initiation into Christ, and for their future actual renovation, in God's good time, if they live to years of discretion, and enjoy the other ordinary means of grace appointed to this end."

This position I am now to make good to be agreeable to the doctrine.

1. Of the church of England: by which it appears not to be a private idea.
2. Of the Holy Scriptures, upon which this doctrine of our Church is founded.

3. Of the ancient Fathers of best note in the truly primitive Church.
4. Of the Reformed Churches beyond the sea; and particularly of Geneva.
5. Of the most famous and eminent divines, both at home and abroad, and particularly of Calvin and Dr. Whitaker, beside various others.

Lastly, I will add answers to all the objections that I could ever hear of against this assertion.

CHAPTER III. This Agrees to the Public Doctrine of Our Church.

Before I go further, I must advise the reader of one thing constantly to be observed throughout this treatise; and it is this: wherever I shall for brevity's sake only say this much, *that the elect do receive the Spirit in baptism*; my purpose is to have it understood with all those conditions and limitations before expressed, in stating the point. So that it must always be in this way interpreted. *viz., That it is most agreeable to the institution of Christ, that all elect infants that are baptized (unless in some extraordinary cases) ordinarily receive the Spirit from Christ in baptism, for their first solemn initiation into Christ; and for their future actual renovation, in God's good time, if they live to years of discretion, and enjoy the other ordinary means of grace appointed of God to this end*. This premised, I may more securely go on with my work. Nor shall any man that finds oftentimes, in that which follows, which is a more compendious expression of this position, have cause to complain that I, "deal ambiguously and sophistically;" because my resolution is to always be tried by this conclusion so largely delivered, and so bounded as in the former chapter as you may behold it.

The first part of my task is to make it good that this assertion is agreeable to the public and established doctrine of the Church of England. And this I propound in the first place; not as if I meant to tie any man's faith to believe the point, merely because the Church of England saith it. For she will not assume so much authority over any man's faith; having declared herself expressly in the 21st article of her doctrine, that even general counsels (which represent the whole Church of Christ on earth*) in things ordered by them as necessary to salvation, have neither strength nor authority, unless it may be declared that they are taken out of Holy Scripture*. I then do not urge the doctrine of our Church to prove the point by it; as some have given out. I only desire to show the agreement that it hath with our public doctrine, that no man might proclaim it to be a piece either of popery or Arminianism; nor yet a private conceit of my own dissonant from the Churches of Christ. Rather, that it is a branch of that truth to which all the min-

isters of our Church either have subscribed, or ought so to do, are as deeply engaged in the defense of it, as myself whom some of them (either ignorant or careless of what they subscribed to) so much oppose now.

This that accords to the doctrine of our Church may appear in one or two plain syllogisms; the first of which shall be this:

Major: That which the Church in its public liturgy exhorts and requires us to pray for, when any infant presumed to be truly and indeed within the covenant of grace, is brought to baptism; and, that which it also teaches us to pronounce concerning that and every such infant, so soon as he is baptized, must necessarily be granted to be agreeable to the public doctrine of our Church touching all elect infants that are baptized, ordinarily.

Minor: But the public liturgy of our Church exhorts and requireth us, at the baptizing of every infant presumed to have an interest in the covenant of grace, as being within God's election,[22] to pray for the Spirit of regeneration to be given unto him: and, so soon as he is baptized, to conclude that he is to be regenerated with the Holy Ghost; and accordingly to give thanks for this in prayer unto God.

Conclusion: Therefore it is agreeable to the public and established doctrine of the Church of England, that all elect infants ordinarily receive the Spirit of Christ in baptism, in such manner and sense as is before expressed.

[22] That our liturgy has an eye to the covenant of grace, and presumes of any particular infant, that, "unto him the kingdom of heaven doth indeed belong;" and on this pronounces the child, after baptism is administered, to be regenerate, may appear most evidently by this: *viz.*: That it leads us to that which our Savior spoke in the Gospel touching those infants that were brought to him, and blessed by him upon this ground, that "theirs is the kingdom of heaven." Not that all children have the right to the kingdom; for Esau had none, (Romans 9). Yet because men cannot see God's secret decree, they are not to make doubt of any particular, but knowing that some infants are elected, and have right to the kingdom, upon this ground they know for certain that this child is regenerate by the Spirit, if he is elected, and if to him belongs the kingdom of God. And therefore our Church in charity pronounces too much of every child considered individually and apart, because in charity she presumes that to that very particular belongs the kingdom of God. For on this ground is the following exhortation and assurance built, which upon this consideration says, "Doubt ye not therefore, but earnestly believe that he will likewise favorably receive these present infants, that he will embrace them with the arms of his mercy, that he will give to them the blessing of eternal life, and make them partakers of his everlasting kingdom."

The major proposition cannot be doubted of, unless we shall say that the doctrine and liturgy of our Church are contrary to one another: which no man, well in his mind, will affirm and yet subscribe to both.

The minor, or, as some term it, the *assumption*, is then the only proposition that must be proved. I pray that you therefore, with patience, shall see it done, in its several branches. There are in it these two particulars:

1. The Church in her liturgy requires us to pray for the Spirit of Christ to be communicated to every particular infant brought to baptism, *presuming* of the particular that he is within the election of grace.
2. She concludes him to be regenerate as soon as he is baptized: that is, to have received the Spirit of regeneration, as its first principle.

1. For the former, let the liturgy itself be produced, wherein the Church enjoins.

1. The Minister alone in this way is to speak to the congregation, when any children are presented at the baptismal font, "I beseech you to call upon God the Father through our Lord Jesus Christ, that of his bounteous mercy, he will grant to these children that thing which by nature they cannot have, that they may be baptized with water and the Holy Ghost." The Church enjoineth further.

2. Both Minister and people are to pray; "We beseech thee for thine infinite mercies, that thou wilt mercifully look upon these children; sanctify them and wash them with the Holy Ghost." Again, in the second prayer; "We call upon thee for these infants, that they coming to Thy holy baptism may receive remission of their sins by spiritual regeneration." Yet again, in the third prayer; "Give thy Holy Spirit to these infants, that they may be born again, and be made heirs of everlasting salvation."

The purpose of the Church, then, is to teach us that we should expect the Spirit of Christ to be communicated in baptism, to elect infants: or else it must be concluded that the Church meant to mock us, by putting us to pray for that which she doth not believe we shall receive.

If any shall say, "the Church teacheth us to *pray*, indeed, for the regeneration of a child, when he is baptized, but not for his *present*

regeneration," I answer: yes, for his *present* regeneration; not actual, ordinarily, such as that he after attains to, in his effectual calling by the Word; yet *initial* and *potential*, (as was before distinguished), as shall appear in the proof of the second branch of the assumption, which is the following *point:*

2. The Church concludes in her liturgy that the child is initially regenerate in his baptism. *For:*

1. It *pronounceth* him to be regenerate; enjoining the Minister in this way to speak to the people, "Seeing now, dearly beloved that these children are regenerate, and grafted into the body of Christ's congregation, let us give thanks to God for these benefits." And lest any should shift this off by saying they are *sacramentally* regenerated, but not *spiritually* by any actual reception of the Spirit at that time, the solemn thanksgiving following is added to cut the throat of this shiftless gloss. Let us examine it in the next place.

2. It teacheth us all thus to join in thanksgiving unto God, "We yield thee hearty thanks, most merciful Father, that it hath pleased thee to *regenerate* this infant, *(how and with what*?), with thy Holy Spirit, to receive him for thine own child by adoption." What words can more fully manifest the Church's intention to teach us that all infants truly belonging to the covenant of grace ordinarily receive the Spirit in baptism: not as a thing which none of them had before but as that of which there was no certainty to us, nor confirmation unto them before, in the ordinary course of divine dispensation of the Spirit, by means?

If the matter is not yet clear enough to such as shut their eyes against it, let them further attend to what the Church requires us that are ministers to pronounce touching on a baptized child, rightly, in private, "I certify you that in this case, all is well done, and according to due order, concerning the baptizing of this child, who being born in original sin, and in the wrath of God, is now, by the laver of regeneration in baptism, received into the number of the children of God, and heirs of everlasting life. For our Lord doth not deny his grace and mercy unto such infants, but most lovingly calls them to him, as the Holy Gospel witnesses to our comfort, in this way, that at a certain time they brought children to Christ." Pick any other sense

than I have done out of the liturgy; especially when it shall be further cleared by the doctrine of the Church*; eris mihi magnus Apollo (you will be my great Apollo).*

But some will be ready to stop me here with various objections which must be answered before my way will be clear to go forward.

1. Some will be apt to say, "The Church perhaps teacheth us to pray in this way, and judge of infants baptized; but they do not do well in doing this; and that if this is the actual meaning of our book of common prayer, we ought not to join in such a prayer."

To this I answer, that it is indeed very true that some have been so bold as to place a lie upon that which the Minister pronounces touching regeneration of the infant baptized; saying, in plain terms, "That is a lie." But saving their foul mouths, I trust this shall appear even out of the Scriptures themselves, in our next chapter, to be the truth; and that God's own infallible truth will bear us out in it. I may not here prevent myself. However, something (to stay the stomachs of such as quarrel our Church for this point, or me, for misinterpreting our Church:) let me allege out of a good author (whom both they and I reverence) and show his judgment in the point. The person I mean is the learned and industrious author of the English Commentary upon Saint Paul's epistle to Titus, namely, Mr. Thomas Tailor. He, in writing on chapter 3 and verse 5 of that epistle, is so expressly engaged in this point, that all the mind of man cannot put him off, without equivocating. This is the judgment of all men that I have ever met with, who have thoroughly read and considered both the place and all that either goes before or follows after that author, to that purpose. Nor am I afraid to refer myself to be judged by the whole world, whether I have abused him in his writings or not, promising that if it appears to any able and impartial judges, that in what I have alleged out of his writings, that I have wronged him, I will ask him to forgive me on my knees, as public as I ever made the accusation incorrectly.

That author having treated of the efficacy of baptism, and proved that in men of years, faith is required to receive the grace offered in it, descends to a question, which in the margin of page 642 where he in this way summarizes it*; How baptism is effectual to infants*. His words in explication of this are the *following:*

"*Question*: But however in men of years faith is required unto baptism, yet we are most to respect it as administered unto children, in whom we cannot expect faith, and therefore unto them either faith is not requisite, or by the former answer their baptism is unprofitable.

Answer: This well is deep, and we want wherewith to draw certainty of resolution; but will assay in some propositions to deliver summarily that which may be extracted out of the Scriptures and expositors,[23] as most probable for the unfolding of this difficulty. To which purpose let us first distinguish of infants; of whom some are elected, and some do not belong to the election of grace. These latter receive only the outward element, and are not inwardly washed. The former receive, in right use of the sacrament, the *inward* grace: not that by it we tie the majesty of God to any time or means, whose Spirit bloweth when and where he wishes. But some receive the Spirit before baptism, who are sanctified from the womb; and some after baptism. But because the Lord delights to present himself gracious in his own ordinance, we may conceive that in the right use of this sacrament, he ordinarily accompanies it with his grace. Here, according to *his promise*, we may expect it, and here we may and ought to send out the prayer of faith for it."

These are Mr. Tailor's words. Do they need an interpreter? Do they require any labor to draw them home to my present point, *viz*. that it is most agreeable to the institution of Christ, that all elect infants ordinarily receive the Spirit in baptism, especially considering that this author in the end of the 639th page, had laid out this for a doctrine raised out of Titus 3:5, that, "God in baptism not only offereth and signifieth, but truly exhibiteth grace, whereby our sins are washed and we renewed by the Holy Ghost." And in explication of this doctrine, he clearly delivers his mind (in the words before quoted) how far forth this doctrine concerns infants, and how far forth it may be granted as true even of them also. I am afraid I shall abuse the judi-

[23] Mark here that Mr. Tailor could find Scriptures and expositors for this position that he here delivers.

cious reader's patience to keep him so long on this section, as to show how all that I collect out of this author (who lately professed unto me, *viva voce*, that he will stand to whatever he hath written, which makes me bolder with him) fully comes up to my purpose. However, because I am published to the world as a corrupter of this man's writings in this point in particular, and by that my sincerity is judged in the allegation of all others that I make use of in this treatise, I must entreat the intelligent reader, for a little while to imagine himself to be some unlearned man that doth not know how to construe plain English. And I wish him to be contented to learn of me that which a boy of 14 years would deserve to be whipped for if he could not understand what hath been plainly said without teaching.

It is said that I have corrupted my author. In what? In falsifying his words, or wrestling the sense? "The sense." How so? "He never meant that elect infants receive the inward grace, but only that they may do it? No?" Doth he not say that God ordinarily accompanies it with his grace? And is this not all one with his speech, "God ordinarily accompanies it with his grace?" "His meaning is mistaken: he doth not say it is done;" But, we may conceive that it is done? Good. But upon what ground are we to conceive this? Is it not this, "Because the Lord delighteth to present himself gracious in his own ordinance?" Or is this, "By virtue of his promise," we may expect it? Or is this, "Here we may and ought to send out the prayer of faith for it?" Or is it because this author hath searched *both* Scriptures and expositors, and finds this *most agreeable* to them? Now when a man tells me that, because this is most agreeable to Scriptures and expositors; "because the Lord delights to present himself gracious in his own ordinance;" because this is, "according to his promise;" and because, "here I may and ought to send out the prayer of faith for it; that therefore, "I may conceive that God ordinarily accompanies it with his graces," *do I abuse him to say that he is of my mind*, "that it is most agreeable to the institution of Christ, ordinarily to do this?"

"Oh," but Mr. Tailor adds; "in the right use of this sacrament," which perhaps in this sense implies as much as a receiving by faith?" Nay, he himself confesses in the very place alleged, that, "in infants we cannot expect faith." Therefore he can mean nothing other by, "the

right use of this sacrament," than a reverant administration of it according to the institution of our Lord, both for matter and manner; to one *within* the covenant.

One will say, "But he saith not say this of all elect infants." In common construction, his speech must be equivalent to a universal. For, when he distinguisheth of infants, whereof, he saith, "some are elect, and some belong not to the election of grace," doth he not give us a general distribution? Are there, in his judgment, some infants that are neither elect, nor non-elect? Again, when he speaketh of such as are, "not elect;" and saith, "these latter receive only the outward element," doth he not mean, in any man's apprehension, all these receive *only* the outward element? Then, by the rule of opposition, when he comes to speak to the other member of this distinction, and saith, "the former *(viz*. the elect) receive, in the right use of the sacrament the inward grace;" can any reasonable creature of the most slender capacity beyond a child, take him to mean less than all the elect?

"Yes," you will say, "they may and ought to take him to mean less; for he saith expressly, not that by it we tie the majesty of God to any time or means, whose Spirit blows when and where he wills;" on some, before; on some, after?" Well. And what follows hence, but only this, that however God hath set down this to be the ordinary course which he ties us to, yet it is not to be denied that he can, and sometimes doth extraordinarily bestow his Spirit, at *other* times? Now this makes no argument against me. I never said that all receive the Spirit *absolutely*; but, "All*, ordinarily* receive the Spirit in baptism." And so this author must allow me to be of his same mind compared to his own words. For he that saith that the, "elect do receive the inward grace;" and that God, "ordinarily," "accompanies the sacrament with his grace;" although he puts a correction of his words for the explication of himself, that he doth not speak this as laying an absolute tie upon God. Therefore, he cannot be in any way understood than in this way*: viz*., that in some extraordinary and special cases, it may be that the Spirit is given, and is otherwise than ordinary. To what other end should he add the word *ordinary*? It is true that God is not, "absolutely tied to times and means." And, whatever he doth, he doth it most freely. But yet when God hath set up a standing ordinance in his

Church, and made such a promise of the presence and bestowing of his grace, as may give his people ground to expect it; and hath bound them to, "send out the prayer of faith for it," he that shall say that God hath not tied and engaged himself ordinarily to give the grace promised, or that to believe this is to tie God where he hath not tied himself, doth not speak like a divine, *but makes God a liar.*

"But hath the author expressed himself, that it is sometimes, and in some special cases, in which the elect receive the Spirit in baptism?" Then he contradicts himself when he saith that God ordinarily accompanies it with his grace? I did not take it on me to quote what he speaks either in private or public; but what he hath publicly written concerning Titus 3:5,[24] where he saith that this is done *ordinarily.*

"Well, but when all is done, this author doth not positively determine the point, but only speaks what, in charity, may *probably* be conjectured. He saith, 'We want wherewith to draw certainty of resolution'?" It is true, he saith so indeed; but what then are those collections out of the Scriptures, and expositors, that he speaks about afterward? "They are but probable conjectures," you will say. True, yet he saith that what he here delivers, is *most* probable. I look for no more. For what could he say more that is not divinely inspired with an infallible Spirit, which no man takes this author to be? Yet he saith enough afterwards, to make the last words a plain contradiction to the first, if he would be taken in this sense, *viz.*, that, "he speaks only conjecturally;" and professes that, "if any should ask him, whether any elect infant receives the Spirit in baptism?" He would answer, "that he cannot tell." For make a note here concerning him that saith, first, that this is not certain whether elect infants receive the inward grace in baptism or not; yet afterwards saith that they, "do receive it;" that, by, "virtue of his promise we may expect it;" and, "here we may and ought to send out the prayer of faith for it;" what doth he but contradict himself? Will not a promise (where the promise is to be found lies upon the *Author* to show; if any man doubts of it), will not the prayer of faith, which we ought to put up to God, make this thing certain? Again, if the thing is yet uncertain, why doth he collect such a certain use of comfort from this particular discourse of his?

[24] Titus 3:5.

For afterwards, making use of the point, he saith, (page 647), "What a comfort is it for a Father to see his child washed with the blood of Jesus Christ? Cleansed from sin? Set into the visible Church; Yes, into the body of Christ, in the right use of the sacrament, in which a parent ought more to rejoice, than if he could make it heir of the world." And do *I* yet mistake this author? Or rather, are they not incendiaries, who have rumored it abroad, endeavoring to set him and me at odds, if it were possible? Yea, do they not by such reports (as daily fly up and down) of the contrariety of his judgment to this point, do what in them lies to damage him more than either he (I hope) will deserve; or than those will be able ever to recompense again to him, if notice should be taken by thereof, by some, "that watch for our hating, and make a man a transgressor for a word?"

So, I have cleared both my author and quitted myself of the unjust imputation of doing him wrong. His judgment, in this way, according to mine, will, I hope, somewhat allay their heat and fury, who, for this point, accuse both me of Arminianism, and our Church, of popery.

Objection: It is objected further, "Is our liturgy to be understood to speak in this way, only in the judgment of charity; and not as binding us to believe infants to be regenerated indeed?"

Answer: It is true that our Church indeed teaches us to hope well of every infant that she admits to baptism; and, in charity, to believe *it is indeed regenerated*; because, for though any man knows if any particular infant is elected, yet doth not bind us absolutely to believe it, *de fide*, of all infants *collectively* taken, because it is *certain* that all are not elected. But the judgment of charity must have a certain foundation to build on; otherwise it is not the judgment of charity, but foolish and sinful credulity void of all judgment. For, unless such a thing is true indeed of some infants, yes, ordinarily, of all that belong to God's election, I am not bound to believe it of every single one, in the ordinary course of divine dispensation. No, I am not bound to believe it, not even so much as in charity. For charity believes nothing but things possible and probable; yea, more probable than the contrary; and things sometimes certainly true of some particulars of the same kind.

No charity could bind me to believe Peter to be a reasonable creature, if it were not certain to me that some men, that all men were such. I am not tied to believe this professor to be an honest man, no not by the bonds of charity, if it were to be certain to me that *no* professor is an honest man. I would not be bound in the judgment of charity to believe that any of those strangling Athenian hearers that in such multitudes, flocked about me, while I preached this point, more than at other times, came for any other end than either to hear some new thing, (merely out of curiosity), or to heckle, to twist my words, to run away with willful mistakes, to censure and judge, to hope to see me foiled and shamed, because indeed I delivered that which they have here rashly and unsoundly taught or unprofitably learned. And because I will not conceal a truth which might convince them of error, unless it was either certainly known unto me, or upon certain grounds to be presumed, that some, yea that many are better affected than this, and more humbly and devoutly minded.

There must be a *certainty* in the *thesis*; otherwise no charitable judgment binds a man to believe anything in the *hypothesis*. Nor is it charity, but folly, that I should believe Peter receives the Spirit in baptism if he that bids me believe it of him, will not *warrant* me to believe it as something certain of any person at all. And it would be a very uncharitable speech to say that our Church meant to stretch my charity to believe impossibilities or improbabilities, or that which is never, yes, nor (ordinarily) certainly done. Therefore, when the Church (when it teacheth me to believe, in charity, that this and that, and the other infant receive the Spirit for initial regeneration in baptism) teacheth and requireth me (on this ground, that, for all I know of those particulars they are elected) to believe the meaning of the church to be this, *that there are some*, yea, *that all elect infants ordinarily receive the Spirit of regeneration in baptism, from the hand of Christ, truly and indeed.*

Objection 3: Lastly, it is objected, "The liturgy of our Church is not the public doctrine of our Church: therefore it doth not follow that this is the doctrine of our Church, because it is found in its liturgy."

Answer: I grant that the liturgy is not formally the *doctrine* of the Church; no more than the superstructure is formally the foundation. However, the liturgy is founded on the Scriptures, as shall anon ap-

pear. If the Church teaches me such a prayer, it is because it presupposeth the doctrine to allow it; otherwise the prayer would be without any foundation. The prayers of the Church are not intended principally for doctrinal instruction, but yet they take this for granted, that the doctrine is correspondent and warrants such prayers; otherwise they would be only blind devotions. Notwithstanding, to put the matter passed all doubt, and to drive the nail to the head, let me in the next place show what is the formal doctrine of our Church in this point. And here, I must give you the substance and force my proof in another syllogism.

Major: That which the public catechism contained in our book of common prayer, and which the *Articles of Religion* concluded in 1562 teach, is to be acknowledged for the *doctrine* of our Church.

Minor: But both our catechism and those articles teach what we have said concerning infants and baptism.

Conclusion: Therefore this position is agreeable to the doctrine of our Church.

There will be no question of the major by any understanding person therefore the minor only requires proof. This is proved by the parts, thus:

1. In the *catechism*. The answer to the second question teacheth every child to profess this*: viz*. that in baptism he was made a, "member of Christ, the child of God," and, "an inheritor of the kingdom of heaven." But no man can be made such, without the Spirit of Christ to initiate him into Christ; for by, "one Spirit are we all baptized into one body," (1 Corinthians 12:13). yea, it, "cannot be that infants should be truly members of the Church of Christ, unless they were endowed with the Spirit," saith Saint Peter Martyr.[25] Therefore every elect infant receives in his baptism, ordinarily, the Spirit to initiate him, according to the doctrine of our catechism.
2. Touching the Articles of Religion, I allege only the 27th article, which is this: "Baptism is not only a sign of profession and mark of difference, whereby Christian men are distinguished from others that are not christened; but it is also a sign of regeneration, or new

[25] *Ecclesia partes vere esse non possunt, nisi spiritu Christi ornati, lob. Com. clas.4 cap.8 sect.15*

birth, whereby, as by an instrument, those that receive baptism rightly, are grafted into the Church; the promises of the forgiveness of sin, and of our adoption to be the sons of God, by the Holy Ghost."

In which words we are to observe especially three *things:*

1. What baptism doth, outwardly, "It doth visibly sign and seal regeneration," and is *not* only a, "bare sign of profession."
2. What inwardly, "They that receive it rightly are grafted into the Church, the promises of the forgiveness of sin, and of adoption to be the sons of God by the Holy Ghost."
3. Who they are that are partakers of this inward grace, "They that receive it rightly;" and this the *Article* indefinitely, which in common construction of logic, must be understood as excluding none in the ordinary course of administration. An indefinite proposition, in a matter necessary is equivalent to a universal.

So then we have now come home to the very head of the point*: viz*., that, "All elect infants," by the doctrine of the Church, "are ordinarily partakers of the Spirit in baptism;" for, "they that receive it rightly, all that so receive it are partakers of the Spirit."

Objection: "But soft and fair; the article doth not say, all elect infants, but *they that receive it rightly?"*

Answer: The article, in those words, speaks the same thing for substance that I do not contend for, as may appear by showing what it means by the phrase *receiving rightly.*

To receive baptism rightly means two things*: viz.*,

1. That baptism is for *matter* and *form* the same that Christ appointed; namely, that the baptized is partly dipped in or sprinkled with water, in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and Holy Ghost, with all due reverence, also, for its manner.
2. That the person to be baptized is sufficiently qualified to give him a right to baptism*: viz*. that he is within the covenant of grace; at least so far forth *as the Church can judge of him*. Otherwise, he but usurps the ordinance, for what hath he to do with the seal of the covenant if he is not comprised in the covenant? Now then to *qualify* an infant, it is sufficient that he is within the covenant, if he is born of Christian parents, he is so far to be held within the covenant, that

the Church ought to admit him to baptism if he is presented to it. But yet we do not say that he is, instantly, or at all, partaker of the inward grace of baptism, unless he is truly in the covenant of grace, and under election. However, supposing him to be such a one, we say, that this is enough to make him capable of the Spirit, and to, "receive the sacrament of baptism rightly." For, more than this is not required at his hands, by the consent of all judicious divines that understand what they say, or whereof they affirm. And it is a blind conceit of Anabaptists to say that no infants are capable of the inward grace of baptism, unless they have actual faith and actually believe.

But unless any should take offense if I do not bring proof of what I say, I will produce *a few* of *many* divines that plainly affirm that it is not required of infants to have actual faith to make them capable of the inward grace of baptism, and that, notwithstanding that they lack that faith, and they may and do partake of the inward grace, by the Spirit. For this purpose I propound unto you the *following:*

1. Peter Martyr, "In infants," he saith, "who by reason of their tender years cannot believe, the Holy Ghost supplies the room of faith, and the effusion of the Holy Ghost is promised in baptism, as the Apostle expressly writes to Titus: 'who saved us by the laver of regeneration, and renewing of the Holy Ghost, which he shed abroad on us abundantly.'"[26]
2. Zanchius, upon those words in Ephesians 5:26, "…washing it with water through the Word," writes this, "On the behalf of the receiver, if he is of years, faith is required: but this faith is not here expressed, because the Apostle speaks of baptism wherein which infants, although destitute of actual faith are grafted into the body of the Church."[27] And lest any should take him to mean only an

[26] *Infantibus autem qui adhuc per atatem credere re non possunt, spiritus sanctius in eorum cordibus fides vices gerit. Effusio quoq, spiritus sancti promititur in baptismo, voin epist: ad Titum diserte scribitur, qui salvos nosfecit, loc. com. class. 8 sect.2*

[27] *Ex parte accipientus, si advlius sit, requiritur fides, Sed bec fides hoc in loco non exprimitur, quia de baptismo quo etiam parvuli, licet actuali fide destituti in corpus Ecclesia in seruntur, verba facit Apostolus dicendu mundans eam lavacro aquae in Ephesians 5. Externa media sunt verbum & aqua per ministrum Christi administrata: medium antem efficax ex parte vus qui mundatur est fides, ut in advito, vel saltem spiritus fidei ut in pueris, spiritus enim ipse applicat sarguinem Christi infantibus.*

outward admission, he afterwards adds; "The external means are the Word, and water administered by the Minister of Christ, the effectual means on his part that is cleansed, is faith, in one of years; at least the spirit of faith, as in infants: for to them the Spirit applies the blood of Christ."

3. That renowned Frenchman Daniel Chamier willingly yields that elect infants may be in some sense termed *faithful*: but how? "Not actual believers, but only *potential*: because no man believes (actually) but he that is capable of discourse."[28]
4. Dr. William Ames, to prove against the Anabaptists the lawfulness of baptizing infants, of 5 arguments, he reserves this to the last place, as if he set most by it, "In the very beginning of regeneration, of which baptism is the seal, a man is merely passive: and it is here that of a man that is to be either circumcised or baptized, no external act is required, as in other sacraments there is; but only a capacity passive to receive. Infants therefore are as capable of this sacrament, in respect even of its chief use, as men of years themselves."[29]

And indeed, it is absurd to say that the grace of that sacrament cannot be attained by infants without actual faith in them, when as it is clear that one part of its inward grace is the Spirit, the worker of faith. Now, no man sound in mind in his wits will say that no person can first receive the Spirit, but by the hand of actual faith, without the Spirit to work it in him?[30] He must therefore first be a partaker of the Spirit of faith to beget faith in him. This Spirit, then, he may receive

[28] *Quomodo inquam fideles? actua ne an potentia nam si actua, negatur: quia nemo credit nisi. compos rationis, lib.5 cap.10 paragraph 28.*

[29] *Quia in ipso innio regenerationis cuius sigillum est baptismus, homo se habei mere possive unde etiam hominis vel circumcidendi vel baptiz indi nulla actio externa requiritur, ut in aliis sacramentis; sed tantum receptio passiva. Infantes igitur sunt aeque capaces huius sacramenti, respectu praecipui etus usus atq. adulti medull. Theol. lib.1 cap.40 Thes.13*

[30] *Spiritus autem communicari dicitur fidelibus, non quia antecedit omnem spiritus operationem, ut quidam imperiti colligunt; nomi ipsam prima regeneratio, & conversio aperte tribuitur spiritui sancto a Christo.* (John 3:5-8) genitus ex spiritu. *Sed quia soli credentes postquam iom crediderunt, operatinoemillam accipiur spiritus sancti, qua obsignantur tanquam arrha haereditatis futurae.* (Ephesians 1:13-14 and 4:30, Galatians 3:14) The Spirit is said to be communicated to the faithful, not because faith goes before all operation of the Spirit, as some ignorant men collect: for the very first regeneration and conversion is plainly attributed by Christ, to the Holy Spirit. (John 3:5-8) Except a man be begotten of the Spirit, etc., but therefore the Spirit is said to be communicated to them, because only believers after they have be-

in baptism, without *actual* faith to take him in. These new jingles in divinity, against the current of all judicious divines, are most intolerable, and good for nothing that I know, but to breed quarrels, to work distractions, to increase doubts, to make all things uncertain, and to bring in atheism. I never yet saw that divine of note in the Church, that ever dared to say and stand to it, that any infants, though dying in infancy, were of necessity actually to believe, or else they could not be united to Christ so as to be saved. Nor yet, that no man can ordinarily have the Spirit of Christ in baptism or at any other time, till by faith he lays hold upon him and so receives him into his heart. But this is a side not to consider.

5. That Reverend Bishop, Dr. Davenant, in his elaborate and solid lectures upon Saint Paul's epistle to the Colossians, answering that objection so much bawled by the Anabaptists (one of the most *ignorant* sects in Amsterdam*) viz*., that baptism hath mortification annexed to it, of which infants are not capable because they are destitute of knowledge and faith to apprehend it; and therefore are not to be baptized? He saith, "If they speak of actual faith, and of the actual study and profession of mortification and vivification, those Scriptures which require these in persons to be baptized, are to be restrained to those of *years*. Touching infants, because they are sinners, not actual, by any proper act of their own, but by a hereditary *habit* in Adam, it sufficeth them to have faith, not actually exercising itself, but included in the *habitual principle of grace: and, that the Spirit of Christ can work this habitual* principle of grace in them, and useth so to do, none but a cracked brain will deny."[31]
6. The author of the comment on Titus: answering an objection which some might make against the resolution of the question touching on the ordinary reception of the inward grace in baptism*; viz*.,

lieved receive that work of the Spirit by which they are sealed, as with the earnest of the inheritance to come, Dr. Ames, Medull. Theo. lib.1 cap.28 de adopt. Thes. 23.

[31] *Si loquantur de fide actuali, de actuali studio &professione mortificationis & vivificationis, illa Scriptura loca quae loec requirunt no baptizatis, ad adultos esserestringenda dicimus. Ad infantes autem quod attinet, quia peccatores, sunt non proprio actu, sed hereditario habitu, sufficit quod peccati mortificationem & fidem habeant non preprio actu sese exerentem, sed in habituali principio gratiae inclusiam: spiritum autem Christi principium hoc habituale gratiae in illis efficere posse & solere nemo sanus negaverit.*

that infants lack faith? He saith; that, "they want indeed actual faith which presupposeth hearing, and understanding." He further saith with Musculus, that, "Children may be called *faithful*, although they have no faith," and with Zanchius, that, "It is probable that elect infants have the Spirit of faith" and in such as live to years, he adds, that the Spirit, "worketh in the seeds or inclinations of faith, which in due time shall bear fruit to eternal life."

Now, we have witnesses enough here, and sufficient information to prove that to, "receive baptism rightly so as to partake of the Spirit in it, faith is not required." And I think every man will acknowledge that all these authors were far enough off from *popery* and *Arminianism*, that these are also witnesses *for me*. And will men yet lay both popery and Arminianism to my charge?

If this is Arminianism or popery to say that, "all right receivers do ordinarily receive the Spirit in baptism," so long as I restrain it only to *right receivers*, and declare that by right receivers I mean only those that truly and indeed belong to the election of grace, I must be content to bear this brand, as many do the name of *Puritan*, without abandonment.

Objection: But they will say, "Both the liturgy, catechism, and article speak generally, excluding none: therefore, if you are in sober sadness, resolved to stick so close to the doctrine of the Church of England, you must hold this, not of the elect only, but of *all* infants no matter what?

Answer: It is very true that our Church excludes none from participation of the inward grace in the sacrament; but, knowing for certain that all the elect *do* partake of it, and not knowing at all that this or that particular infant is not elected, doth not suffer any of her children to speak or judge of any particular infant that he doth not receive the inward grace; no more than she permits him to say that such a particular is not elected, "For, who hath known the mind of the Lord?" (Romans 12:3). And, "who art thou that judgest another man's servant?" (Romans 14:4). However, our Church knows very well, and *presumes* that all her children are known only to God, "They are not all Israel that are of Israel," (Romans 9:6): and that of those, "many" that, "are called" but a, "few are chosen," (Matthew 20:16). But who those few are, she will not determine, yet so much she doth determine, that any

particular infant is to be taken and held in the judgment of charity, for a member of the true invisible elected sanctified Church of Christ, and that he is regenerated indeed, in the sense before said. And so do I. Notwithstanding, do not mistake her or me. It is one thing to speak of all infants distributively, singling them out individually one by one, and passing judgment of each particular apart; and another thing to speak of them collectively, and in the lump, without restraining our speech to any particular. To say that we cannot judge of any particular son of Adam, not discovered by God himself to be rejected, that he is rejected of God doth not prove that no son of Adam is rejected; when we speak of all mankind in the general mass or lump; for then, what need of a hell for castaways? So, that learned Bishop saith, "By the judgment of charity, the faithful judge every professed member of the visible Church, when they speak of the particular persons, to be a member of the invisible, elected, called, justified, sanctified; however they know in general, that many are in the Church, which are not of it, and that many are called, but few are chosen."[32] The same phrase we have in the form of burial, wherein when we bury any particular persons whatsoever, we are taught to say and pray, "that we with this our brother may have perfect consummation and bliss," and yet no man will say that all men that die go to heaven, for even in that very prayer we are taught to restrain this, "only to the elect: Almighty God, with whom do live the spirits of them that depart hence in the Lord, and in whom the souls of them that be elected, after they be delivered from the burden of the flesh be in joy and felicity."

So then, neither our liturgy (in the public form of baptism) nor catechism, nor article intend to bind me or any man else to believe that every man without exception indeed partakes of the inward grace of baptism, although it binds me and every man to conclude no other, when we place our speech upon any particular. Nor is this my interpretation of the phrases at hand alone; but that judicious Hooker also saith, that, "all do not receive the grace of the sacrament that receive the sacrament of his grace."[33] So Mr. Thomas Rogers also saith this in his often printed commentary on the *Articles of Religion*. For in ar-

[32] Dr. John Downham on Psalm 15:1, page 19.

[33] Lib.5 Sect.57.

ticle 25, he makes this one of the propositions couched in that article; "All which receive the sacraments, do not receive there with all the things signified by the sacraments."[34] And before, in explication of the third proposition, he saith; "In some the sacraments effectually work in process of time by the help of God's Word read or preached which engender faith. Such is the estate principally of infants elected unto life and salvation, and increasing in years." And upon Article 28, proposition 4, "The spiritual life is peculiar to God's elect." Mr. Hooker delivers as much, for having said that infants, "receive the divine virtue of the Holy Ghost," in baptism, "which giveth to the powers of the soul their first disposition towards future newness of life;" afterward adds, "Predestination doth not bring to life, without the grace of external vocation, wherein our baptism is implied. For as we are not naturally men without birth, so neither are we Christian men in the eye of the Church of God, but by new birth, nor according to the ordinary manifest course of divine dispensation new born, but by that baptism which both declareth and maketh us Christians. In which respect we justly hold it to be the door of our actual entrance into God's house, the first apparent beginning of life, a seal perhaps to the grace of election before received, but to our sanctification here a step that hath not any before it."[35] Some may cavil at the word *perhaps*: and say that he makes it but a *perhaps*, that men receive baptism as a seal of election. But before they do so, let them duly weigh the place I quoted in Hooker, and they shall find that he makes *no perhaps* of this. He saith that such as partake of the grace of baptism are elected: but only of this, that they do, perhaps, *receive baptism* as a seal of grace of election before bestowed on them; for he is dealing with Thomas

[34] Propos. 11. He that shall hold otherwise doth in effect bring in *opus operatum* again. For although he will say that grace is given by virtue of the institution, yet he also saith that, by virtue of the institution, every infant outwardly baptized is partaker of the inward grace. Why so? Because baptized, forsooth. Now no papist will say that baptism could confer grace if it were not by virtue of divine institution; for there are none of them so absurd as to say that the outward signs of themselves naturally, without respect to the institution, do confer grace. This opinion therefore, for substance, is the very same with that of the papists; only they have put on other clothes upon it. It is as much wolfish as the other, only it hath gotten on a lamb's skin. Therefore Dr. Whitaker disclaims it in his treatise *De Sacram. in genere*, quaest. 4, cap. 1: *Non enim ex opere operato, ne parvulis quidem gratiam conferri a Sacramentis affirmamus, ut necesse sit habere gratiam omnes qui Sacramenta percipiunt.*

[35] Lib.5 Sect.60 page 316.

Cotton in this work about baptism. Cotton affirms that, "Baptism is only the seal of grace before received." Mr. Hooker answers by distinguishing of grace, into grace of election and grace of sanctification; admitting his words (with a perhaps) to be true, in the former sense; but not in the latter, ordinarily.[36] And doth not that Reverend prelate, Dr. Francis White, in answer to the calumny of the Jesuit Fisher say as much? For, first, he makes good the efficacy of baptism, out of Scriptures, fathers, our own Church, and foreign divines, and particularly out of John Calvin. Then, he adds, now without approbation of it, (why else should he speak it? And what use would it be of against Fisher?), "The same author with others of his part, maintain the former doctrine concerning the efficacy of the sacrament of baptism, and they differ only from Lutherans and Pontificians. They differ first, in that they restrain the grace of sanctification only to the elect. Secondly, in that they deny external baptism to be always effectual at the very instant time when it is administered.[37] [38]

To make an end, our own catechism teaches as much in express terms. What need we further witness? That, teaches me to, "believe in God the Holy Ghost, who hath sanctified me and all the elect people of God." The elect; all the elect, only the elect if my learned friend Dr. Jackson's word may be taken for the exposition: for he would have the reader to observe a difference between the extent of the sufficiency (for so I take him) of Christ's death, and the efficacy of Christ's Spirit.", "Although," he saith, "in that place we are taught to believe in the Holy Ghost; yet this we are taught with this *caveat*, that he sanctifies all the elect people of God, not all mankind."[39] Now, compare our

[36] *Deus in baptismo ut significat remissionem peccatorum & salutem, ita re operatur: veritas cum signo conjuncta est in electis. Whitaker: de sacram. in gen: quest.4 cap.2 respons. ad 7 testim.*

[37] Answer to Fisher, page 176.

[38] If any shall press me with the rubric, before confirmation of this point, my answer is that rubric has reference to confirmation; giving us to understand that if an infant dies without confirmation it is certain by Scripture that he is undoubtedly saved, as if he had been confirmed. 2. That rubric speaks of the state of infants dying before they come to years, as the old rubric of the first book says expressly, which does not concern our present position which has reference only to such infants as live to years of discretion, showing what, ordinarily, is conferred on them in baptism; and not what they receive, that live not so long, but die in infancy. In these I doubt not that the Spirit of God works more effectually.

[39] Treatise of God's Essence and Attributes, Sect.2 cap.15 page 171

liturgy, article, and catechism all together. The liturgy teaches me to believe of this and every particular infant considered single and apart that he is indeed, "regenerate of the Holy Ghost." The article saith that they (that they *all*), "that receive baptism rightly are grafted in by the Holy Ghost." The catechism shows how this is to be limited, and extended, saying, that, "the Holy Ghost sanctifies me and all the elect people of God." Therefore by the doctrine of our Church, all the elect and only the elect[40] certainly and indeed, ordinarily receive the Spirit, in baptism. Yes, our liturgy is *clear* in this point, as I have before shown, in that it presumes the child to be one to whom belongs the kingdom of God; upon which ground we are taught, "not to doubt but steadfastly to believe that he will favorably receive the present infant; that he will embrace him with the arms of his mercy, that he will give unto him the blessing of eternal life, and make him partaker of his everlasting kingdom." Again in the end of the prayer which is appointed to be used immediately before the act of baptism in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost, we pray that the children may, "receive the fullness of God's grace and ever remain in the number of his faithful and elect children;" which shows plainly that the Church supposes that all such as do indeed receive the Spirit in their baptism, are of the number of God's elect. And so Bucer expounded it of old, as shall hereafter appear in due place,[41] when we come to show the judgment of foreign divines in this point.

Nor is this to be put off with that new coined distinction of election to grace and not to glory. For the liturgy speaks only of election to glory, inasmuch as it had assured us before, that God will give unto the infant baptized, "the blessing of eternal life, and make him partaker of his everlasting kingdom," and so concludes this prayer, that the infants may be, "inheritors of his everlasting kingdom through Christ our Lord." And why should any presume to obtrude upon the Church such a distinction which hath not have the least show of any footing in the Word of God? For however, I do not deny but that the Scripture sometimes speaks of a temporary election of some persons

[40] This restraint is clear in the Scripture (see Galatians 4:6). And we must expound the doctrine of our Church by that rule. See the next chapter.

[41] Chapter 6.

to particular offices and services in the Church of God; yet it never speaks of election to the grace of sanctification, but as it is a beginning of glory which certainly follows sanctification and is undoubtedly conferred on all that are sanctified: so as no man is elected to the one but he is elected unto the other also. For such grace is but glory begun, (2 Corinthians 3:18). And when Saint Paul commends the Ephesians to God, "that is able to give them an inheritance among all that are sanctified," (Acts 20:32) he most evidently shows that, as none partake of the inheritance but such as are sanctified; so none that are sanctified can miss of the inheritance. The same might be demonstrated out of Romans 8:29-30, where the Apostle shows that all predestination to effectual calling and justification ends in glorification, as Saint Augustine most soundly and unanswerable collect from this very text.[42]

Yes, this truth is so clear that *Bellarmine* himself could not but confess and maintain it against all opposers, although he could not but know it to be contrary to the doctrine of many of his own side, who were the first authors of the distinction of election, "into election to grace, and election to glory," which is still maintained by the later Jesuits, Cornelius a Lapide,[43] and others, from whom the Arminians have made bold to borrow it, as they do sundry other wares of that society. But Bellarmine is peremptory that whosoever is under the decree of God's election, however perverse and cross he may so be to the means of his conversion, and perseverance in grace,[44] and in respect of the liberty of his will may be yielded to be such a one as may possibly refuse grace, yet it is certain that he will not refuse it, because God will call him in such manner as may best agree to his disposition to the end that he might not reject God calling him. For by this means it comes to pass that the true grace of God is refused of no hard heart, because grace is given to this very purpose that it might mollify the heart. And all this he speaketh to show that God's decree cannot fail;

[42] De predest. sanct. cap.17 videlocum.

[43] Com. in Ephesians 1:4-5.

[44] *Respondeo potest ille libere gratiam repudiare, sed certum est non repudia turum, quia deus vocabit illum, sic ut videt congruum illi esse ut vosantem non respuat. Hoc enim wodo gratia dei vera anullo duro corde respuitur, quoniam ad hoc datur ut cor emolliat. Haec Bel. de Gra. lib. arb. lib.2 cap.15 resp. ad 2 object.*

but that all who are elected to glory, and do as certainly obtain the one, as they do the other.

Objection: But yet some may here object one thing more, and that is this, "The Church teacheth to believe all the elect to be regenerate actually, and not only initially, as you say. Why may not any man expound it in that sense, as well as in yours; the terms are general, seeing this child is regenerate."

Answer: If by actual regeneration is meant an actual change of the heart by the infusion and operation of particular habits of grace, the best expositors of the doctrine of our Church teach otherwise, and the very doctrine of the Church doth itself declare the contrary, in the ordinary course of such as live to years. For expositors, take Mr. Rogers, in the place before cited, where he is allowed to deliver this to be the sense of the Church, "In some the sacraments do effectually work in process of time by the help of God's word read or preached which engendereth faith, such is the estate principally of infants elected unto life and salvation, and increasing in years."[45] And this book hath been printed with public allowance many times. If the Church will not be tried by him, then mark what Mr. Hooker hath to this purpose, "Baptism is a sacrament which God hath instituted in his Church to the end that they which receive the same might by it be incorporated into Christ, and so through his most precious merit obtain as well that saving grace of imputation which takes away all former guiltiness, as also that infused divine virtue of the Holy Ghost which gives to the powers of the soul their first disposition toward future newness of life.[47]

But you will say, "the words of our book are plain?" True: so is *Hoc est Corpus Meum*, for you know what: yet you and I know these words must be expounded according to the true sense of them explained by other Scriptures which make plainly against both transubstantiation, and consubstantiation. So then, the words of our book in the liturgy must admit of what sense our doctrine elsewhere sets on it. Now, our doctrine is itself clear against certain actual regeneration in baptism of infants *living to years*. For in Acts 17, touching on predestination,

[45] In article 25, prop. 3.

[47] Ibid., op. sect. 60.

it is said; “they which be endued with so excellent a benefit of God, be called according to God’s purpose by his Spirit, working in due season they through grace obey the calling, they be justified freely, they be made the sons of God by adoption.” So much of what our Church holds in this.

CHAPTER IV. The Point Proved by Authority of Scripture.

My next work is to make good the point in hand, by divine and infallible testimony of Holy Writ. And this is that foundation only, which I build on, for proof of the position. If any shall convince me to have failed in this, I will forever abandon this opinion, (although it should be with peril of life) whatever all the men and Churches in the world should profess, and bind me to the contrary.[48]

That I may more methodically proceed, and dispatch more speedily that which I have to allege out of the Scriptures, I must necessarily bind myself to the laws of argumentation, wrapping up the force of my arguments in some plain syllogisms (as I have done in the former chapter) and confirming the several propositions that need proof, by expressed Scriptures, expounded by such learned expositors, as my adversaries *pretend* most respect to. By this course I shall be sure not to abuse my readers, if they are able to judge of reason when they see it.

Argument 1: My first argument shall be drawn from the nature of baptism in respect of the several parts of it which the Scripture continually joins together, when it speaks of that sacrament; and I frame it in this way.

Major: That which the Scriptures attribute to baptism, as the chief part and as it were the soul of that ordinance is ordinarily communicated to *all* the elect, *when* they partake of baptism.

Minor: But the Scriptures do attribute the confirming of the Holy Ghost to that ordinance as a principal part of it.

Conclusion: Therefore it is consonant to the Scriptures that *all elect infants baptized*, ordinarily receive the Spirit in baptism.

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[48] *Nemo mibi dicat, O Quid dixit dominus, aut quid dixit parmenianus, aus pontius, aut qualibetillorum. Quia nec catrolicis episcopis consentiendum est, sicubi forte falluntur, ut centra canonica Dei Scripturas aliquid sentiant Aug de Unit. Eccl. cap. 10. Si enim ratio contra divinarum Scripturarum authoritatem reddutur, quamlibet acuta sit, falllit verisimilitudine, nam vera esse non potest. Hom. epist.7 ad Marcellin.*

The major proposition, I think, should not be doubted of by any; unless by Sacramentarians. For, will any man of understanding deny to the elect that which the Scriptures everywhere attribute as the chief part, and as it were the soul and life of that ordinance of baptism? If any man shall do so, he must grant that elect infants receive but a piece of baptism; the shell, without the kernel; the body, without the soul. And if this is true, to what end are they baptized? If they are not, even in infancy, capable of the principal part of baptism, why are they admitted to it? How shall we answer the Anabaptists who plead from here, against the baptizing of infants, that they are not capable of the inward grace? Dr. Ames affirmeth, that, "they are as capable of baptism, in respect of the chief use thereof, as persons of years;" who shall deny them the inward grace? Do we not know that in God's account, the sacrament of circumcision was not accounted circumcision when it was only outward in the flesh, and not inward also in the heart? "For, he is not a Jew which is one outwardly; neither is that circumcision, which is outward in the flesh. But he is a Jew which is one inwardly; and circumcision is that of the heart in the Spirit, and not in the letter, whose praise is not of men, but of God," (Romans 2). Circumcision we know, was a, "seal of the righteousness which is by faith," (Romans 4:11). Now I demand, whether a sound divine ever affirmed that only the outward ceremony of circumcision of the flesh was unto the elect, the proper and only seal of the righteousness which is by faith? I am sure the Scripture everywhere teaches that the Spirit is the seal of God set upon the faithful.[49] If then, circumcision was accounted uncircumcision where it was not accompanied with the inward grace, what shall we say other of baptism, where the Spirit is not communicated? Therefore, also in baptism of the elect (for whose sakes only, this and all other ordinances of Christ were set up in the Church) there must be, ordinarily, not only the outward element of water sprinkled on the child, but also the inward grace, otherwise it must necessarily follow that either in the baptizing of elect infants, only half baptism is ordinarily conferred, which in God's account is no better than no baptism. Or, baptism is not to infants what the Scriptures affirm it to be to men of years. And if this last is true,

[49] 2 Corinthians 1:22; Ephesians 1:13; 4:30.

in the ordinary course of divine dispensation, I will have to maintain that *infants are not to be baptized*. If those infants, which may be saved without baptism, receive no more than the outward sign when they are baptized, *why are they baptized*? Can the outward sign save them; or make them more certain or more capable of salvation than they were before, so long as they remain void of faith? Would it not be as good to defer their baptism until they are of years; as to offer them to baptism in infancy, which doth them no more good, than it doth to a reprobate, until their actual conversion? To say that baptism admits them to the outward means, is to say nothing to the actual purpose. For, ask these men, what is it that makes a person capable of the inward grace of baptism. They will answer; *faith*. But how is this faith worked in them? *By preaching of the word* they say. Well, admit this, may an infant unbaptized not come to hear the word read or preached? Anabaptists do not shut their children out of the Church when the word is preached, but only exclude them from the sacraments. And we also permit excommunicate persons to hear sermons, however we debar them from other ordinances. Therefore infants do not need baptism merely for their admission to the outward means of faith and conversion, for as much as they may participate of the word without baptism, and the word being, according to these men the only outward ordinary means of begetting faith. If Anabaptists might as freely show themselves here among us, as they do in other countries, this doctrine of baptismal grace would be better entertained by such as now impugn it without consideration of this sequel. This therefore to me is without all controversy, that, "What the Scriptures do attribute to baptism as the principal part and as it were the soul of baptism, is ordinarily communicated from Christ unto the elect, although infants (because in them actual faith is *not* required) in their baptism." Where the Scripture makes no difference, why should we?

What else doth the author of the commentary on the epistle to Titus mean, where he saith,[50] "We must conceive that in every sacrament there are three essential parts, the absence of any of which destroy the whole; 1. The sign, 2. The thing signified, 3. The analogy between them, which is the union of them both. The first, is some out-

[50] Page 639.

ward and sensible thing; the second, inward and spiritual; the third, mixed of them both." To this agree *all* learned divines and *confessions* of Reformed Churches, so far forth at least, that they cannot unanimously conclude sacraments to be not naked signs, "but certain sure witnesses and effectual signs of grace and God's good will towards us, by which he doth work invisibly in us,"[51] and convey some inward grace, ordinarily, from Christ to all that have a true interest in the covenant of grace, of which sacraments are the seals. And to my major, stands good against all Sacramentarians, and their unwitting proctors no matter what. I come therefore to the minor premise.

The minor proposition now to be proved is this, "But the Scriptures do attribute the conferring of the Holy Ghost to that ordinance, as the principal part of it." This I make good by all such Scriptures as mention the conferring of, and washing with the Holy Ghost, as well as with the outward element; without difference of years, and without mention of actual faith to apply the same.

I might begin with that place in John 3:5, "Except a man be born of water and of the Spirit," where water and the Spirit are joined, as going together into all heirs of the kingdom. This place, (however some make a doubt whether it is meant of the sacrament of baptism, yet) not only the ancients, but Beza[52] also without all doubt, interprets of baptism, so also, the learned Bucer.[53] But because I did not use it in my lectures, and some may wrangle at the exposition, therefore resolve to wave it: and quote only three other texts.

The first is that in Matthew 3:11, "I indeed baptize you with water unto repentance: but he that cometh after me is mightier than I, whose shoes I am not worthy to bear, he shall baptize you with the Holy Ghost and with fire." In which place John makes the baptism of Christ to consist not only of water, *but of the Holy Ghost*, and of the powerful operation of the Holy Ghost metaphorically described

[51] Articles of Religion 25.

[52] *Sed de baptismo hic agi, sive simpliciter, sive aliqua ad legales ablutiones allusione, omnino existimo. Beza in locum.*

[53] *Nec enim audiendos puto eos, qui hic per aquam, non aquam sed spiritum sanctum volunt intelligi; quasi vero Dominus voluerit spiritum sanctum bis ponere: eo dicere, vel, qui non fuerit genitus ex spiritu sancto et spiritu sancto; vel, qui non fuerit genitus ex aqua, quae est spiritus sanctus. Bucer de vi et effic. Baptis. inter script. Anglic., pag. 596.*

under the term of *fire*. Nor can it be understood, either of baptism administered by Christ in his own person, (for Jesus himself did not baptize; but his disciples did[54]) or only of extraordinary gifts of the Spirit conferred on the Apostles to work miracles, and to speak with tongues:[55] but it is meant also of that which all the elect may expect in the *right use* of that ordinance, by virtue of *Christ's* institution, ordinarily, when his ministers rightly dispense the outward element. For mark this, John doth not speak this to Christ's Apostles afterwards assembled at Jerusalem, but to the promiscuous multitude that came to his baptism. Therefore it cannot be meant only of those extraordinary gifts bestowed on the Apostles in the day of Pentecost; but of the ordinary course of divine dispensation unto *all* the elect.

To justify this exposition better, consider the Apostle Peter speaking unto such as those who heard him, "were pricked in their hearts;" and demanded, "what they should do?" For he answers thus; "Repent, and be baptized every one of you, in the name of Jesus Christ, for the remission of sins, and ye shall receive the gift of the Holy Ghost," (Acts 2:38). He requires them to repent, indeed, before baptism, because they were of years: but, on their baptism, he assures them of the Holy Ghost to be bestowed on every one of them. True, you will say; "but that was *because* they repented." I deny that; for however, if they had not repented, they had not received the Holy Ghost. Yet their repentance was not the cause of their receiving the Spirit in baptism, but, Christ's own institution and promise to accompany his own ordinance with the inward grace. Otherwise, why did they need to be baptized? For if repentance would certainly *fetch* the Spirit; baptism in that respect should be superfluous. It cannot honestly be denied that those very persons had received the Spirit in some measure before baptism. How else could they have repented? If then they did not receive the Spirit first, on their repentance, but before it, this seems a truth impregnable, that infants who cannot actually repent, do not ordinarily receive the Spirit in baptism, for want of repentance? Or can it be inferred from any of the places before quoted, that they speak of the efficacy of baptism in persons of years only?

[54] John 4:2.

[55] Acts 2:2-4; Luke 24:49; Acts 1:4-5.

Some perhaps will be ready yet to press me, that both the place in Matthew, and those alleged out of the Acts also, clearly intend an extraordinary manifestation of the Spirit visibly on the men there spoken of, and of extraordinary gifts bestowed on them; and so cannot be drawn to prove what is *ordinarily* conferred in baptism now. But let such consider that however the places indeed comprehend an extraordinary manner and measure of conferring the Spirit to those that were then baptized; yet baptism was the ordinance in which those extraordinary gifts were given. And what can this teach us but that in baptism the Spirit is still bestowed, although not in like manner of measure as at the first? That miraculous way of conferring the Spirit was then necessary to gain honor to the Gospel from unbelievers. This necessity being removed, we have no reason to expect the like extraordinary manner of dispensation. But because we have as much need of the Spirit to regenerate and sanctify us, as ever they had, therefore we have even from there as good warrant as they to expect the donation of the Spirit in our baptism, so far as the Spirit is useful and necessary for us in these times to fit us for Christ's work and kingdom.

But some will yet object, that place in Matthew is so far from proving the actual conferring of the Spirit in baptism, that it rather proves the exact contrary. For John speaking to such as he had baptized, saith of Christ, "He shall baptize;" not, "He *hath* baptized you, with the Holy Ghost," they therefore did not receive the Spirit in baptism, but were to expect it as a thing then to come. How then can it follow here that water and the Spirit ordinarily go together in baptism of the elect?

To this I answer, 1. That it cannot be proved that this speech was directed to such as were baptized; although it was uttered at that time it was spoken to such as came to his baptism, to be rather spectators, than to be baptized of him. For the 7th verse makes it manifest that this was spoken to the Pharisees and Sadducees; who, if we believe Saint Luke, "rejected the counsel of God against themselves, and were not baptized of him," (Luke 7:30). If this answer will not pass, then I add, 2. The Baptist did not mean to show a difference of time between the outward washing, and conferring of the Holy Ghost, but only to note a difference between him, the ministerial agent, and Christ the Author of that sacrament; by it to raise their thoughts higher and

to teach them to depend on Christ for the conferring of his Spirit, which John, his Minister, could not confer, although he baptized them outwardly with water. He distinguishes, not *de Baptismis*, as if his baptism differed from that of Christ: but *de baptizantibus* of the *persons* baptizing, showing what was proper to himself; namely, to baptize outwardly with water; and what to Christ; namely, to confer the Holy Ghost, the learned Chamier saith,[56] who makes good his exposition, out of Augustine, Chrysostom, and Jerome; The speech therefore notes, not a distance of time, but a difference of agents; it shows, not what those that were then baptized did not receive at the present; but from whom that gift is received, and to whom the conferring of it is to be ascribed.[57] He speaks no other ways of Christ baptizing them, in the future tense than he doth of his coming, in the same tense also he that, "cometh after me," saith our translation, "shall baptize you." But in the original it is, ὁ δὲ ὀπίσω μου ἐρχόμενος (Matt. 3:11); which, word for word, is to be rendered thus, *qui venturus*, he that is *coming*, or *about to come after me*; as if he had not presently come: and yet we know that he had come, even at that time, therefore both Beza and our translators render the text in the present tense, *Qui venit*, he that, "cometh." And in the same sense we understand that which follows of Christ's baptizing with the Holy Ghost. He, "shall baptize;" that is, saith Beza,[58] he, "doth" baptize you with the Holy Ghost. To this I may add that which learned Bucer saith of so many of them as were truly baptized unto repentance; that, to the, "intent they might escape the wrath to come, it must of necessity follow that they received the Holy Ghost as the Spirit of saving repentance, and faith in Christ, even in that baptism of John."[59] The reason of this exposition is that which was given before*: viz.*, that the scope of the Baptist is not to point at the time when, but at the *person* who baptizes with the Holy Ghost. Nor, to restrain his speech only to such as were then baptized, but to assure all the elect of God of the same benefit of baptism, when they

[56] De Sacram. lib.5 cap.13 par.21.

[57] So Calvin, lib.4 Instit. cap.15 sect.8.

[58] *Qua etiam ratione dixit futuro tempore, potius quam, Beza in Matthew 3.*

[59] *Bucer in Script. Anglic. Devi & efficacia Baptis. page 595. So also Dr. Whitaker: de Sacram in Genere question 4 cap.2 Nec sequitur, baptizabit; ergo non baptizat: nom illud baptizabit, continuum catum. sive continuam actionem significat.*

should, by God's providence, be its partakers. Which being so, I conclude here that the Baptist, in that passage, declares what in baptism is ordinarily communicated to all the elect, infants themselves being not excluded. For as Dr. Ames saith well,[60] it is not in baptism as in other ordinances of God, that a man must necessarily lay hold on the thing signified, by an act of his own, or else he should not receive it, here *receptio tantum passiva*, only a passive capacity to receive grace offered is sufficient,[61] which unto elect infants is never lacking, because, "theirs is the kingdom of God."

A second place is that in 1 Corinthians 12:13, "For by one Spirit are we *all* baptized into one body." Here the Apostle makes baptism to consist chiefly in the spiritual institution of a man into the body of Christ by the Holy Ghost; as if he would give us to understand that, that doth not deserve the name of baptism in which the Spirit doth not engraft us into Christ. Nor doth he note this, as some special privilege in extraordinary, conferred only upon a few; but he manifestly declares it to be the common benefit of all that by election belong to Christ, when he saith, "by one Spirit are we all baptized into one body."

This is true, Calvin saith on the place of all the faithful, "for however unto many, baptism is but a symbol without any further effect: yet the faithful do, together with the outward sacrament, receive the thing represented thereby. And therefore in respect of God it is always true that baptism is an incision into Christ: because God doth not represent anything but what he is ready to fulfill, if we be capable thereof." Now that infants are capable of it, he proves in his commentary on the 7th chapter of this same epistle; where he shows that the children of faithful parents are holy, *ex beneficio faederis*; by *virtue* of

[60] Ibid ut supra.

[61] The same author answering to that of Bellar. Baptismus aliquid sacramentale confert, etiamsi deture & non percipiatur fide. Takes upon him to give this answer on behalf of the Protestants, Nihil omnino in terua qaualitatis consert: adultis absq, fide. Colleg. Anti-Bellarm tom.3 Disp.9 thes. 7. And who will not therefore infer a concession of what I contend for, in infants? Why else does he not absolutely deny Bellarmine's proposition, but only limit it?

the covenant. If holy, then, "faithful, although not yet endowed with actual faith," saith Musculus.[62]

Another place to prove that the Scriptures attribute the conferring of, and washing by the Holy Ghost, unto baptism as a principal part of that ordinance, is that in Titus 3:5, where the Apostle speaking of baptism, describes it to be the, "laver of regeneration, and of the renewing of the Holy Ghost:" in which words it is as clear as the sun at noonday, that baptism is not the, "Laver of regeneration" alone, but of the, "renewing of the Holy Ghost," also. So as he that is partaker only of the former, is but half-baptized: that is, he is partaker but of the body of the sacrament, without that which gives life, form and being unto that ordinance. And, to make the baptism of the elect to be no more ordinarily, than a participation of the carcass of Christ's institution, would, I think, be a harsh doctrine even in their own ears that deny the Spirit to elect infants. More soundly Calvin saith,[63] "The Apostles are accustomed even from sacraments to draw arguments to confirm us in assurance of our participation of the things therein signed and sealed to us. For this ought to be an undeniable principle maintained by all the godly, that God doeth not abuse his people with empty signs, but by his power inwardly makes good, by what external signs he represents to us. Wherefore, fitly and truly is baptism styled the, "laver of regeneration." Now, if baptism is fitly and truly invested with this title, because God undoubtedly makes good unto his own, inwardly, that which is externally signified, who will call that baptism, in the language of the Scriptures, that is destitute of inward grace?

I know the shift which is laid hold on, to beat off all these plain and pregnant proofs*: viz.*, "that none of these places speak of baptism with reference to any, but such as bring with them actual faith to lay hold upon the grace of baptism: and that therefore these texts prove nothing touching on the communicating of the Spirit to infants."

Answer: Although I have said enough before to keep oft any intelligent reader from this evasion, yet, for their sakes, who think no

[62] *Omnes Christianorum infantes ad Christum pertinentes, deque numero fidelium existentes, recte dicuntur esse in fide Christi, fideles et credentes, licet nondum sint imbuti fide. Musculus in Matthew 18.*

[63] In locum.

objection sufficiently answered that is not fully removed every time it is urged, I will be content to take the pains of giving a fourfold answer to all this.

1. I answer by denying the proposition objected*: viz*. that all the places before cited speak only of the persons grown and endowed with *actual* faith. This was answer enough until the thing objected is proved, as well as said. For that which is but only affirmed without proof, may be denied without wrong to any. I willingly admit that some places of Scripture speak of faith, and some of repentance, when the speech is of actual sensible apprehension and application of the inward grace of baptism, by an act of the person himself making use of, and receiving comfort sensibly from his baptism.[64] But this doth not prove that the inward grace is never *at all* conferred upon the elect where there is not actual faith to apply the same. This is no more true than those places which require actual faith in all persons of years, on pain of damnation if they are capable of the ordinary means of grace, and admitted to them, proves that not so much as an infant can be saved, without actual faith. An opinion so harsh and rash, as no learned man would willingly be guilty of.
2. I answer that of infants actual faith is not required: for that cannot be justly required, whereof, in the ordinary course, their very infancy makes them altogether incapable. This I have so largely proved in the former chapter, as I should rightly be condemned of tautologizing, if I should stand to repeat all the testimonies before alleged out of Zanchius, Martyr, Chamier, Dr. Ames, Dr. Davenant, and the author of the commentary on Titus, who all confess that in infants it is enough to make them capable of the inward grace in baptism, that they have the Holy Ghost in them instead of faith to apply the same.
3. I answer that if these men will yet so far gratify the Anabaptists as to contend further that elect infants cannot be *capable* of the inward grace of baptism, without faith; infants can, in some sense, be admitted to *have faith*; and so, not incapable of the inward grace

[64] Colossians 2:12; Acts 2:38; 1 Peter 3:21.

of that sacrament. He that said, "whosoever shall offend one of these little ones that believe in me," (Matthew 18) would give us to understand that it is no extraordinary thing for infants that are elected to have in them some degree of faith. This faith is not actual, but potential, initial, and seminal, which is no other than the Spirit of faith communicated, as Zanchius, and Peter Martyr, say as well.

If my words are worth nothing with these men, if none of the worthies before alleged may prevail, let them yet give some credit to Mr. Aynsworth, a man far enough off from popery, and also from conformity to our present Church. He, in his *Censure of a Dialogue of the Anabaptists*, when he comes to their objection against the baptizing of infants, *viz*., that if it cannot be proved that infants have their hearts sprinkled from an evil conscience, have faith, repentance, and they ought not to be baptized; he gives a double answer; 1. That this makes as much against circumcision of old, as against baptizing of infants now. 2. That, "Christian infants have the graces they speak of, repentance, faith, regeneration, though not actually, or by way of declaration to others: yet they have through the work of the Spirit the seed and beginning of faith, virtually, and by way of inclination; so that they are not wholly destitute of faith and regeneration, though it be a thing hidden and unknown to us, after what manner the Lord worketh those in them." This he proves solidly and fully, and among his other arguments is this one: "They to whom God giveth the sign and seal of righteousness by faith, and of regeneration, they have faith and regeneration; for God giveth no lying sign; he sealeth no vain or false covenants. But God gave to infants circumcision, which was the sign and seal of the righteousness of faith and regeneration, (Genesis 17:12, Romans 4:11, 2:28-29, Colossians 2:11), "Therefore infants had (and consequently now have) faith and regeneration, though not in the crop or harvest by declaration, yet in the bud and beginning of all Christian graces." Then mark his, "censure" of such as deny this, "They that deny this reason, must either make God the Author of a lying sign and seal of the covenant to Abraham and his infants, or they must hold that infants had those graces then, but not now: both which are wicked and absurd to affirm. Or they must say that circum-

cision was not the sign and seal of the righteousness which is by faith; and then they openly contradict the Scripture (Rom. 4:11)." And after more full proof, he makes this sharp conclusion, "Wherefore they are but a faithless and crooked generation, that notwithstanding all that God hath spoken and done in this kind, do deny this grace of Christ to the infants of his people, and the seal or confirmation of this grace by baptism now, as it was by circumcision of old." Thus he pressed here the Anabaptists, whom it is not possible otherwise to shake off.

4. Lastly, I answer by retorting the argument on those that make it. The same necessity which lies on an infant to have actual faith, so he can partake of the Spirit of regeneration by his baptism, will also be as strong to exclude him from participation of the outward sign. For, baptismal washing is (at least) significant and obsignant too, sealing to the party baptized the inward grace signified and exhibited, by their own confession that quarrel against me for this position of baptismal regeneration. And if so, what should an infant do with this honorable mystery and sacred ordinance, he being not able to put any difference between baptismal washing by the minister, and ordinary washing of his face at home by his nurse? Now then, if his present incapacity doth not hinder his partaking of the outward element, which yet, in the ordinary course of dispensation, requires faith to discern the use and mystery of this divine institution, as well as to apply the inward grace by it signified, what should hinder but that an infant belonging to the election of grace should partake initially of the grace of the sacrament, by the Spirit which is in him instead of actual faith? Deny him this, and deny him the sacrament itself.

By all this I hope it is now evident out of the Scripture itself, that either elect infants do ordinarily partake of the Spirit, in baptism, or else they do not receive the whole baptism, but only a piece, if we consider this ordinance, as the Scripture doth; *viz*., not only as an outward sign, but as that which ever is accompanied with the inward grace to all that are elected.

My other arguments drawn from divine testimony are two: and both taken from two distinct uses of baptism, which now follow in order.

The next argument:

Major: That which was ordained to be the laver of spiritual regeneration and renovation unto all that are saved by it, must necessarily contain in it the donation of the Spirit, by which this work may be done.

Minor: But baptism was ordained unto this end, that it should be the laver of regeneration and of the renewing of the Holy Ghost unto all that partake of it, and are saved, ordinarily.

Conclusion: Therefore, baptism (taken as the Scripture takes it, for all that which, in baptism, is usually given to the elect) contains in it, ordinarily the conferring of the Spirit to all the elect that partake of it.

The major is undeniable; unless we will maintain that the effect may be produced without its proper cause. For how can baptism wash and renew a man spiritually, without conferring the Spirit? This is as if I should grant a man to speak, yet deny him to have a tongue; or, to admit him to act, and move rationally, and yet not yield him to have a reasonable soul. This proposition therefore I take for granted.

The minor is expressed in Scripture, "Of his mercy he saved us, by the laver of regeneration and of the renewing of the Holy Ghost, which he shed on us abundantly through Jesus Christ our Savior," (Titus 3:5). Therefore the conclusion is sound.[65]

But you will perhaps make an exception and say that the Apostle speaks here of actual regeneration, which, by my former distinction and foundation, cannot agree to infants?

Answer: That he speaks of regeneration, the text itself will clear it. That he speaks *only* of actual regeneration worked by the Word is not apparent; yea, no circumstance of the text will warrant any man so to restrain it. The text tells us that baptism is the, "Laver of regeneration," but that it is only to actual believers such, what words will bear such an exposition? But to make all sure, let us hear what judicious Calvin, and other of the learned speak of the true meaning of

[65] This place was alleged in the former argument, but to another purpose: there to prove the Spirit of regeneration to be one main branch of whole baptism; here it is to declare the end of baptism, in respect of regeneration.

this place: so that in the mouths of two or three witnesses every word may be established.

1. Mr. Calvin, in his answer to the Anabaptists, who deny baptism to infants on pretense of their incapacity of the end of baptism, in other words, *regeneration*, until they are able to make use of the Word, brings them in this way objecting, "But how are infants regenerated in baptism, they being not capable of so much as any knowledge either of good or evil?" "To this," he saith, "we answer, that this is the secret work of God, which, although to us it is not evident, yet we may not say, that therefore it is none at all."[66] Now, if he did not mean this of what God ordinarily works in and at baptism, it would be no answer to their objection which lies only against all present efficacy of baptism, in the ordinary course, in and on infants.

The same author, prosecuting the same business to that objection which they further make, *viz*., that, "circumcision, and therefore baptism, is the sacrament of repentance and faith." He saith it this way,

> "Although infants, in the moment of their circumcision, were not able to comprehend what that sign meant, they were yet truly circumcised for the mortification of their corrupt and defiled nature, which, after they came to years, they meditated on. In a word, this objection is easily answered: they are baptized unto future repentance and faith, which graces although they are not formed (actually) yet by the secret operation of the Spirit the seeds of both lie ye in them. By this answer, is at once overthrown whatever these men object against us from the signification of baptism such as that, for example, where Paul calls baptism the laver of regeneration and renewing by the Holy Ghost, from whence they would conclude that this sacrament is to be administered unto none, but to such as are capable of those graces."[67]

[66] *At quomodo inquiunt regenerantur insantes, aec beninec mali cognitione praediti, nos autem respondemus, opus Dei etiam si captui nostro non subiaccat, non tamen esse nullum Instit. lib.4 cap.16 sect.17.*

[67] *Elsi infantes, quo circumcide bantur momento, quid sibi vellet lignum illud intelligentia non comprehendebant; veretamen circumci debantur in nature sue corrupta, as co taminatae, mortificationem, quam adulti postra meditarentur. Deniq nullo negotio solui potest objectio bec, baptizari in futuram paenitentiam & fidem: qua elsi non dum in illis formalae sunt, areana tamen spiri-*

So then Calvin, you see, avouches infants to be *partakers* of regeneration in baptism, although not actual, yet seminal and initial; and that from this very place of the Apostle.

2. Zanchius, in his confessions, affirms that not only those of years, but infants also, "if they do truly and indeed belong to the covenant," are, in baptism so sealed, as those that, "even now are incorporated by the Holy Ghost into Christ," and that therefore among other titles given unto baptism, in Scripture, it is called the, "laver of regeneration."[68]

3. Peter Martyr expounds this place not only of that which is conferred on persons of years endued with actual faith, but even on elect infants, by virtue of the Holy Ghost supplying in them the room of faith. I pointed out this place before; yet because he speaks so fully to this purpose, I will repeat the same idea again. This author, having declared himself about the efficacy of baptism, with it shows that we ought to understand that in persons of years, faith is so required that without faith they neither receive the seal of justification, nor yet of sanctification, in their baptism. This is also true of Augustine as well; the efficacy of baptism is indeed from the word of institution, yet not as it is pronounced by the minister, but as it is believed by the receiver. But what benefit then can baptism (may some say) bring to *infants* who cannot actually believe? This, our author wisely and roundly prevents, by adding, that, "in infants who by reason of their tender years cannot believe, the Holy

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tus operatione utruisq, semen in illis later. Hae responsione semel evertitur quic quid adversum nos torquent a baptismi significatione petitum: Quale estrelogium quoa Paulo insignitur, ubi vocat laverum regenertionis & renovationis; unde ratiocinantur nemini nisi earum rerum capaci conferendum. Iden, ibid: sect.20.

[68] *Baptismus Primum Novi Faederis sacramentum est quo cum omnes, qui vel penitentiam peccatorum professi, fidem etiam in Christum, adeoque in deum patrem, creduntur. 1 Corinthians 7:14, tum maxime illi qui vere ad faedus pertinent, Christo tanquam ei iam per spiritum sanctum incorporati obsignantur: ut non sint amplius sui turis, sedidius, per quem in faederis societatem, eaq, in unum corpus cum eo sanctis que omnibus, & omnium spiritualium caelestiving, bonorum participationem, asciti esse dicuntur. Acts 19:5, 1 Corinthians 6:19. Per hunc baptismum, tanquam lavacrum regenerationis, a peccatis vi sanguinis Christi, mundati, & cum Christo consepulis in mortem. ut quamadmoduin ille resurrexit a mortuis per gloriam patris, sic & nos in novitate vitae ambulemus, unde & sacramentum penitenti in remissionem peccatorum, sacramentum fidei, symbolum faderis, Lavacrum regenerationis, appellari consuevit lib. confess. cap. de. Cap. de bap. sect.1.*

Ghost supplies *the room of faith*."[69] And, to assure us that such infants have the Spirit, he quoteth this very place of our Apostle to Titus, saying, "The effusion of the Holy Ghost also is promised in baptism, as the Apostle expressly writes to Titus, (where he saith) who saved us by the laver of regeneration, and of the renewing of the Holy Ghost, which he shed on us abundantly by Jesus Christ our Savior."[70] Lastly, the author of the commentary on Titus as hath been already declared at large in our former chapter, also expresses this, that not only persons actually believing, but even elect infants also ordinarily receive, in the right use of baptism, the inward grace. And this he speaks as grounded on this very text, unless we will say that he forgot his text, when he spoke it; which to impute to him, were, in my apprehension, a wronging of him.

Wherefore I conclude this argument in this way. If the judgment of Calvin, Zanchius, Peter Martyr, and the author of our English commentary on Titus, are found in exposition of this Scripture, it proves the ordinary communication of the Spirit of regeneration as well to infants who are elect, as well as to persons of years that actually believe. This is the substance of our main position.

Argument 3: My third and last argument is drawn from another use of baptism; in their words, our institution and incorporation into Christ. I frame it in this way:

Major: That which baptizes elect infants into the death of Christ, and initially incorporateth them into the true mystical body of Christ, in their baptism, must needs be ordinarily communicated to them in that ordinance.

Minor: But it is the Spirit of Christ that doth this.

Conclusion: Therefore the Spirit of Christ, according to Scripture, is ordinarily given to the elect in baptism.

The major is confirmed thus. The elect are baptized into Christ's death, when they are baptized outwardly and sacramentally; therefore they must needs then receive that by which this is done. The antecedent is expressed in Scripture, "Know ye not that so many of us as

[69] Loc. com. Clas. 4 cap.8 sect.2. See our former chapter where the author's own words are quoted.

[70] Vide etiam, Bucer de vi effic. bapt. inter opera Anglic, page 597.

were baptized into Christ, were baptized into his death? Therefore we are buried with him in baptism into death," (Romans 6:3 -4). What is this to infants? Some may say, "Yes," Saint Augustine saith,[71] "it doth pertain even to infants also, when it is said we are buried with him by baptism into death." And learned Danaeus, commenting on that passage of Augustine, defends him in it, if it is restrained to the elect, and understood only of *initial regeneration.*

And doth Calvin set more narrow bounds unto this text? Calvin doth not say, as some do, that the Apostle wrote in this way because they were *actual* believers to whom he writes. But, he affirms it to be from the very *institution* itself, the common benefit of all of us that are now baptized; although he could not but know and remember that we were not baptized at man's estate, but in our infancy. His words are these, "It is a true thing, out of all controversy, that we put on Christ in baptism,[72] and were baptized upon this very ground, that we should be one with him."[73] Do we think that Calvin was asleep when he wrote this, or rather those that deny it are in a dream? Let no man tell me that he and all the authors I have named or can name, more often speak against this very position, than for it; and that it is easy to produce them, in more than a hundred places, avouching this expressly, that the sacraments do not profit a man except the one that hath faith to apply the grace offered in them. So Calvin himself speaks plainly, in that very place, besides sundry other passages that he hath elsewhere to this very purpose touching the efficacy of baptism.

I am not either so ignorant, as these men would make me, in the authors I quote; nor yet so impious as to corrupt my authors in such manner, as some insinuate. It is very true that Calvin[74] and other reverend divines often require faith as the hand of the soul, to apply unto the believer the grace offered in the sacraments. But is it not also as true, that both Calvin and the rest have also written all that which

[71] *Ac per hoc etiam ad ipsos (nempe parvulos) pertinet quod sequitur, dicens consepulti illi sumus per baptismum in mortem, Aug. Enchirid. cap. 52*

[72] *Ergo & sidem & regenerationem habent parvuli electi Dei, etsi nondum illius opera nobis apparent: & eadona habene proratione etatis, (i.) pro capacitate vasis. Lamb. Dan. in Augustin. Euch. ibid*

[73] *Extra controversiam induere nos Christum in baptismo & hac lege nos baptiza ri, ut unum cum ipso simis Calvin in his Commentary on Romans 6.*

[74] *Instit. lib.4 cap.14 & 15. nec non in commentaris eius super sanct. script. passim.*

I have alleged out of them? If not, then let me bear the blame forever. If so, why do men complain that I wrong my authors? If I quote a passage out of Bellarmine against the popish tenet in any particular, will any man conclude that I have wronged him because they are able to show that Bellarmine himself writes quite the contrary in some other parts of his works? If I find an author speaking for me, I cannot be justly taxed of falsifying him, although he speaks never so directly against me in another place; unless it appears that he retracted the first, and professeth an alteration of his judgment. So then these quick and great read men are too hasty in their sentence that I have wronged my authors, although I had no other plea in bar, but only this.

However, that I may give them a little further satisfaction than they deserve, know all men by these presents, that forasmuch as Calvin and the rest acknowledge a present efficacy of baptism in infants elected although they do not actually believe, and forasmuch also as these authors have never recanted such their judgment of those infants, their other speeches which require actual faith, must of necessity be understood with limitation and reference only to such as are of years;[75] forasmuch as none of these can have any actual comfort and sensible evidence of the inward grace conferred upon him in his baptism, nor be actually a partaker thereof on his own part without actual faith to apprehend and apply the same. So, Chamier accurately expresses himself in treating of this very argument; sometimes he affirms justification and regeneration to be conferred in baptism.[76] Yet in some places seems to deny either justification or sanctification to be given to any, till they come of age and believe.[77] However, the clear expression of his meaning purges him from the guilt of contradiction, and preserves his reader from stumbling and mistaking. For, in one place for all, he shows what he means by that sanctification and justi-

[75] So Calvin in Matthew 19:14. *Talium est renum Dei, thus writeth against the Anabaptists caudl Quod autem non aliter reconciliari ros Deo & adoptionis here des fieri comendunt quam fie hoc de adultis fatemura sed quod ad i fantes attinet salsion esse convincit hic locus.* Whereas they contend that we are only by faith reconciled to God, and made heirs of adoption: we acknowledge it to be true of persons of years, but that it is fall in the case of infants in this very place of our Savior commendeth, because it saith that even

[76] Lib.5 de sacram. cap.4 par.8-10

[77] Lib.2 de sacram. cap.7 par.24-25

fication to such as are of years, that, in the moment of the baptism of infants it is not conferred, *viz*., 1. Not any justification or sanctification at all, by any physical efficacy in the external sacrament, either in or after its administration. 2. Neither the sense of justification, nor yet sanctification, as it imports an actual change. By the former he means that by which actually a man applies that justification unto himself, which is properly not in us, but in God. This sense can be in none but such as are of years. By sanctification he understands, "an actual change both of the understanding and will from falsehood to truth, from evil to good."[78] This is that which he denies to be ordinarily communicated to infants, so did Calvin, and so do I.[79]

But lest any should imagine that I cunningly play the lapwing in carrying away my reader from the objection made against me out of Calvin, with telling him a fair tale out of Chamier, I will return to Calvin again, and make good what exposition I formerly have of such passages as may be urged against me out of Calvin, or others; and that by Calvin himself.

This learned man, having largely confuted the blind error of the Anabaptists that furiously deny the baptism of infants, shows also that however he admits of some present efficacy of baptism even in and on them, his meaning is not that they ordinarily partake of actual regeneration in that ordinance, unless they such as die in their infancy. For thus he explicates himself in this particular, "Whom God grants to elect, if after they have received the sacrament of baptism they die before they come to years, them he doth renew by the power of his Spirit, and this is something incomprehensible to us, as it seems best to himself. But if they live to years of discretion, whereby they may be instructed touching the truth of their baptism, they are then

[78] *Apello autem justificationis sensum, eum per quem actu nobis applicatur justificatio illa, que proprie est extra not, and in Deo: qui sensus non est nisi in adultis, and judicio ulentibus. Sanctificationem vero notum est significare actualem immutationem tum intellectus tum voluntatis, a falso inverum, a malo in bonum. Cham. ibid. lib.2 cap.7 par.12*

[79] *Fatemur ergo baptismum pro cotempore (id est, aute fidem) non profuisse nobis hilum, quando in eo nobis oblata promissio, sine qua baptismus nihil est, neglecta jacebat instit.* lib.4 cap.15 sect.17. And in sect. 15 of the same chapter. *Exboc sacramento, quemadmodum ex aliis omnibus, nihil assequimur nisi quantum side accipimus.* In all this he speaks of actual application and sensible evidence on the part of the reciever, or else he must necessarily be held as a contradictor of himself in all sixteen chapters of his work.

thereby the more provoked to the study of newness of life, the impression of whereof they then come to learn that they were endowed with from their very infancy, by which they ought more seriously to meditate on the same all the days of their life. And hither is to be referred that which Paul teacheth touching our burial with Christ by baptism, in those two places, (Romans 6:4, Colossians 2:12) for there the Apostle meant not to show that it is necessary for him that is to be baptized, to be thus buried with Christ beforehand, but what simply baptism effects in and in those that are now baptized."[80] By this all men may perceive that however he affirms that vigor and life of this sacrament cannot be sensibly applied on the part of the receiver, by any but by persons of years that have actual faith, yet he admits of some initial work of the Spirit even upon infants, if they belong to the election of grace. The same may be said of all other modern divines that require actual faith for the application of the inward grace of baptism, on the part of the receiver. In this way much may be spoken to this so often iterated objection, by which so many think to strip me at once of all those testimonies of Calvin, or others whom I have produced. And so much also the major proposition of my present syllogism.

The minor proposition was this: It is the Spirit that in this way incorporates us into Christ. This is evident in the express words of Saint Paul, "For by one Spirit are we all baptized into one body," (1 Corinthians 12:13). On these words the learned Morton writes this,

[80] *Quos electione sua dignatus est Dominus, si accepto regenerationis signo, praesenti vita ante demigrent quam adoleverint, eos virtute sui spiritus nobis incomprehensa renovat, quomodo expedire solus ipse providet. Si grandescere in aetatem contingat, qua baptismi veritatem edoceri queant, hinc magis ad renovationis studium accendentur, cuius tessera se a prima statim infantia donatos esse discent, quo eam toto vitae decursu meditarentur. Eodem referatur quod duobus locis Paulus docet, nos Christo per baptismum consepeliri* (Rom. 6:4; Col. 2:12): *nam eo non intelligit consepultum Christo iam prius eum esse oportere qui baptismo sit initiandus: sed quae baptismo subest doctrina simpliciter declarat; idque iam baptizatis. Instit. lib. 4, cap. 16, sect. 21.* If any shall quarrel the translation of the word *tessera* (which is rendered properly enough), let them know that Calvin meant more by it than only an outward badge or sign, as appears by what he had spoken in the very next section before, viz.: *Baptizari in futuram paenitentiam et fidem* (infantes dicit) *quae etsi nondum formatae sunt, arcana tamen spiritus operatione utriusque semen in illis latet.* In English thus: They (viz., infants) be baptized unto future repentance and faith, which graces although they be not yet formed, yet by the secret operation of the Spirit the seed of them both lies hid within them. So in cap. 15.1: *Proinde quibus visum est baptismum non aliud esse quam tesseram ac notam qua religionem nostram apud homines profitemur, quo modo imperatoris sui insignia praeferunt milites, in suae professionis notam; ii quod primum erat in baptismo non perpenderunt.*

"Why doth not the Apostle simply say that, by one Spirit we are made one spiritual body: but rather thus, we are baptized into one body? Certainly that he might show that a man is then incorporated into the Church in the beginning of his conversion and regeneration; at what time Christ communicating his Spirit to him, makes him a member of the invisible Church, as the Minister in the administration of baptism admits and engrafts him into the body of the Church visible."[81]

If it is answered, that all this may be granted, and yet the main point still denied: because the Spirit may be given to the elect, not at the moment of baptism, but at their effectual calling by the Word: I reply; then, between the time of baptism and effectual calling outwardly by the word, baptism is but a bare sign, to such as live to years. But this is confessed by all sound divines to be a mere fancy derogatory to Christ's institution, and is condemned in the Sacramentarians as Marlorat on Ephesians 5:26 saw. He therefore saith, "that therefore the Apostle teacheth that in baptism we are washed, because there God doth both testify our ablution, and also effect what he represents. For unless the truth of the thing were joined with the outward sign, it were improper to call baptism the laver of the soul."[82] And in that very place, saith Calvin, "Paul comprehends the whole Church of Christ, no less than where he saith in another place[83] that 'by baptism we are engrafted into the body of Christ:' so as from both, we collect that infants, whom Christ reckons among the rest of his members, are to be baptized, lest they should be torn from his body."[84]

If yet they answer that this doth not follow by their doctrine*: viz.*, that baptism is a bare sign; because they grant it to be also a seal of it after grace: I rejoice: this doth not help (unless they grant, as Calvin

[81] *Quare non simp iciter dicit per unum spiritum fimus unu spirituale corpus; sed potius, baptizamur in unum corpus? Certe ut ostenderet hominem in Ecclesiam incorporari in initio conversionis & regenerationis suae: quo tempore Christus spiritum suum communicant, eum invisiblilis Ecclesia membrum facit, ut minister baptismi administratione eum in visibilis Ecclesiae corpus admittit & inserit. Morton in locum.*

[82] *Quod baptismo nosablui docet Apostolus, ideo est quod illic ablurionem nostram testatur Deum & simul efficit quod figurat. Nisienim conjuncta esset rei veritas & exhibitio, impropria hec esse locutio, baptismus est lavacrum anime. Marlorat in his commentary on Ephesians 5.*

[83] 1 Corinthians 12:13.

[84] *Universam enim Ecclesiam complectuur Paulus, ubi dicit mundatam lavacro aque. Nihilo secius & ex eo quod ahbi dicit, nos in Christi corpus per baptismum esse infertos, colligimut, infantes, quos mebris suis annumerat, haptizandos esse, ne a suao corpore divessantur. hist. lib.4 cap. 16, sect.22.*

freely doth some principle and seed of grace bestowed, ordinarily, in baptism) because by their opinion it is a seal of something absent that is to be expected in reversion only. They deny all present exhibition and collation of any grace in the moment of baptism, by virtue of Christ's institution; and so they do not make it a sign signifying but rather prognosticating only some future effect: which is a new kind of divinity, that, so far as I am able to judge, destroys the nature of a sacrament, by denying to it both the chief part of it, *viz.*, the inward grace thereby signified and together with the sign exhibited and conferred on those that truly and indeed be within the covenant; as also the vigor and efficacy of the Word of institution which makes the union between the sign and the thing signified; and lastly this spoils elect infants of the inward seal; in other words, the Spirit of Christ, which incorporates them into Christ as members of his body. Were not such possessed with too much prejudice, they would not so easily leap over all these material arguments, but be more sober in their censures and wary in their doctrines. I do not deny the future efficacy of baptism after the act of administration; but I only plead for some efficacy of it when it is administered. In a word, I will conclude this matter in the very terms of Calvin before quoted, "Infants are baptized unto future repentance and faith; which graces although they are not yet formed in them; yet, by the secret operation of the Spirit the seeds of them both lie hid within them."[85]

I see, I think, some ready to wrangle further, and to object to me after this manner, "Some places have been alleged indeed to prove that in baptism the Spirit is given to the faithful. But yet we do not hear of one text that saith directly and expressly that elect infants then receive the Spirit."

To this I answer, that when any of you will show me any express text of Scripture that in direct terms mentions the baptizing of infants, I will also show you an expressed text to prove their reception of the Spirit in baptism. But if you cannot do the one (nor is it much material, so long as there is such solid ground in the Scriptures, and such undoubted arguments may be thence drawn to prove the lawfulness and necessary use of paedobaptism) what equity is it to require of me

[85] Ibid ut supra Instit. lib.4 cap.16 sect.20.

the other? How is it possible to show an expressed text proving that infants receive the Spirit in baptism, when no text is found that mentions their baptism? If in the judgment of all the Churches of Christ, it is sufficient (as indeed it is) to confute all the Anabaptists in the world, that infants are within the covenant, and therefore ought not to be debarred of the seal of it, no more than infants of old were debarred of circumcision by reason of their inability and incapacity to understand that mystery, that to them belongs the kingdom of heaven, and therefore the admittance into it must be yielded to them, that they are a part of Christ's Church, yea of his body. Lastly, that although they do not have actual faith, yet they have the Spirit of faith to apply unto them the grace of baptism, *if God so pleases*. Therefore in all these respects they may be baptized, notwithstanding that no text of Scripture enjoins it in so many words. Then this also ought to satisfy all ingenuous and moderate men that by like sound and necessary consequences I have from the Scriptures made good this point in hand. The places alleged I have seriously weighed, and found them all clear for the proof of my conclusion. Nor have I been my own judge, or expounded them out of my own head, but taken such expositions as the most learned, judicious, reverend, and eminent divines of this last age, as well as others of less note had set upon them, long before I meddled with them, lest any man should say that I take on me these things simply to coin expositions of my own, that might look favorably upon that which is taken to be my own cause.

One thing remains for me to cover here that in a word must be dispatched. There are some I know, who will like well enough the allegations of Scripture brought to prove that the elect, that *all* the elect receive the Spirit in baptism. But with it they find fault at restraining those Scriptures to only the elect. For they will have it in this way, that the Scriptures are clear to prove that all that are baptized do receive the Spirit in baptism, as well as the elect.

To this I briefly say thus much. The Scriptures do not warrant any such extent of baptismal grace. It plainly teaches the contrary. For what do these men make of that place in Romans 8:30, "Whom he did predestinate them he also called, and whom he called, them he also justified, and whom he justified, them he also glorified?" The

Apostle restrains justification and effectual calling to those that are predestinated, to what? To grace only? No, to *glory*, saith the text expressly.

The ground of these men's mistake is this, that they think the efficacy of baptism depends so certainly and universally on the institution, that where there is no willful actual opposition in the party baptized, he cannot miss of the effect. In other words, he cannot miss out on the Spirit of grace if there is no opposition to being baptized. But they must know that however by virtue of the institution, we may assure ourselves that the elect partake of the inward grace yet it is not the *institution* alone, but God's[86] *preordination* of them to grace and glory, that makes the sacrament effectual on them, and not upon others. We admit the word, in its kind, to have efficacy to beget faith as an instrument in the hand of the Spirit. Yet the Spirit doth not beget faith in all. Why? Because they *resist*? That may be true, but why doth it work faith in others? Chiefly, because they are *elected* to eternal life. So saith the Scripture, "as many as were ordained to eternal life believed," (Acts 13:48). Doth Saint Luke in that place think we mean something other than this*; that they and only they that were elected, did believe.*

Lastly, do but consider one more plain place, it is in Galatians 4:6, "Because ye are sons, God hath sent forth the Spirit of his Son into your hearts, crying, Abba, Father." He doth not say, because they *had* received the sacrament of baptism, which yet they had done; nor yet, because they did believe, which to no doubt many of them did, but, "because ye are *sons*." Now this sonship did not depend on the sacrament, or any ordinance of Christ; no nor yet upon their faith and inward grace; but upon the eternal decree of God's free election. "According as he hath chosen us in him before the foundation of the world, that we should be holy and without blame before him in love: Having predestinated us unto the adoption of children by Jesus Christ to himself, according to the good pleasure of his will," (Eph. 1:4-5). So we have ended this section in proving this point by the Holy Scriptures.

[86] See afterwards in chapter 6 and 7, the judgments of Calvin, Junius, Dr. Jewel, and Dr. Whitaker.

CHAPTER V. The Judgment of the Fathers in This Point.

I have now come to the third part of my task, which is to prove that this hath been the judgment and doctrine of the chief and best approved fathers of the primitive Church. In this, I will enforce myself to all possible brevity, contenting myself with a few instances, lest the work grow too *large* and *tedious* to the reader. And that I may be as good as my word, I will mention only such as lived within the first 500 years after Christ, because those that came after *may* be liable to challenge.

1. Then, to begin with Cyprian, that eminent doctor and famous martyr, who is described by Gregory Nazianzen, the, "chief and most approved pastor of his time," and is a principal light. He was a light not only to the Churches of Carthage and Africa; but his fame and admiration spread itself throughout the whole Christian world.[87] He, in his epistle *ad Pompeium De Haeret. Baptizandis*, gives this for a reason why such were to be rebaptized as were baptized by heretics cast out of the Church*; viz*. because there is no presence of the Spirit among such as are not of the Church of Christ; and therefore their baptism is not sufficient. His words are these, "Wherefore, let them grant that, either the Spirit is present where they say true baptism is; or, that it is no true baptism, where the Spirit is not: because baptism cannot be without the Spirit."[88] It is true that out of his zeal against heretics of that time, who grossly erred in pain fundamentals, he was over vehement against baptism administered by such as the Church had then ejected out of her society; because he thence inferred a necessity of *rebaptism* of all such as were so baptized by such heretics. Yet all the allegations reach home to our present purpose, in that this shows his judgment to be clearly *for* this truth*, that the Spirit is ordinarily communicated in baptism*. Here he afterwards infers in the same epistle;

[87] Gregory Nazianzen in laudem Cyprian. Pastorum optimus and probatissimus.

[88] *Quare aut et spiritum esse concedant illic, ubi baptisma esse dicunt, aut nec baptisma esse, ubi spiritus non est, quia baptisma esse sine spiritu non potest.*

"The nativity of Christians is in their baptism."[89] And to make it evident that he understood this to be the ordinary effect of baptism, even upon infants, he elsewhere expressly declares himself. For, in his epistle *ad Fidum de Infant Baptiz.*, he useth this as an argument proving the lawfulness of baptizing infants. He saith that the Spirit doth not refuse to communicate himself even to them. The Holy Scripture, he saith, declares that divine grace is dispensed unto all, as well to infants as others, which was a type in Elisha's stretching himself on an infant insensible of the good which the Prophet did unto him.[90] By which it is manifest that, had Cyprian not believed that the Spirit communicates himself to infants in their baptism, he would scarce have allowed them to be baptized; forasmuch as this is the chief ground that he builds upon, to justify their admittance unto the same. If any shall except against what is urged out of this last epistle, as being no other than a heterodox opinion, Goulartius will defend it, if it is restrained to the elect; and Chamier justifies Goulartius in that assertion.[91]

2. Gregory Nazianzen calls baptism, "That good thing which gives us initiation into Christ; which common benefit and foundation of new life we all receive from God."[92] In his oration or homily *touching on baptism*, after a large and eloquent narration of the efficacy of baptism, he saith that it hath force even on infants also, and therefore would have them baptized on this ground, that he takes it for granted, that they also are, in some degree, sanctified even in baptism. Witness his speech, "It is better that they be sanctified without any apprehension of the thing done, than that they should depart this life without baptism and initiation. And of this thing circumcision may afford us precedent: for, that being the

[89] Nativitas Christi morum in baptismo est.

[90] *Esse deniq apud omnes. Sive infantes, sive majores matis unam divina muneris equalitatem declarat nobis Scripturae divinae fides, cum helisaeus super infantem vidue filium qui mortuus jacebat, ita se Deum deprecans super stravit, ut capiti caput, and facici facies adplicaretur, & superfusi helisaei membra singulis parvuli membris, & pedes pedibus jungerentur.*

[91] *Et vere Goulartius, in hunc ipsum notavit locum, Quaecunque profert hac epistola Cyprianus noster de S. Baptismi in electis Christi variis effectis ut orthodoxe & ad fidei analogiam scriptum amplectimur. Cham. de Sacram. lib. 2, cap. 6, parag. 38.*

[92] *Initiationis divinae bonum, quod commune beneficium, & secundae vitae fundamentum a Deo omnes habemus.* Greg. *in laud. Gorgo.*

forerunner of baptism, was administered unto such as could not by the use of reason discern what it meant."[93] Here I do not urge to prove the necessity of baptism, as if without reception of it that it is impossible for infants to be saved. I make no doubt that in the time of the law many infants were saved that died before the eighth day wherein they were to be circumcised. But I make use here only to show what Gregory believed and taught touching on that which is ordinarily communicated in baptism, even to infants, as well as others, supposing them to be admitted to it.

3. The great Athanasius, who, in his time was the chief, and in manner, the only professed champion when the truth had left her and (as Jerome complains) the whole world *seemed* to be turned to the heretic Arius. Athanasius, by the sentence of all divines, was a most approved doctor, as Vigilius[94] the Martyr describes him. He, in his *Book of Questions* dedicated to Antiochus, Question 2, propounds this question, "hence may a man know plainly that he hath been baptized and received the Spirit in baptism, seeing he was but an infant when he was baptized?" The answer he gives to this, "As a woman with child by the springing of the babe in her womb, knows for certain that she hath conceived fruit: so the soul of a true Christian knows, not by the reports of his parents, but by the springings of his heart, (especially upon those solemn days in which baptism, and the Lord's Supper are administered) and by the inward joys that then he conceives, that he received the Holy Ghost when he was baptized." This testimony is so clear and full that I do not know what can be said to evade it. He speaks indefinitely, therefore he excludes none that are truly Christians. But to them he restrains it in expressed terms, and so he speaks directly to our present point.

4. Chrysostom, one of the best and clearest expositors of the New Testament, among all the Fathers; calls baptism our, "initiation into Christ."[96] And to let us see that he means it not of an outward ad-

[93] Edit. Graecolat. Billii, Paris, 1609. *Praestat absque sensu sanctificari, quam sine sigillo et initiatione abscedere. Atque huius rei ratio nobis est circumcisio, die octavo pagi solita, quae baptismi figuram quodammodo gerebat atque iis qui rationis adhuc expertes erant offerebatur.*

[94] Omnium ecclesiasticorum virorum judicio probatissimus. Vigil. cont. eutich. l.2 c.4

[96] Hom. 1, in Acts.

mission only into the visible Church, he afterwards declares himself, when he makes the Spirit to be the chief part of baptism, as if there were no baptism worth that name, which is not accompanied with the presence of the Spirit to make it efficacious, "In baptism the chief part is the Spirit, by which the water becomes effectual."[97] If any shall say that this doth not prove that the Spirit always accompanies the outward washing; but rather the contrary, because Chrysostom speaks this of the Apostles that had been baptized, and yet were commanded by Christ after his resurrection to stay at Jerusalem in expectation of the Holy Ghost; saying, "Ye shall be baptized with the Holy Ghost not many days hence," (Acts 1:5). I answer, that Chrysostom admits that in them the case was such indeed. But, he saith, *"both* are performed together."[98] I do not stand to justify his exposition of the place in respect of what he saith touching on the bestowing of the Holy Ghost upon the Apostles, as if they did not receive the Spirit in some measure before that time. Let that opinion shift for itself as it can. I only urge the words to show his judgment of this present point, that now we Christians receive the Spirit in baptism as well as the outward sign.[99] And lest any should imagine him to be so gross as to think that all that partake of the outward washing receive the inward grace, hear him afterwards in the same Homily expressing his grief for the contrary, "What anguish of heart, do I sustain so often as I see some, even when they are ready to breathe their last, run unto baptism, and yet are never a whit the more purged by it."[100] This Father therefore did not hold that all that are baptized do partake of the Spirit in baptism, however his judgment was clear for it, in the ordinary course of divine dispensation. Nor let any Arminian think to make me tardy, as if I abused the reader

[97] Hom. 40, in Acts.

[98] Aom. 1 in Aci

[99] That this was his judgment even of infants also, appears in his Homily on Psalm 14 (i) 15. juxta Heb. *aduucit quispiam infantem adhuc ubera sugentem, ut baptizetur, & statim Sacerdos exigit ab infirma atate pocta conventa & assensiones, & minoris atate acipit susceptorem & interegat. Renunciat Satanae, & non dicit in sinem: vel etam Christio conungitur in sinesed statim in principio vita petit renunciationes & conjunctiones.*

[100] *Eduio Savil. Ibid. Quos estus pectoris sentio, quoties alios video subextremum halitures festinantes ad initiationem, nec hinc fieri puriores. Ibid. prope fin edit. Lat.*

by alleging that which my author speaks concerning persons of years (who do oftentimes *ponere obicem*, actually oppose the Spirit of grace even while they are present at the means of grace) in order to prove the same in the case of infants. For however it is too true that persons of years oftentimes resist the Spirit by a wicked heart and corrupt life; yet this Father speaks of men of another disposition. He speaks of men even at the point of death, apprehending a necessity of remission of sin by Christ, and, "hastening to initiation,"[101] which argues an earnest desire after the grace of baptism; and yet they do away without it. Therefore, they of whom he speaketh are not such as resist the Spirit when they are baptized: and so, the words are pertinent unto my purpose.

5. Basil, to that question, "How Christians are saved?" Gives this answer, "By being regenerated by the grace received at baptism."[102] And a little after, "Baptism is unto me the beginning of life and the day of regeneration is the beginning of duties, in that respect."[103] In another place, speaking of baptism, he saith that it is, "the death of sin, the new birth of the soul,"[104] and I will not add more out of him. This may suffice.

6. Jerome, in his third book of dialogues against the Pelagians, brings in the Pelagian in this way cavilling with the orthodox, "I pray thee tell me, why are infants baptized?" To which he gives this answer; "that in baptism their sins might be remitted."[105] And in the conclusion of that book, that he might at once hiss that absurd distinction of the Pelagians (that children are baptized not for remission of sin, but to make them partakers of the kingdom of heaven) out of the Church. In this way he also speaks of the orthodox person to the Pelagians.[106] "That I may at length put an

[101] Festimantes adinitiationem. *Ibid.*

[102] De Spir. Sanct. c.10

[103] Ibid.

[104] Conc: exhort. ad sanct. bapt.

[105] Dic queso, & me omni ibera questione, quoare infantult baptizentur? Orthod. *ut iis pectata in baptismate dimitantur.* And so much the author of The Perpetuity of the regenerate man's estate, acknowledges and professes, page 456, edit 2.

[106] *Hoc unum dicam, ut tandem finiatur oratio: aut novum vos* (Pelagiani nempe) *debere symbolum tradere, ut post Patrem, Filium et Spiritum Sanctum, baptizetis infantes in regnum caelo-*

end to this discourse, I will say but this one thing: either you must forge a new creed, and after that form of baptism, I baptize thee in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost, add this, that you may partake of the kingdom of heaven; or, if you believe that there is but one baptism of persons of years and of infants, you must hold that infants also are baptized for remission of sin, as well as others." But this cannot be without the Spirit in an infant (then, at least, if not before) communicated to apply the blood of Christ unto him, as the same Father, against the Luciferians,[107] expressly teacheth, "Sins are remitted to none, without the Holy Ghost." And a little before, he saith this, "How can that soul be purged from old sins that hath not the Holy Ghost?" And again, in the same tract, "It is not water that washeth the soul, but the water itself is first sanctified by the Spirit;" not unlike to that speech of Moses in another case, "The Spirit of God moved on the waters," whence it is evident that baptism cannot be without the Spirit. To conclude, "Christ," he saith, "was baptized, and received the Spirit in baptism; not that he had it not before, for he never was without it; but that it might be manifest to us, that true baptism is that wherein the Holy Ghost is present." And to this also Calvin gives testimony, in his *Institutes.*[108]

7. Ambrose, speaking of the parts of baptism,[109] "There are," he saith, "in baptism, three things, water, blood, and the Spirit. Take away but one of these, and ye destroy the Sacrament. For what is water without the blood of Christ; or a common element, without any effect of the Sacrament?" If any shall say that this is not clear for the efficacy of baptism at the time of administration, he shall in this show so much ignorance in that Father's writings, as that the learned would justly blame me, if I should take up more time to

rum; aut si unum et in parvulis et in magnis habetis baptisma, etiam infantes in remissionem peccatorum baptizandos in similitudinem praevaricationis Adam credatis.

[107] Hieronymus adversus Luciferianos: *Nulli hominum sine spiritu sancto peccata dimittuntur. Quomodo antiquis sordibus anima purgatur, quae non habet spiritum?* Ibid. *Neque enim aqua lavat animam, sed prius ipsa lavatur a spiritu, et cetera.* Vide locum.

[108] Lib.4 cap.16 sect.18

[109] *De iis qui initiantur mysteriis, cap. 4 tres sunt in baptismate, aqua, sanfuis, spiritus; si unum borum, detrahas, non stat baptismatis sacramentum. Quid enim est aqua sine cruce Christ? elementum commune sine ullo sacramenti effectu?*

demonstrate this unto him, and gnash their teeth at such an ignoramus.

8. Lastly, Augustine, that great and famous doctor of the Church is known to all to be very frequent in this very argument. It shall suffice to quote a place or two, "There is not," he saith,[110] "the least doubt to be made by any man, that then every one of the faithful is made partaker of the body and blood of our Lord, when in baptism he is made a member of Christ." If any man thinks that by the faithful, he means only persons of years actually believing, let them consult his epistle[111] to Boniface, a devout earl, touching the baptizing of infants; in which they shall find that Father to comprehend infants in the number of the faithful, and that by reason of the, "Sacrament of faith." Again,[112] "We say that infants baptized, although they be now aware of it, the Holy Ghost doth dwell. For so are they without knowledge of his being in them, although he be in them; as they are, of the reasonable soul; (reason being in them who yet cannot make use of it) like a little spark raked up under ashes, and is not stirred up but by access of years." And in the same epistle, with which I will make an end,[113] "The Holy Ghost is said therefore to dwell in them, because he secretly works in them, that they may be his temple; which he afterwards perfecteth in those that profit and make further proceedings, & persevere in the same." In these words what can be said more plain and full to my present purpose touching the Holy Spirit's seizing upon infants, even in baptism, to prepare them in his own time to be temples for himself?

Such as would extend the efficacy of baptism indifferently to all infants will be perhaps ready to wrestle all these testimonies out of my hand and make use of them against me forasmuch as all these

[110] *Serm ad infantes. Nulli est aliquatenus ambigendum, tunc unum quemq, fidelium corporis sanguinisq, domini participem fieri, quando in baptismate efficitur membrutis Christi.*

[111] Epist. 23. tom.2

[112] *Epist. 57 ad Dardanum, Dicimus in baptizitis parvulis, quam vis id nesciant, habitare spiritum sanctis. Sic enim cum nesciunt quam vis sit in eis, quomadmodum nesciunt & metem, curus in us ratio qua uti nondum possant veluti quadam scintilla sopita est; excitanda atatis accessis.*

[113] *Habitare autem ideo & in talibus dicitur, quia occulte in eis agit, ut sint templum eius, idque in proficientibus & proficiendo perseverantibus proficit. Ibid.*

allegations seem to make for the universal extent of grace to all that are baptized, without restraining it to the elect as I do.

It is true the Fathers make no exception to my point, yet this doth not prove that therefore they held that none are exempted by God. nay they often declare the contrary. They, considering the charge which Christ hath laid upon his ministers to deny baptism to none to whom belong the kingdom of God, and not taking upon them to pry into God's secrets to know who they are that belong to his election, and who, not: as they baptize all, so they pronounce of each one, that his sins are remitted, and the Spirit is given him in baptism. Yet with this, confining the donation of these gifts only to such as have indeed interest in the kingdom, although they do not take on them to declare who they are in *particular* that have no share in it. Now, that notwithstanding their indefinite and illimited speeches, touching the efficacy of baptism, they did hold and declare that all are not indeed partakers of the grace of baptism, shall appear by one or two of them, which I think is enough to declare the judgment of the rest that were found among them.

Not to repeat what I formerly urged out of Chrysostom, to show that he was not of opinion that all, without exception, certainly received grace in baptism, although they did not actually resist it when they were baptized. I will mention only one passage out of Jerome, and another out of Augustine concerning this point.

Saint Jerome, if it is not falsely fathered on him, writing on Galatians 3,[114] "As many of you as have been baptized into Christ have put on Christ," hath these words; "If they who have been baptized into Christ, have put on Christ, it is manifest that they who have not put on Christ were not baptized into Christ. For to such as were thought to be faithful, and to have attained the baptism of Christ, it is else-

[114] *In Gal. 3 si igitur qui in Christo baptizanti sunt Christum induerunt; manifestum est eos qui non sunt induri Christum: non suisse baptizatos in Christo. Ad eos enim qui fideles & baptizma Christi conecuti putabantur dictum est: induite vos Domicum Jesum Christum (Rom. 13) Si quis hoc corporeum & quod oculis carnis aspicitur, aqua tantum accepit lavacrum. non est judutus dominum Jesum Christium Nam & Simon ille de actibus Apost: acceperat lavacrum aque: verum quia sanctum spiritum non habebat, indutus non erat Christum. Et Haretici, vel hypocrite, & si qui sordide victitant, videntur quidem accipere baptismum, sed nescio an Christum habeant indumentum. Itaq, consideremus ne forte & in nobis aliquis deprebendatur, qui ex co quod Christi non habet indumentum, arguatar non baptizatus in Christo.*

where said, put ye on the Lord Jesus Christ. If any hath received only that which is corporeal and visible, *viz*., the laver of water, he hath not put on Jesus Christ. For even Simon magus received the external washing, yet because he did not have the Holy Ghost, therefore he did not put on Christ. And so heretics, hypocrites, and those that live wickedly seem indeed to *receive* baptism, but I do not know that they have put on Christ as a garment. Therefore let us lay this to heart, lest any man be found among us that being not clothed with Christ, should not prove to have been baptized into Christ."

Some perhaps may snatch at this testimony and say that Saint Jerome speaks here of such as are of years that do *obicem ponere*, make resistance to grace; and not of infants of which the whole question is about. And if he did speak of infants, yet there is not a word of election, as the reason why some receive that which others go without. To these two cavils I must make an answer in order. First, I deny that he speaks only of persons of years, for without the general observation, that, "there must be some who were not indeed baptized into Christ," he makes application in particular to himself and others, most of which were baptized in infancy, (though some of years were daily added) and even in them would he have to consider seriously whether it were not thus with themselves, although baptized in infancy. Nor doth he make reluctation in Simon Magnus to be the reason why he was not baptized into Christ. But, "his not having the Spirit," and this is as much in effect, as if he had said, he was not baptized into Christ, because he was not in the number of God's sons by election. For the Scripture assigns this as the reason why some partake of the Spirit, "because they are sons," (Galatians 4:6). The rule of opposition therefore, must needs make the contrary true. No son, no Spirit: "no Spirit, none of Christ's."[115] Therefore, secondly, I say, that in effect he restrains the grace of baptism only to the elect; and for this reason, that they *are* elected. For if Simon could not be baptized into Christ, for lack of the Spirit, it is true that he could not be baptized into Christ, because he was not elected. For if he had been a son by election, he could not have missed the Spirit, as is clear in both the following, "And because ye are sons, God hath sent forth the Spirit of

[115] Romans 8:9.

his Son into your hearts, crying, Abba, Father," (Gal. 4:6), and, "For as many as are led by the Spirit of God, they are the sons of God." (Rom. 8:14). Now, forasmuch as the Holy Scriptures so clearly teach that none partake of the Spirit to sanctification and salvation but *only* the elect, (as by and by we shall, by occasion, see confessed also by Lombard himself) it was too great a wrong to such a worthy Father as Saint Jerome was, to interpret his speech uttered according to Scripture, as having in it a meaning *contrary* to the Scripture, to bolster up a tottering error of some that drew it immediately from Bellarmine and the rest of that crew.

What do we need of many words. If Jerome is not thought clear enough, then see my other witness, Saint Augustine, who will, I am sure, put everything past doubt, if Lombard doth not abuse him, "The sacraments," he saith,[116] "do effect or work that which they signify, only in the elect." I willingly admit that Lombard seeks to give an answer to him; but such as rather establish than oppose our present position. See what he writes.

Peter Lombard takes upon him throughout his fourth distinction of his fourth book,[117] to show the efficacy of baptism. He begins with infants, and as his own opinion, affirms first, that, "they all obtain remission of sin in baptism." Then he alleges the opinion in others that seemed to thwart his, "Some," he saith, "think that some infants notwithstanding baptism may perish, grounding themselves upon that of Augustine, the sacraments do effect that which they represent, only in the elect." But to evade this, he saith, "that they lack understanding in Saint Augustine, who do not so interpret him as that the sacraments do not procure remission of sin unto salvation, but only unto the elect." In which Lombard's answer to the allegation of the adverse parties out of Augustine, we may behold these three particulars. 1. A distinction between that remission of sin which is indifferently sealed to all in baptism, and that grace which is necessary for them

[116] *Sacramenta in solis electis efficiunt quod figurant, ita Lombard: 4. sent. dist. 4 in A.*

[117] *In princ. Sacramentum & rem simul suscipiunt omnes parvoli, qui in baptismo ab ordiginali mundantur peccato: quamuis quidam dissicantur illis qui perituri sunt parvulis in baptismo dunitti peccata, innitentest illis verbo Augustini (Sacramenta in solis electis effisiunt quod figurant) non intelligentes idud ita esse ace piendum, quia cum in alus efficiuus sacramenta remissionem, non hoc is faciunt ad salutem, sed solis electis.*

to obtain in it, that are undoubtedly saved by it. 2. A confession that lasts in other words, "grace unto salvation," is peculiar only unto the elect.[118] 3. A concession that they all receive in baptism what is represented thereby in the outward sign. I willingly acknowledge that his own opinion is that in some sense, all infants receive remission of sin in baptism. But yet, they do this in such a sense, as doth not suffice for their salvation, if they are not of the number of the elect, as his own words expressly manifest in the place alleged, which restraint of his is fully the same with that I hold.[119]

And thus out of the first Father of the popish schoolmen that ever reduced the body of divinity into a method out of the Fathers, you have a confession that Saint Augustine was clearly of this judgment, that only the elect receive the Spirit and grace in baptism; which therefore we have reason to believe to be also the judgment of all the Fathers that lived in his age or before him. This is true unless we will make him a private opinionist that dissents from the rest, which would be a miserable shift, with palpable injury offered to so eminent a lamp in God's Church, who hath on his side Chrysostom and Jerome, that for substance to the point at hand, speaks as much as he doth. This is enough to acquit him of the stain of a private opinion, and sufficient to stop the mouths of all gainsayers, that would with great pleasure shake out this arrow shot out of his bow into the sides of that error touching the equal efficacy of baptism upon all that are partakers of

[118] Gab. Biel in 4 Sen. dist.4. 42 concl. 7, assigning some causes why some receive more grace in baptism than others do, among the rest he puts down this for one. *Cum Christus communiter ponitur nosse omnia que Deus scientia visionis, per consequens novit electos omnes, & ad quem gradum gloria sint elect. Potuit ergo pro praestinato ad majorem gloriam offerre plenius passionem suam & pracipue eum obiulit pro genera humano ad hoc ut impleretur pradestinatio divina.* And this he says is a meritorious cause of the inequality of grace given in baptism. And a little before ibid, he assigned election to greater glory, to be the cause why some receive greater grace; so he urges it out of Scotius, which shows clearly that the founding schoolmen always took it for granted that the efficacy of baptism was extended only to the elect.

[119] *Saint Augustine de pec. Mer. & remis.ad marcellimum lib.2 cap.27 Sicut generatio carnis precati per unum adom in condemnationem trahit omnes qui co modo generantur, sic generatio spiritus gratia per unum Jesum Christum ad justificationem vita aterne ducit omnes qui eo modo pradestinati regenerantur. Sacramentum autem baptismi profectio sacramentum regenerationis est. And the same Saint Augustine, De bono perseverantia. cap.11 Proinde sicut apostolus ait, non volentis neq, currentis; sed miserentis est Dei qui & parvulis quibus vult, etiam non volentibus neq, currentibus subvernit, quos ante constitutionem mundi elegit in Christo, daturus etiam iis gratiam gratis.*

the outward element; an absurdity not hatched in the Church by the Spirit of error, until after Peter Lombard was dead and rotten.

It may not be denied that the Fathers in many passages do not speak so distinctly and cautiously as the gross mistakes of after ages would have required; yet their excessive speeches and flowers of rhetoric must not be so far urged, as to weaken their authority in what they took upon them to speak positively, properly, and determinatively, according to the Scriptures. When no adversary as yet appeared to abuse their speeches to a wrong sense; they spoke more securely and freely, not giving such exact bounds to their words, as otherwise they would have done. If they found any that would presume upon salvation, because they had been outwardly baptized, whether they were heretics, hypocrites, or lewd livers, Chrysostom and Jerome (as we have seen) begin then to restrain the saving grace of baptism only to such as believe and live as they ought. And if any think that election makes no difference between a man and a man, but that such as are not elected, as well as the elect, may be partakers of that opinion with protestation, that the sacraments do not effect what they signify, but only upon the elect. And all this Lombard himself will confess to be true of the efficacy of baptism to salvation. When therefore, we meet with any of the ancients that do not thus limit their assertions, we must yet conceive them to be of the same mind with Saint Jerome and Saint Augustine in this point; especially considering that the Scriptures themselves (as in the former chapter hath been declared) do so bound the same, from which we ought not to conceive that those founder Fathers would dissent. For, those three worthies before described (who are better expositors of the minds of the rest of their brethren that lived with them or before them, than any perverse papist or Arminian either is, or can be) have so fully and perspicuously declared themselves agreeable to the point at hand. And so we have covered the judgments concerning the Early Fathers.

CHAPTER VI. The Confessions of Reformed Churches.

I do not doubt that I shall meet with some spirits that will deride and scorn all these testimonies of the Fathers, as the *dreams* of erring men;[120] and so will be ready to say that it is not much matter what the Fathers speak, forasmuch as they spoke and wrote a great deal more than any sound divine will take upon him the justification of, or is able to defend. Therefore it is requisite that I now show what the Churches of Christ, since the last happy reformation, have all conspired to acknowledge and profess in their several public confessions, printed at Geneva, concerning this point. By this it will appear, that here they do, in substance, concur with those Fathers that some shallow brains please to set so light by. The judgment of our own Church, as it is expressed in the *Form of Baptism*, the *Catechism*, and *Articles of Religion*, we have already seen that at large. We are therefore now to produce the *Confessions of foreign Churches* only, which here follow in order.

1. *The Helvetic Confession*, chapter 20 states the following[121], "To be baptized in the name of Christ is to be enrolled, initiated, and received into the covenant and family, and so into the inheritance of the sons of God: yea to be even now called by the name of God, that is, to be called a son of God; to be purged from the filth of sin, and to be endowed with the manifold grace of God, unto a new and in-

[120] *Nec tamen patres aliud dicunt, qua quod nos dicimus, fieri nos in baptismo novos homines, & peccata nobis remitti, et spiritum sanctis esse efficacem: amnia hac not domus; sed nort ideo sequitur, sacramenta conferre gratiam ex opere operato quasi quia sunt efficacia organa spiritus sancti, ideo ex via suo & ex opere operato efficacia sunt. Whitaker. de sacram. in genere. quest.4 cap.2. Et Paulo post: ibid. Tribuunt illis (patres nempe) multum baptismo, & merito quidem remisionem peccatotum, gratiam, vivificationem, regurationem, & alia huius modis & forsan aliqui nimium tribuunt: quas quam re vera nihil dicunt quod nonsatis commode exponi potest. Non enim dicunt illam gratiam esse it clusom in aquo, out ex opere operatio conferri: sed spiritum sanctum esse in aqua & per aquana efficacum, quod ex eo Basil ijloco constare potest, quem assert ellarminus, vide ibi plura, in page 73-74.*

[121] *Baptizari in nomine Christi, est inscribi, initiari, & recipi infadus, atq familiam, adesq hareditatem filio um Dei, immo iam nuncumpari nomine Dei id est, appellari filium Dei pulgari itema sordibus peccatorum, & donari varia Dei gratia, ad vitam novam & innocentem.*

nocent life." And a little after[122], "for we are inwardly regenerated, purified, and renewed by God through the Holy Ghost." And at the close of that chapter, they add[123], "We condemn the Anabaptists, who deny young infants born of faithful parents to be admitted unto baptism. For according to the doctrine of the Gospel, theirs is the kingdom of God, and they are within the covenant of God." Why therefore should not the sign of the covenant of God be given to them? Why should they not be initiated by holy baptism, that are God's peculiar, and within his Church?

2. *The Confession of Scotland*, "We do certainly believe that by baptism we are engrafted into Jesus Christ, and made partakers of his righteousness whereby all our sins are done away."[124]
3. The Belgic Confession, article 34 speaks in this way,[125] "Therefore did the Lord command all of his be baptized with pure water, in the name of the Father, the Son, and the Holy Ghost; that he might signify that the blood of Christ by the Holy Ghost doth perform inwardly in the soul, that which the water doth effect outwardly upon our bodies." And that they understand this of infants also, they afterward express themselves, by declaring against the Anabaptists, that even infants partake of Christ in baptism, *pro modulo suo*, according to their capacity, as well as others: saying,[126] "certainly Christ shed his blood that he might no less wash infants of faithful parents, than those of years; and therefore it is requisite they should also receive the sign or sacrament of that thing which Christ for their sakes accomplished.

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[122] *Nam inturre gentramar, purificamus & renovamur a Deo per spiritu sanctum.*

[123] *Damnamus Anabaptistas qui negant baptizandos esse infantulos recens natos a fidelibus. Nam iuxta doctrinam evangelicam, horum est regnum Dei, et sunt in foedere Dei. Cur itaque non daretur eis signum foederis Dei? Cur non per sanctum baptisma initiarentur, qui sunt peculium et in Ecclesia Dei?*

[124] *Certo credimus per baptismum nos in Christo Iesu inseri, et eius iustitiae, qua omnia nostra peccata teguntur et remittuntur, participes fieri.*

[125] *SVOS igitur OMNES jussit dominus in nomiac Patris fili, & spiritus sancti pura aqua baptizari, ut significaret sanguinem Christi per spiritum sanctum idem prestare & efficere interme in anima, quod aqua extreme operatur in corperibus.*

[126] *Re vera Christus non minus sanguinem suum effadit ut fidelium infantes, quam ut adultos ablueret: ideoque, signum seu sacramentum rei, quam Christus eorum causa est operatus, illos recipere convenit.*

4. *The Confession of France*, which is also the *Confession of Geneva*, professeth this,[127] "We acknowledge only two sacraments common to the whole Church, the former whereof is baptism, given unto us to witness our adoption, because in it we are engrafted into the body of Christ, that being washed with his blood we might also be renewed by his Spirit unto holiness of life." Again in the 37th article, "We believe, as is foresaid, that as well in the Lord's Supper, as in baptism, God doth bestow upon us in very deed; that is to say truly, and effectually whatsoever he therein sacramentally doth represent unto us: and therefore with the signs we join the true possession and fruition of that thing which is therein offered to us." And in article 38 likewise.[128] [129]
5. *The Argentinian Confession*, chapter 17, thus determines, "Touching baptism, we confess that which the Scripture everywhere affirms of it: that, thereby we are buried into the death of Christ, knit together in one body, we put on Christ; it is the laver of regeneration to wash away our sins, and to save us, (Romans 6:3, 1 Corinthians 12, Galatians 3, Titus 3, Acts 22, 1 Peter 3)."[130]
6. *The Augustan Confession*, article 9 teaches, "that infants being by baptism commended unto God, are received into the favor of God, and made his sons as Christ testifies: saying, it is not the will of your Father which is in heaven that one of these little ones should perish, (Matthew 18)."[131]

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[127] *Agroscimus duo tantum sacromenta toti ecclesia communia, quorum prius ost baptismus, nobis testificanda nostra adoptionis datus quoniam in eo inferimur Christi corpori. ut tius sanguine abluti, simul etiam ipsius spiritu ad vitae sanctimoniam renovamur. Article 35.*

[128] *Credimus, sicut ante dictum est, tam in caena quam in baptismo, Deum nobis re ipsa vere & efficaciter donare quidquid ibi sacramentaliter figurat; ac proinde cum signis coniungimus veram possessionem ac fruitionem eius rei quae ibi nobis offertur.*

[129] *Dicimus itaq, elementum aque, quaotum vis taducam; nobis nihilominus vere testificari interiorem animi nostri ablutiontem in sanguin Jesu Christi per sancti spiritus efficatiam, Romans 6:3, Ephesians 5:26.*

[130] *De baptismate itaq, confitemur, id quod passim scriptura de illo pradicat eo sepeliri nos in mortem Christi, coagmentari in unum corpus, Christum induere, lavacrum regenerationis, peccata abluere, vot salvare, Romans 6:3, 1 Corinthians 12, Galatians 3, Titus 3, Acts 22, 1 Peter 3.*

[131] *Docet quod infantes per baptismum Deo commendati, recipiantur in gratiam Dei, & fiant fily Dei, sicut Christus testatur, (Matthew 18) nom est voluntas patris vostri qui est in calis, ut peccat unus ex parvulis istu.*

7. *The Saxon Confession*, chapter 14 saith,[132] "We retain the baptism of infants also, because it is most certain that the promise of grace belongs even to infants & nor do we judge this a mere idle ceremony, but that then they are truly received by God, and sanctified.
8. *The Confession of Wirtemburg, cap. de baptismo*, saith this to the same effect, "We teach that he that is baptized in the name of the Father, of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost is anointed with a spiritual chrysme: that is, he is made a member of Christ, and endowed with the Holy Ghost."[133]
9. To all these we may add the pious and orthodox *Confession of the Palatine*, extant in the same *Harmony of Confessions*, "Touching the force and efficacy of holy baptism, I believe and confess that our children (forasmuch as they also are included together with us in the covenant before spoken of) when they are baptized into the articles of the ancient and catholic faith (as in them also they ought to be trained up and instructed) are made partakers as well as we of the bloody death of our Lord Jesus Christ, and of all other good things which in that his death he as procured: and that in this manner*; viz*., that as they receive the outward seal, to wit the holy sacrament, the elementary water from the Minister of the word externally in the body; so also together at once by Christ they are washed with his blood in their souls; that is to say, they are internally baptized, and are regenerated anew as new creatures by the Holy Ghost."[134]

But some may object that this last point is not the confession of the Church of the Palatinate, but only of Frederick III, the Palsgrave of

[132] *Retinemus et infantium baptismum, quia certissimum est promissionem gratiae etiam ad infantes pertinere, et cetera; nec iudicamus hunc morem tantum otiosam ceremoniam esse, sed vere tunc a Deo recipi et sanctificari infantes.*

[133] *Docemus eum qui baptizatur in nomie patro, fila, & spiritus sancti ungi spirituali clapsmate; hoc est fieri membra Christi; & donari spiritu sancto.*

[134] *De virture & efficacia (acri baptismi credo & consicor liberos nostros, quia in hoc fadere, ut iam dictum, etiam ip si una includuntur, cum in articulos antiqua nostra & catholica fidei baptizantur, sicut in tis itpit educari & institui debent, etiam cruentis mortas domini nostri Jesu Christi, omniumq, eius bonorum que illic morte sua acquisivit, una participes sieritidq, hoc modo, quod quemadmodum externum sigilum, sacro sanctum sacramentum, nempe elementarem aquam a ministro verbidivini, extriusecus in corporc ceripiunt, ita quuq a Christo ipso, effuso istuis sanguine, in animabus suis hoc est interne baptizantur, & per spiritum santcum de integro, seu in novas creaturas regeneratur.*

Rhene? To which I answer, 1. By confessing it to be true that it was indeed the confession of that religious prince; yet such as was approved of by that whole Church, as appears by the inserting of it among the public confessions of the Churches, nor is there any other confession of that Church to be found in the Harmony of Confessions, but only this; by which it is evident that the whole Church of the Palatinate, considering how full this confession was, and how exactly, according with their public catechism, did they think it to be needless to draw any other public body of confession, but rather to rest in this so well performed to their hands. 2. I say that it doth fully agree to the established doctrine of that Church set forth in their public catechism. For in the 69th question of that catechism this is demanded;[135] "By what ground art thou admonished and confirmed that in thy baptism thou art made a partaker of that one and only sacrifice of Christ?" The answer to it is this, "Because Christ enjoined that outward laver of water, with this promise annexed to it, that I should be no less certain that I am washed by his blood and spirit from all the filth of my soul; that it, from all sins, I am externally washed with water, whereby the stains of the body are wont to be purged away."[136]

To which I may further add, that learned Pareus, in his larger explication of that catechism, however, requires faith in the receiver that will have sensible possession and benefit of the graces of that sacrament. Yet in his commentary upon the 74th question of the same place, undertaking to prove against the Anabaptists, the lawfulness of baptizing of infants, the second argument which he there useth is this[137], "that remission of sins by the blood of Christ, and the Holy Ghost the worker of faith, is promised to infants; as well as to those of years, and that therefore infants ought to be baptized." Again, in his answer to the second objection of the Anabaptists by which they would prove that infants ought not to be admitted unto baptism;

[135] *Qua ratinoe in baptismo ad moneris & confirmaris, te unici illues, sacrificii Christi participem essec.*

[136] *Quod Christus externum aqua lavacrum mandavit, addita hac promissiene, tac non minus certo ipsius sanguine & spiritura a fordibus anima: hoc est, ab omnibus peccatis meis lavari, quam aqua extrinsecus ablutes sum, qua sordes corporis expurgari solent.*

[137] *Ad infantes ecclesia pertinet beneficium remissionis peccatorum & regenerationis, infantibus aeque ac adultis remissio peccatorum per sanguinem Christi, & spiritus sanctus, effector promittitur; ergo infantes Christianorum debent baptizari.*

namely, "because they believe not." He thus saith[138], "they have faith although not actual; yet, potential, and by inclination; or at least the Holy Ghost himself supplies its room, and so sufficeth for their baptism: For he that hath received the Holy Ghost ought not to be excluded from baptism; according to that of the Apostle in Acts 10:47," which that author applies to this very purpose.

So we have the confessions of nine Churches of chiefest note beyond the seas, professing and publishing as much as those eight Fathers of old, and as our own Church at home, touching the efficacy of baptism of elect infants; or, if you will, indefinitely of all infants supposed to be truly and indeed within the election and covenant of grace.

Some, haply, will be meddling here again, and say that all these confessions do not set such a restraint upon the efficacy of baptism, as our present position doth, but extend it indifferently unto all. But to such I must give the same answer that I did before, because the objection is the same and because also it is set upon the same sandy foundation*: viz*. that the confessions are indefinite, so as none are excluded from the grace of the sacrament, that are partakers of the outward washing. The form of expression which the churches use is indefinite, and it is necessary it should be so, because they speak of baptism considered in its nature when it is applied to those within the covenant, to all which the grace of baptism is ordinarily given. Yet, well knowing that all are not indeed within the covenant, although born of parents that are members of the visible Church, *they do not say universally that all infants are partakers of the grace of baptism, but indefinitely, that infants are partakers of it*. Now, although oftentimes an indefinite proposition *in materia necessaria* is equivalent to a universal, yet it is not always so, (as, hath been formerly said) when some circumstance occurs that may vary the condition of the party to whom it is applied. As for

[138] *Infantes enim credunt suo modo, pro modo aetatis, quia habent inclinationem ad credendum. Fides inest infantibus potentia et inclinatione, licet non actu, ut in adultis.* And a little after: *Habent etiam infantes spiritum sanctum, et ab eo regenerantur pro modo aetatis suae, sicut Ioannes Baptista impletus fuit spiritu sancto cum adhuc esset in utero matris; et Ieremiae, cum nondum prodiisses ex utero, sanctificavi te. Si infantes habent spiritum sanctum, certe operatur in eis regenerationem, bonas inclinationes, novos motus, et alia quae ad salutem eis sunt necessaria; vel certe haec omnia ipse quasi supplet, et ad baptismum eis sufficit, iuxta dictum Petri: quis potest arcere ab aqua eos, qui spiritum sanctum acceperunt, sicut et nos? Acts 10.*

example, to say that persons so and so educated in their youth prove wise and able men for such or such an employment, makes the proposition to be taken as generally true, by reason of the sufficiency of the means of their education: yet because there may be, and oft is, some inward impediment or incapacity in some particulars, that proposition is by no wise men believed to be meant as universally true of all that are under the same helps and means. Yea some propositions that are universally propounded, have yet their limitations implied which are discerned by all rational men that either hear or read them as for instance, "Ye are all the children of God by faith in Christ Jesus," (Galatians 3:26) the Apostle saith, yet who can be so charitable as to think that there was not so much as one hypocrite in all the Church of Galatia? Doth the same Apostle not say elsewhere, that, "All men have not faith?" (2 Thessalonians 3:2) and again, "They are not all Israel which are of Israel?" (Romans 9:6). What then? Why, *this*. The Apostle, looking on the powerful means of begetting the Galatians unto God, *viz*., the Word and Sacraments, and considering their outward submission and conformity to them, he professeth of them in the lump, "Ye are all his children if ye be indeed inwardly, what ye seem outwardly to me, that I am willing thus to hope and speak of you."

In the same manner then, the Churches must be understood, if they should deliver themselves in universal terms; forasmuch as all are not partakers of the Spirit and blood of Christ, that are partakers of the outward laver of regeneration, as some of the Fathers have soundly taught us in the former chapter. Because in the sacrament, by virtue of Christ's institution, ordinarily, grace is given to all that are by election capable of it; and it being known to none who they are that are not elected, it is more apt and proper to speak indefinitely, rather than restrictively, in public confessions of Churches, so that all may with more care and reverence attend the ordinance of Christ, and expect that in it. This, however is not certainly universally communicated to all indifferently, yet is not denied to this, or that, or any particular person presented to baptism. For although any mortal man can judge, or may take liberty to presume of anyone in particular, however in the

general he may set it down for a conclusion of truth, that there are some which go without it.

If yet I should be further pressed, that at least all the Lutherans expressly and stiffly declare themselves to believe that all infants certainly receive the inward grace of baptism, so as to be indeed regenerated in the very instant of the administration? To this I answer, that it is perhaps true of some particular men among them, that, as all men who profess themselves stiff followers of such or such a master, usually in a tract of time and through heat of disputation, go further than their master, or than those more moderate men that in former times added here unto him, as they now do. So these who therefore, for some errors which they unjustly father upon that worthy, are termed *pseudo Lutherans* going further than Luther ever did, may take upon themselves the defense of this error, which yet may justly pass as a private fancy of their own. And they have no true issue with him that they seem so much to glory in; at least no public definition of any of those Churches, which are at this day (through the violence of some particular men in them) nicknamed *Lutherans*. I am sure, and so also may all others be that will take the pains to peruse their confessions, that no such thing can be necessarily proved hence. But that the contrary to this may be as possibly defended, as that which some would deduct from those public instruments and declarations of their faith generally agreed upon among them all. And how are we to consider the rest; in other words, the French, Genevan, Helvetic, Netherland, and Palatinate Churches[139] are to be understood in the confessions, let the most learned and judicious among them declare unto us in their public writings, which is the next thing that I am to show.

[139] Dr. Francis White makes it the constant tenet of all those whom the quarrels of the world term Calvinists, to restrain the efficacy of baptism only to the elect, in his answer to Fisher, page 176, touching the efficacy of baptism; of which more afterwards.

CHAPTER VII. The Judgment of Foreign Divines.

I shall not need to be long in this, because I have in great part shown the judgment of Calvin, Peter Martyr, Zanchius, Junius, Bucer, Beza, Marlorat, Daneus, and Chamier; so far as they have opened or cleared any of those places of Scripture before alleged in my fourth chapter, proving my position by divine testimonies of the Scriptures. Notwithstanding, for my words' sake, I must do something, and set down here also a brief section of their opinions concerning this matter, who are of most eminent note in the Church that it may be yet more manifest that I have not set before you any new doctrine of my own. My purpose is not to be curious in marshalling the several authors which I now am to produce, but rather to place them in rank so that I can complete this section.

I have everywhere in my treatise made use of Calvin, so as I have not much more to allege out of him than that which I have alleged before. However, because he is one of the principal modern writers that I build upon, as being very clear for this opinion, and of best reckoning with those that oppose me in this, I will here also produce him again, and lay nearer together all such passages of his, as are more scatteringly dispersed in my former chapters, on the occasions there offered unto me. And because I may be thought to mistake his meaning, I will together and at once show you how that renowned and invincible Chamier also understands Calvin's writings touching this point: and so I shall dispatch both Calvin and Chamier with one and the same labor.

Chamier, dealing against the Pontificians, especially against Bellarmine, touching on the efficacy of the sacraments of the New Testament, disclaims that position that sacraments are without all efficacy. He complains of it as a wrong done to all sound protestants, (who everywhere he calls by the name of Catholics, which title the papists unjustly attribute, and appropriate unto themselves) that they are charged with such an error. He saith, "The Catholics teach that in receiving of the sacraments, grace is wrought in the faithful, and that

the sacraments are to be held efficacious to the ends for which they were ordained. Nor do they unwillingly hear that from Greg de Valentia, *viz*., it ought not to be doubted but that in some manner, whatever that is, the sacraments are causes conferring grace. For in indeed the words of Calvin are these*; God doth truly perform whatever he promiseth and represents in the outward signs; nor do the outward signs want their effect, that he who is their author might prove himself true and faithful of his word*."[140] Then Chamier goes on to explain how and in what manner they work grace, not as the principal cause, but only instrumental; and that not physical, but moral. The same, in effect, he speaks again in the very same book, chapter 3, part 10, "Verily both Calvin, and all Catholics acknowledge the efficacy of baptism."[141]

But here some will be ready to object: What do we need with all this? Who denies this? The whole question is, what efficacy doth he and Calvin *mean*? Answer: Let Chamier himself explain the meaning in his own words. They are these,[142] "The doctrine of us Catholics is less gorgeously set out (than that of the papists) but more solid. There are two parts of man's restoration to salvation, Justification and Sanctification;" both of which he briefly explaineth, then concludes,[143] "Unto both these parts the sacrament of baptism is applied, in other words to represent, and to effect them." This he demonstrates out of *Calvin's Catechism*, which is the publicly authorized Catechism of Geneva and the Church of France. In this way the Catechism explains,[144] "What is the meaning of baptism? Answer: It hath in it two parts: for therein both remission of sins, and also spiritual regeneration is represented." And a little after this the Catechism explains the

[140] *Docent ergo Catholica in sacramentorum perceptione effici gratiam un fide.., hacte aes sacramenta dacenda efficacia, neq. inunti audiunt a Greg de Vale. Dubitari non deber, quin per aliquem tandem modum, quicun1; ille sit, sacramenta omnino sint causx gratiam. Et sine Calvini verba haec sunt; praestat agitur vere Deus quicquid sigrus promittit, ac figurat: nec est ectu suo carent signa, ut verus & fidelis probetur eorum author. So Calvin lib.4 Instit. cap.14 sect.17.*

[141] Sane tum Calvinus omnes Catholic baptismi efficaciam agnoscunt.

[142] *Lib.5 de sacram. cap.4 par.8. Nostra sententia minus est terbis ampullata sed longe simplicior & solidior. Restaurationis humana duas esse partes interim dum expectator salus plena; Justificationem & sanctificationem.*

[143] *Ibid. par.9 Uniq huic parti adbibium esse sacramentum baptismum, scit.* significande & efficiende.

[144] *Quae est baptismi significatio? Ea duas partes habet: nam ibi remissio peccatorum, deinde spiritualis regeneratio figuratur.*

former word, *representation*, "I judge it to be so a figure, that the truth of the thing figured is also annexed to it. For God doth not frustrate our expectation when he promiseth us his gifts, and therefore it is certain that both remission of sins and regeneration is both offered to us, and also received by us in baptism."[145] Thus far the Catechism of Calvin fully agrees with all those passages of his formerly cited works; if not only I, but that Reverend Chamier is not mistaken in construing his words this way.

There is no question, some say, but that you are both out, if you say Calvin meant this of the efficacy of baptism before faith. For Calvin, even in that very chapter so often before quoted, saith expressly,[146] "There is no more to be required in the baptism of infants in respect of present efficacy, than this, that the covenant of God made with them should be ratified and confirmed. The rest that is signified in that sacrament shall follow after, in God's good time." To which I answer, that this is as much as I contend for*; viz*. this efficacy as may for the present confirm an elect infant in God's covenant. But this confirmation is not, in Calvin's judgment, the bare reception of the outward sign, but a conferring of the inward earnest of the Spirit to assure them by it after grace and glory. For so he speaks in chapter 15, section 12 of the same book. The Apostle, he saith, having showed that we are accepted of God through Christ, he subjoins,[147] "That they all who are clothed with the righteousness of Christ, are also regenerated by his Spirit, and the earnest hereof we have in our baptism." There is then a confirmation by an *earnest*, and this *earnest* is part of the whole benefit promised, and by him assigned in express terms to be the Spirit, yes, look but into the very last words of the next section immediately preceding the section now quoted, and you shall find

[145] *Sic figuram esse sentio vi simut annexa fit veritas. Neq, enim sua nobis dona pollicendo nos Deus feustatur, proinde & peccatorum veniam, & vitae nobitatem offeri in baptismo, & recipia nobis certum est.*

[146] *Instit. lib.4 c.16 sect.21. Quare nihil plus in pedobaptismo presentis efficacie requirendam est quam ut faedis cum illis a domino percussum ab firmet & sanciat. Reliquote ejus sacramenti significatio, quo tempore Deus ape providerit, postca consequetur.*

[147] *Subiungit, eos omnes qui iustitia Christi induuntur, simul spiritu regenerari, et huius regenerationis nos arrham habere in baptismo.*

him there affirming,[148] "That we are baptized unto the mortification of our flesh, which mortification is begun in us from our very baptism, we daily go forward in it, and it shall be perfected in us when we depart hence unto the Lord." Mark it here, what Calvin means by *confirming and ratifying* the covenant unto an elect infant; and what it is that is to be expected to follow after in God's good time, even breaking out, growth, and perfection of that grace, which was begun even from his baptism in which he receives the Spirit as the earnest penny and Author of the same.

But Calvin directly affirms,[149] "Till by faith we lay hold upon the promise sealed in baptism, our baptism is not worth a rush unto us?" To this I have sufficiently answered more than once before; and particularly in chapter 4, in confirmation of the major proposition of my third argument: the sum of which is briefly this; *The sacrament profits no man of years, without faith to apprehend the promise: nor can the elect themselves sensibly perceive the fruit and comfort of their baptism, in the ordinary course, until after they have obtained actual faith at their actual conversion. Nor doth it follow that they did not have the Spirit in baptism, because they were not capable of so much as knowing the same at the time; much less, of believing; for so saith the author*,[150] "Although infants in the instance of circumcision were not able to comprehend what that sign meant, they were yet truly circumcised unto the mortification of their corrupt and defiled nature, which after they were yet truly circumcised unto the mortification of their corrupt and defiled nature, which after they came to years they meditated on. And a little after; infants are baptized unto future repentance and faith, which graces although they be not (actually) formed in them, yet by the secret operation of the Spirit in the seeds of both do lie hid in them." Now these two places laid together make it evident that, when the author said

[148] *Baptizomur in mortificationem carnis nostrae, quae a baptismo in nobis inchoatur, quam quotidie prosequimur; perficietur autem quum ex hac vita migradimus as dominum. sect.11.*

[149] *Fatemur ergo baptismum pro eo tempore non prosuisse nobis helum, quando in eo nobis oblata promissio, sine qua baptisimus nihil est, negicta jacebat. Instit. lib.4 ca.15 sect.17.*

[150] *Etsi infantes quo circumcidebantur memento, quid sibi vellet signum ilud, intelligentia non comprehendebant: vere tame circumcidebantur in natura sue corruptae ac contaminata mortificationem quam adulti postea meditarentur. Deniq, nullo negotio solvi potest objectio haev, baptizari in futuram paenitentiam & fidem; qua etsi nondum in illia formata sunt, arcand tamen spiritus operatione utriusq, seme in illis latet. lib.4 c.16 sect.20.*

that, "Baptism profits nothing till the promise be apprehended," his meaning was not that the Spirit of God doth nothing at all at the time of baptism in an elect infant; but only this, that the party cannot have any actual sensible benefit until actual faith is begotten in him, and the same actually employed in the application of those good things which were exhibited and sealed unto him in his baptism.

But it will be yet further objected that, admit that Calvin was of opinion that some infants are endowed with the Spirit in their infancy, yet he did not mean to ascribe the communication of it to baptism; but rather declares himself to mean it of grace received before baptism, as appears by the instances he gives of John the Baptist,[151] which he contends to have been, "sanctified in the womb by God, who therein gave us an experiment of his power to sanctify others," in the same manner. Now, what is this to the reception of the Spirit in baptism? To this I answer, first, that his main scope is to confute the Anabaptists' doctrine touching on their supposed impossibility of the capacity of regeneration in an infant, for which reason they would not have him admitted to sacred baptism, as appears in the beginning of the same section.[152] Therefore here I collect that his purpose was to overthrow this imaginary bulwark, by making it evident here not only a possibility, but (in that particular of John) a certainty of regeneration even in the womb, which was sooner than baptism, so as their argument could not hold against baptism. For if an infant is capable of the Spirit in the womb, much more than in baptism, and therefore he ought to be baptized. Secondly, if his purpose were not thence to infer that an infant not only may, but *doth* receive the Spirit in baptism, it would not be a sufficient answer to their objection. For they might justly reply thus, if you intend only a possibility of regeneration of some, before baptism, and not of what is ordinarily conferred in baptism, then it cannot follow here. The reason is that because in some extraordinary cases some few may be sanctified before baptism, therefore it ought to be drawn into an ordinary practice that infants

[151] *Documentum prabuitim Johane Baptista que in matris utero sancti sicuit, quid in reliqius Passat. Ibid. cap.16 sect.17*

[152] *Ibid. Ratione quoq, firmissima obtender sibi videntur, cur arcendi sint a baptismo pueri, dum causantur non esse pareatatem adbus idoneous qui signatum illis mysterium asseqeantur, Id autem est spiritualis regeneratio, quae cadere in primam infantiam non potest.*

should be baptized because by your own confession, that sanctification which some infants partake of, is not by virtue of the efficacy of baptism, but by and from the special pleasure of God manifested upon some few, here and there without this ordinance. Thirdly, I add that Calvin certainly and expressly intended that the first principle of regeneration, in other words the Spirit of Christ is ordinarily given in baptism. In the 21st section of the very same chapter, he speaks this way,[153]

> "Whom God granteth to the elect, if after they have received the sign of regeneration, they die before they come to years, then he doth renew by the power of his Spirit, by us incomprehensible, as it seemeth best unto himself. But if it so fall out that they live to years of discretion, whereby they may be instructed concerning the truth of their baptism, they are then thereby the more provoked to the study of newness of life, the pledge and badge of which they then come to learn that they were endowed with from their very infancy, whereby they ought more seriously to meditate upon the same all the days of their life. And hither is to be referred that which Paul teacheth in those two distinct places touching our burial with Christ by baptism, (Romans 6:4, Colossians 2:12). For thereby the Apostle meant not to show that it is necessary for him that is to be baptized, to be thus buried with Christ beforehand; but, what simply baptism doth effect in and upon them that are now baptized, that so no cracked brains should contend that this doth go before baptism. After the same manner Moses & the Prophets admonished people what was the

[153] *Quos electione sua dignatus est Dominus, si accepto regenerationis signo, praesenti vita ante demigrent quam adoleverint, eos virtute sui spiritus nobis incomprehensa renovat, quomodo expedire solus ipse providet. Si grandescere in aetatem contingat, qua baptismi veritatem edoceri queant, hinc magis ad renovationis studium accendentur, cuius tessera se a prima statim infantia donatos esse discent, quo eam toto vitae decursu meditarentur. Eodem referatur quod duobus locis Paulus docet, nos Christo per baptismum consepeliri. Nam eo non intelligit, consepultum Christo iam prius eum esse oportere qui baptismo sit initiandus: sed quae baptismo subest doctrina simpliciter declarat; idque iam baptizatis, ut ne insani quidem baptismo praeire ex hoc loco pugnaturi sint. In hunc modum et Moses et Prophetae populum admonebant quid sibi vellet circumcisio, qua tamen infantes donati fuerant. Tantundem valet quod et Galatis scribit, eos dum baptizati fuerant, Christum induisse. Quorsum id? Nempe ut Christo in posterum viverent, quia non ante vixissent. Et quanquam in natu grandioribus mysterii intelligentiam signi susceptio consequi debet, parvulos tamen alio loco ac numero habendos mox exponetur, et cetera.*

meaning of circumcision; with which notwithstanding their very infants were also signed. This is the equivalent to that which also the Apostle writeth to the Galatians, that when they were baptized, they put on Christ. Why speaks he so? Namely, that they might now live unto Christ, which before that time, they had not done. And although in persons of ripe age the receiving of the sacrament ought to follow the understanding of the mystery; yet infants are to be accounted of another rank and number, as shall be presently declared."

By all this then it is manifest that Calvin's judgment was for the *reception* of the Spirit in baptism, in its ordinary course, notwithstanding the instance he gives of the Baptist, who received his first sanctification in his mother's womb. His meaning was not to show when an infant receives the Spirit, as if he usually received it in the womb, or out of baptism; but only to prove a possibility that an infant may receive the Spirit in baptism notwithstanding his infancy, because he may partake of it in the very womb.

Well, yet when you have all done, is Calvin speaking all this in some special cases only, as namely as in the case of elect infants dying in infancy, as the place last cited may declare? Answer: It is very true that Calvin doth not speak of all that are outwardly baptized; no more do I. I restrain it to the elect, and so doth he[154] as is evident in the last passage quoted of him. But yet he is not so to be taken, as if he held that only elect infants who die in infancy, receive the Spirit in baptism. But that *all* the elect, whether they live or die, ordinarily partake of the Spirit in that ordinance. Touching elect children that die in infancy, I am of the opinion that, by a secret and incomprehensible work of the Spirit, they are actually regenerated so as to be made ready to enter into that holy city into which no unclean thing shall ever enter; and this Calvin also professedly maintains.[155] They therefore have a fur-

[154] *Spiritus sanctus* (quem non omnibus promiscue sacramenta advehunt, sed quem Dominus peculiariter suis confert) *is est qui Dei gratias secum affert, qui dat sacramentis in nobis locum, qui efficit ut fructificent. Instit. lib. 4, cap. 14, sect. 17.*

[155] *Porro infantes qui servandi suut, (ut certe ex ea atate omnino aliqui servantur) ante adomino regenerari mi nime obscurum est. Nam si ingenitam si corruptionem ematris utno secum asserunt: ea repurgatos esse oportet, antequam in regnum Dei admittantur, quo nihil ingreditur polintum aut utquinatum, Instit. lib.4 cap.16 sect.17.*

ther work made in them, than others ordinarily have. Howbeit, it was never the meaning of that judicious man to restrain all communication of the Spirit to such as die in infancy, but only to extend it to all the elect, and to the elect only. Why else should he say that even,[156] "We are baptized unto mortification of our flesh, which mortification is begun in us from our very baptism, and we daily go forward in it?" Why doth he avouch that,[157] "Christ was sanctified from his first incarnation, that he might sanctify his elect of every age, without any difference. For as he took to him our flesh, in which he perfectly performed perfect and complete obedience for our sakes, and in our rooms, for the abolishing of the sin of disobedience committed by us in the flesh; so he was conceived of the Holy Ghost, that being fully endowed with the Spirit, upon the assumption of our flesh, he might transfuse the same holiness unto us?" All which he speaks, not of such as die in infancy, but of such as live also to ripe years. And if he did not mean to affirm this to be the ordinary course of divine dispensation, in the baptism of such as live to years, he could not possibly repel the argument of the Anabaptists, who therefore disclaim the baptism of infants because they receive no part of the inward grace signified by the outward sign. For if he should make such an imperfect answer as this, *viz.*, that although elect infants who live to years are not then in any degree partakers of the inward grace, yet such as die in infancy, do partake thereof; and therefore, for their sakes at least infants should be baptized. Now, if he should answer in this way, they would hiss at such a poor shift, and reply like this: if you would have all infants baptized, because some of them may die and in that regard may need baptism, forasmuch as they are to be regenerated in baptism, to make them fit for heaven. This is a poor kind of reasoning, for, by your own confession,[158] "Elect infants, dying before baptism, cannot perish," so as there is no necessity for baptizing

[156] Instit. lib.4 cap.15 sect.12 of which but a little before.

[157] *Et sane ideo prima infantia sanctificanus fuit Christus, ut ex atate qualibet sine dises imin electos suos in scipso sanctificaret. Nam quemadmodum ad delendam inobedientia culpam, qua in carne nostra pe petrata suerat, cam ipsam carnem sibi induit, in qua perfectam causa viceq, nostra obedientiam prastaret ita ex spiritu sancto conceptus suit ut cuis sanctitute in assumpta carne ad plenum perfusus, ipsam ad nos transfunderet, Instit. lib.4 cap.16 sect.18.*

[158] *At periculum est ne is qui agrotat, si absis, baptismo decesserit, regenerationis gratia princtur, minime vero, jufantes nostros, antequam nascantur, se adoptare in suis pronunciat Deus, quum le,*

of all infants for regenerating a few by it, that may happen to die in infancy, inasmuch as they would be sanctified, although they should never be baptized, and the rest, although baptized, would not by your own doctrine, be then sanctified at all. Here I have largely declared the judgment of that judicious and justly honored Calvin, touching this point. I have been more tedious in this than a judicious reader will (perhaps) bear patience. But if any find fault, my apology is this, they who should have had more mind and honesty, have filled the heads of the multitude with the following lie, that, "However I made a great flourish with the name of Calvin, for giving my countenance to my opinion, yet the truth is, Calvin delivered no such thing; but is rather against me, than for me, as they are able to show at pleasure to any man that shall require it." Now to clear myself of this foul aspersion unjustly cast on me, I held myself bound by a kind of necessity thus copiously to set down Calvin's opinion; and to meet with all objections that could possibly be put up against me, to weaken the several testimonies I take out of Calvin for my defense. I did this to the intent that after all that can be said on both sides, the impartial reader, how meanly he is gifted, may be able to judge, whether Calvin speaks with or against me.

What was the conceit of Chamier, and particularly of Calvin, you have seen in part already. And because Chamier is of such eminent note in the Church, and on behalf of protestants. In his own writings, concerning the efficacy of baptism on elect infants, I will produce a place or two more out of him. Writing of this very point, and stating the controversy between the papists and us therein it, he saith,[159] "The question between them and us is not: 1. Whether justification from all sins be offered and conferred in baptism; for this, neither part denies: nor, 2. Whether any sanctification at all be then conferred: for that, both allow: but the punctual difference is only concerning the quantity and measure of sanctification. The papists contend that

nobis in deum fove promittic, seminiq, nostro post nos. Hoc. verbo continetur eo um sabes. Insit. lib.4 cap.15 sect.20.

[159] *Constat utrinq, consentui in prius caput de justificatione, nempe quo ad cuplam paenam1. ommum peccatorum, quam in baptismo significari id est estica neutro negant. In altero utidem capite, hoc videm capite, hoc saltem untrinq, poni, santificatione (i) novitatem vitae conferri. Quid igitur controverti? Nomirum brius sanctificationis modulum & menstoram. De sacram: lib.5 cap.4 par.10.*

sanctification complete is then given; and this we deny, saying that it is only then begun, and is daily perfected by degrees." Here, lest any man should dream of an ambiguity in his speeches, take notice that Chamier in that very chapter had before showed his meaning to be that of which is ordinarily communicated in the very instant of the administration of baptism. For so, he saith,[160] "The present difference between us and papists touching the efficacy of baptism, may be reduced to two heads; the first touching the present effect of it; the other, touching that which is future. By the present effect, I mean," saith he, "that which is assigned to be wrought in the very instant of the right administration of baptism: by the other, that which follows after the celebration ended." Then he goes on with his discourse that was but now propounded, to show that even in the moment of baptism all orthodox divines allow of some present efficacy of baptism upon infants, unto sanctification, as more at large appears in the author himself. Yes, he is so resolute for the efficacy of baptism upon infants that he doth not fear to affirm that either at that time or else it *never* takes effect on them. See his own words,[161] "So far is it said of us that we should teach that baptism effecteth nothing upon infants until they come to age; that on the contrary, we know that the effect of baptism, which is performed immediately by God himself, (sometimes) goes before the very celebration of baptism: therefore we say that, either then there is some effect in truth and indeed, when the sacrament is administered; or else there will never follow after any at all, that is, then our sins are truly remitted, and our adoption made sure to us: but all this, morally," and not by virtue of any inherent force in the outward signs to convey those graces naturally to the receiver by virtue of the outward act performed in such manner as the virtue that is in a potion conveys itself necessarily to the expelling of corrupt humors out of that body into which it is received. This *physical efficacy*, as they term it, is a thing which both he and all sound divines

[160] *Duo dissenti onis capita sunt primum, de effectu praesenti, alterum desuture. Praesentem effectum duo, qui aslignandus sit huic sacramento in ipso celebrationis legitima momentol futurum vero qui pust tam celebrationem. Ibid. par.6.*

[161] *Etenim jantum abest, ut diceamus nihil agere baptismum, nisi cum adolesucrint infantes ut contra effectum baptismi, quem Deus ipse perse prastet, sciames praecedere ipsam celebrationem baptismi: Itaq, aut nunquam ullum futurum, aut tum esse reapse quam celebratus vere inquod remitti peccata; vere adoptione, se fici morailter. de sacr. l.2 c.6 par.4.*

professedly disclaim. To make an end with this author, he allows an efficacy, we see, and expounds himself to mean only a moral efficacy. This moral efficacy he affirms to be found, not in all, yet in all the elect, as he also presently after declares himself,[162] "We rightly say," he saith, "that the effects of the sacraments are to be expected only from their institution, without which the external administration of the outward signs hath in it no force at all. But in this respect *(viz*. of the institution) the sacraments, of themselves avail very much; that is, although no actual faith be present to the receiver; as for example, in infants, at least in those that are elect." So we have seen both the judgment of Calvin and Chamier, the glory of France, and indeed of all Christendom. I will be very brief, in the rest.

Our next witness shall be that great and profound divine, whom Calvin styles, "a most potent man in the Scriptures," Martin Bucer, who treating of the efficacy of baptism, plainly avouches that,[163] "Baptism saves none of years, but believers. Salvation indeed is offered in baptism unto all; but those of years receive it not, but by faith, and infants, by the secret operation of the Holy Ghost, by which they are also sanctified unto external life." Then, for a conclusion of all that he had said and collected from many Scriptures cited to this purpose, he thus shuts up the whole matter,

> "From all these places we now clearly perceive baptism to be commended unto us as an instrument of divine mercy, which

[162] *Quid ergo; nimirum bene diximus, effecta sacramentorum non aliter expectanda, quam ex institutione: extra quam externa signorum administratio vim nullam habet. Hoc modo sacramenta ipsa valent per se plurimum: id est etiamsi nulla adsit actu praesens fides, ut in infantibus, saltem electis. De Sacram. lib. 2, cap. 6, par. 40.*

[163] *Nec enim servat baptisma adultos nisi credentes: salus quidem baptismate offertur omnibus: recipiunt autem illam adulti non nisi per fidem; infantes per arcanam spiritus sancti oprationem, qua ad vitam eternam sanctificantur. Ex bis iam omnibus locis clare perspicimus, baptisma commendari nobis, ut instrumentum divinae misericordia, quo deus non sua, sed nostra causa dignatur uti, ut quo electis suis, quibus ipse haec sua destinavit dona conferat usus suorum ad id ministerio, quod eis prasecripsit, peccatorum salutarem penitentiam, certamq. ablutionem & remissionem, mortem, sepuliuram purgationem, spem certam resurrectionis, in Christum incorporationem, cius induitionem, (i) salaficam communionem, regenerationem, innovationem, spiritus. Nec minus efficax est horum omnium donoram Dei instrumentum baptisma electis Dei quos es statuit dominus regignere, quam est ullum remedium quantumus efficax ex natura ut dicitur ad conferendam sanitatem corpori, ad suspsiendum hunc effectum maxime parato & accommodato. Ex dei enim verbo pendet effectus utriusq, rei. Imo multo certius, percipiunt electi Dei enumerata Dei beneficia per baptisma, quam corpora humana sanitatem suam per illa, qua vocantur romedia naturalia. Bucer. De vi & effic: bapt. in daf. inter scripta anglica.*

> God granteth merely for our sakes to use, by which he might confer on his elect, by the ministry of his servants, all these gifts, saving repentance, certain ablution and purgation of our souls, undoubted hope of the resurrection, incorporation unto Christ, putting on of Christ; that is, the saving communion, regeneration, and renewing of the Holy Ghost. Nor is this instrument of baptism less effectual unto all these uses in the elect, whom God hath resolved to regenerate, than is any remedy, how effectual soever, by a natural energy, to give health to a body that is most capable of such remedy, when it is applied thereunto. For on God's word the effect of each thing depends. Yea much more certainly do the elect of God's partake of all the forementioned benefits by baptism, than human bodies do receive health by natural means applied."

So we see Bucer to avert the efficacy of baptism, not only to persons of years believing, but to infants also. And this, to be ordinarily in the baptism of the elect, of all the elect, and only of the elect.

Peter Martyr, writing of the very same subject, and endeavoring to make good the solid doctrine of the Church touching the baptizing of infants, affirms that they are not incapable of baptism for want of actual faith, because the Spirit in them supplies the room of faith; nor are they excluded from the present efficacy of that ordinance, because that unto them, as well as to the rest of the faithful, the Holy Ghost is promised at that time. His own words are plain and full enough. Therefore take the pains to read and mark them,[164] "In infants," he saith, "who by reason of their tender years cannot believe, the Holy Ghost supplies the room of faith. Also the effusion of the Holy Ghost is promised in baptism, as the Apostle expressly writes to Titus saying, "who saved us by the laver of regeneration and renewing of the Holy Ghost, which he shed abroad on us abundantly.""Afterwards, in the same chapter, he takes occasion to debate what efficacy, in particular, infants are partakers of in their baptism, and modestly refuseth to determine it punctually. He waves the point when he saith, "I hold

[164] *Infantibus autem qui adhuc per atatem credere non possunt, spiritus sanctus in eorum cordibus fidei vices gerit. Effusio quoq spiritus sancti premittitur in baptismo, ut in baptismo, ut in epist. ad tit. diserte scribitur; qui salves nos fecit, Loc. Com. clas.4 cap.8 sect.2.*

that it is sufficient that we acknowledge they shall be saved, forasmuch as they, by election and predestination, belong to God's peculiar flock that they are endowed with the Spirit, who is the root of faith, hope, love, and all other graces, which Spirit afterwards doth manifest and declare himself in the sons of God, when they come to years."[165]

Musculus, of baptism gives this description,[166] "We define baptism to be the sacrament of regeneration, purgation, initiation, sanctification, obsignation, and incorporation into Christ our Savior. For all these are effected in the elect and faithful by the Spirit of Christ, of all which graces baptism is the sacrament; so as in it this may rightly be said to be done, because truly and spiritually it is effected by the Spirit of Christ." If any think to object against me that Musculus speaks like this of those faithful, and so, doth not understand it of infants? I answer out of Musculus himself,[167] "All infants belonging to Christ, born of Christian parents, and being of the number of the faithful, are rightly said to be in the faith of Christ, to be faithful, and believers, although as yet they are not endowed with actual faith." Besides he that saith, "Christians being elect are, by the Holy Ghost engrafted into Christ, in baptism, must not exclude elect infants, forasmuch as none but infants are now usually baptized in the Church." Therefore he must be understood of what baptism ordinarily effects upon infants; or else his definition is very improper, yea, false, being applied to children, beside whom there are none (unless in some rare cases of proselytes) baptized in these latter times.

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[165] *Judico satis est, ut statuantur quod servan di sunt, eo quod per electionem & predestinationem ad peculim Dei pertineant; spiritu sancto profundi, qui radix est fidei, spei charitatis, & ommium virtutum, quos postea exerit & declarat, cum per atatem licet. Ibid. sect.14.*

[166] *Definiemus baptismum esse sacramentum regenerationis, purgationis, initiationis, sanctificationis, obsignationis, & incorporationis in Christum servatorem. Haec cuim omni no per spiritum Christi fiunt in electis & fidelibus quorum sacramentum est baptismus; ut rect in illo profici dicatur, quod per spiritum Christi rei ipsa & spiritualiter perficitr. Muscul. de bapt. quest.1 sect.8 Loc.com*

[167] *Omnes Christianorum infantes ad Christum pertimentes, deq numero fidelium existentes, recte dicuntur esse infide Christi fidelis & credentes, licet nondum sint imbuti fide. Musc. in Matthew 18.*

Francis Junius, in his *Theses of Paedobaptism* speaks as fully to this point, as any of the rest,[168] "If all the elect are to be baptized into the body of Christ, if moreover all of them, as well infants as persons of years ought to put on Christ, then to separate from the body of Christ and not to engraft them into Christ, were a most wicked thing." And again a little after,[169] "When infants (What infants he means, he had sufficiently expressed before*: viz. elect infants*) are baptized, God doth both offer, and confer all the good things of the covenant, and engageth himself unto it." In another place, he speaks in this way,[170] "Baptism is a sacred action of God washing those that are his own, inwardly, with the washing of the Spirit; outwardly, with the washing of water. (Matthew 3, John 1 and elsewhere) These two therefore, the water and the Spirit, the washing of water, and the washing of the Spirit are relatives. The relation itself is that application or union of these according to the nature of relatives, which constitutes the form of the *sacrament*. Wherefore as a man in human actions doth, with his soul and body produce both an inward and an outward action in one and the same operation, in which as the soul is said to be the form of the body, so is the inward action, after a sort; the formal; and the external, the material part of the action even so after the same manner God, by his Spirit and by water, performs both an internal and an external action, in one and the same operation; in which, the inward washing by the Spirit is the formal part; and the external washing with water, is the material part of that his action; according to that of John the Baptist, 'I indeed baptize you with water, but he that cometh after me shall baptize you with the Holy Ghost.'" This passage passing from that learned man in a scholastic confutation of a subtle adversary, is

[168] *Si enim in Christi corpus baptizandi omnes electi, si omnes Christum induere debent, infantes non secus ac adulti, eos a Christi corpore separare & Christo non inserere nefandum esset. Thes. 4.*

[169] *Cum baptizantur infantes Deus offert & confert omnia bona foederis & stipulatur. Ibid. Thes.10*

[170] *Baptismus est actio sacra Dei lavantis suos, intus, lotione spiritus, foris, lotione aquae, Matthew 3, John 1, et passim. Haec igitur relata sunt, aqua et spiritus, lotio aquae et lotio spiritus. Relatio ut est* σχέσις *illa, sive applicatio unius ad alteram secundum naturam relatorum, formam constituens sacramenti. Quemadmodum igitur homo in actionibus humanis, anima et corpore actionem internam et externam agit unica operatione, in qua, sicut anima est forma corporis, ita actio interna formalis quodammodo, externa vero materialis est; in eundem modum Deus spiritu suo et aqua agit actionem internam et externam unica operatione, in qua, lotio interna a spiritu formalis est; et materialis, externa, prout dicebat Ioannes: ego baptizo vos aqua, et cetera. Junius, in Exam. Gratian. Prosp., par. 3.*

perhaps more abstruse than it can be fully understood of an ordinary reader; yet all that are judicious cannot see less in it that this*: viz*. that in the judgment of Junius, that is not held for baptism of the elect, in which God doth not ordinarily accompany the outward administration of that sacrament with some inward work of the Spirit inwardly washing the soul, as well as the water outwardly washes the body, in the laver of regeneration.

But what manner of work that is, which is ordinarily performed by the Spirit, in the matter of regeneration, the same author also describes in the place first cited. There he distinguishes regeneration, and then explains himself in what sense he affirms elect infants to be regenerated in baptism,[171] "Touching regeneration, it is one way to be considered in the foundation, that is to say, in Christ the *habit* thereof; and another way, in us, in its act. The first regeneration (which may be termed a transplantation out of the old Adam into the new,) is as a cause; and the other followeth as its effect. Of the former, Christ speaks in John 3. The Apostle joins both together in Romans 6 with this (in other words the first) elect infants are regenerated when they are set into Christ, the obsignation of which is made over to them in the time in which they are baptized." So we see the point receiving clear testimony from this witness also, as full as can be desired, if all the passages of the author are laid together, and considered with impartial eyes.

In the next place let us inquire of Zanchius, what he thinks of this point. We are in part informed already what his judgment is. But this being the place which is proper for him to give his verdict, let us hear him more at large in his own words. He, in his confession of faith, speaks of baptism in the following manner,[172]

[171] *De regeneratione aliter consideratur in fundamento, id est, in Christo, habitu; aliter in nobis, actu. Prima regeneratio* (quae dici potest transplantatio a vetere Adamo in novum) *tanquam causa est, altera tanquam fructus sequitur. De prima loquitur Christus, John 3. Apostolus utramque coniungit, Romans 6. Hac regenerantur infantes electi cum Christo inseruntur, et huius obsignatio fit iis dum baptizantur. De Paedobapt., thes. 7.*

[172] *Baptismus primum novi faderis sacramentum est; quo cum omnes, qui vel penitentiam peccatorum professi, sidem etiam in Christum adeoq in Deum parre, filium, & spiritum sanctum profitentur, vel saltem propter parentum pietatem ad faedus pertinere creduntur, 1 Corinthians 7:14, tum maxime illi qui vere ad fadus pertinent, Christo tanquam ei iam per spiritum sanctum incorporati, obsignantur: ut non sint amplius sui juris, sed illius, per quem in faderis societatem, ceq. in unum corpus cum eo sanctisq omnibus, & in omnium spiritualium calestiumq, bonorum par-*

> "Baptism is the first sacrament of the new covenant in which all that either by repentance and profession of faith in Christ, and so in God the Father, the Son and Holy Ghost, or by reason of their parents' piety are believed to pertain to the covenant, (1 Corinthians 7:14) but especially they that do truly belong to the covenant, are sealed up for Christ, as being even then incorporated into him by the Holy Ghost: that they might no longer be in their own, but his, through whom they are said to be received into the society of the covenant, and so into one body with him and with all the saints, and into the participation of all spiritual and celestial blessings, (Acts 19:5, 1 Corinthians 6:19). By this baptism, as by the laver of regeneration, they are cleansed from their sins by the virtue of Christ's blood, and are buried with Christ into death: that as he rose again from the dead by the glory of the Father; even so we also should walk in newness of life. Whence also it is called the sacrament of repentance for remission of sin, the sacrament of faith, the badge of the covenant, the laver of regeneration."

So here we see an *efficacy of baptism*, and an *efficacy to regeneration*, even in *infants* also belonging truly and indeed to the covenant of grace, as well as to persons of years attaining to actual faith and repentance.

And lest any man should stumble at the ambiguity of some words used here, we may find Zanchius expressing himself almost in the same terms which I used at the beginning of this treatise, in the explication of my distinction of *initial*, and *actual* regeneration; for which those who term me a dreamer, must also take him (and the Fathers into the same number). For, he saith,[173] "Not unfitly do the Fathers teach, that effect of the Holy Ghost moving upon the waters, which

ticapationem, asciti esse dicuntur, Acts 19:5, 1 Corinthians 6:19. Per hunc baptismum tanquam per lavacrum regenerationis, a peccatis vi sanguinis Christi, mundati, & cum Christo consepulti in mortem: ut quemadmodum ille ressurexit a mortuis per gloriam patris, sic & nos in novitate vita ambulemus. Unde & sacramentum penitentia in remissionem peccatorum, sacramentum fidri symbolum federis, lavacrum regenerationis, apellari consicuit. Zanchius lib. Confess. cap. de baptismo sect.1

[173] *Non incongrue Patres docent effectum illum spiritus Domini, quem describit Moses in Genesis 1, typum fuisse illius quem praestat spiritus sanctus in aqua baptismi. Ut enim ibi incubabat aquis illis, et eas fovebat, animabat, praeparabatque ad* ζωογονίαν *rerumque omnium generationem; sic*

Moses describeth in Genesis 1 to be a resemblance of that which is, the Holy Ghost performeth in the water of baptism. For as there he rested upon those waters, that he might cherish and prepare them for the producing of living creatures, and for the generation of all things: so the Holy Ghost sits upon the waters of baptism, and sits as it were abroad upon them, and blesseth them, and thence doth cherish, regenerate, and animate the elect, and makes them fruitful unto all good works." The Holy Ghost then rests on the waters (not in the shape of a dove as some absurdly picture him; but yet truly in a spiritual manner, as best becomes him) and communicates himself there to elect infants, for, "producing of future actual," newness of life, not presently, but in due time and order, in them. It would be easy to add to this great cloud of witnesses, many more.[174] But I must of necessity contract myself; I will therefore mention only two more of this sort, and then draw nearer home to our own divines.

One of the two I mean to cite is Lambertus Daneus, an author of great learning and note in the Church, he, in his learned and fruitful commentary upon Saint Augustine's *Enchiridion*, chapter 52 (Where the Father quoting that of the Apostle in Romans 6, "we are buried with him by baptism into death," and avouching this belongs even to infants as well as to others;) allows Augustine's saying of being restrained to the elect, and understood only of initial regeneration, as I had occasion to note before. His own words are these, "Therefore little infants that are the elect of God, have faith and regeneration; although the work in it doth not yet appear to us: and those gifts they have, according to the condition of their age, that is to say, according to the capacity of the subject receiving the same."[175]

The other is that famous Vossius, now so much brought up of all learned men, he, in defense of the baptism of infants, after arguments to confirm the truth, adds answers to the principal objections of the

spiritus sanctus praesidet aquis baptismi, et eis quasi incubat, illisque benedicit, et inde electos fovet, regenerat, animat, faecundosque reddit ad bona opera. Zanchius, de Trib. Eloh., lib. 7, cap. 1.

[174] Occolompadius, Pareus, Marlorat, and Melanchthon.

[175] *Ergo & fide & regenerationem habent parvuli electi dei, etsi nondum illies opera nobis apparent: & ea dona habent pro ratione atatis, id dest, pro capacitate vasis.* See more touching the judgment of this author, in my answer to the 4th main objection against this position of baptismal grace.

Anabaptists pleading against it. And to that so often iterated cavil, that infants ought not to be baptized because they want faith, shapes this answer,[176] "It is of no validity which they urge, namely that unbelievers ought not to be baptized. For one may be said to be an unbeliever two ways, *viz*. negatively, so he that is indeed destitute of the habit of faith, yet is not polluted with the contrary habit of infidelity: or positively, as he that both wants the habit of faith and also labors under the contrary of unbelief. Infants are unbelievers only negatively; that is, they have not yet the habit of faith, of which they are not for the present capable. Notwithstanding, they are capable of the Spirit of faith, by which the soul receives a spiritual and supernatural being, and that is the principle or beginning of all spiritual operations, and is effectual in his due time, and remains in a man even when there is a cessation of the actions of it. If they were without this Spirit, infants could not be united to Christ, nor be made members of his mystical body, and so neither should they be partakers of the privileges of the Church which are contained in the creed. Although, therefore infants do not have actual faith, yet this ought no more to keep them off from baptism, than meat ought to be denied them, because the Apostle saith; he that will not work let him not eat."[177] Here we see an *initial regeneration* taken for granted, and so described, and so described also as there is no need of labor to draw it home to my present purpose.[178] Thus have I made good what I un-

[176] *Nec ullius est momenti quod aiunt, incredulos non esse baptizandos. Nam bifariam aliquis incredulus dicitur: negative, qui salutari fidei quidem habitu destituitur, non tamen contrario habitu est pollutus; positive autem, qui et habitu fidei caret, et contrario* ἀπιστίας *malo laborat. Infantes duntaxat negative sunt infideles, hoc est nondum habentes fidem, cuius ne quidem capaces sunt per naturam. Tamen capaces sunt spiritus fidei, per quem anima accipit esse spirituale ac supernaturale, estque principium operationum spiritualium suoque tempore est efficax, ac cessantibus etiam actionibus in homine manet. Absque hoc spiritu si essent parvuli, non unirentur Christo, nec mystici eius corporis membra forent; eoque nec participes essent privilegiorum ecclesiae, quae in symbolo commemorantur. Etsi igitur infantes non credant actu, tamen non magis hoc eos a baptismo arcere debet, quam cibus iis debet denegari, etsi ab Apostolo dictum sit: qui non vult laborare, non manducet. Gerard Vossius, Thes. Theol. de Paedobapt., par. 1, thes. 15, nuper editis.*

[177] 2 Thessalonians 3:10.

[178] Let the reader here be advised, that the Arminians are censured by the four public professors of Leiden for joining with that, that blasphemous wretch Socinius, and his disciples, in that they in their public confessions of their faith, make baptism to be only an external rite by which men are engrafted into the Church, and admitted to God's ordinances, without any obsignation, and real collation of grace in and upon the parties baptized. And although the remonstrance use some words that may seem to insinuate a purgation, a de-

dertook in producing the judgment of many foreign divines of best note in the Church. If any complain of length and tediousness in citing so many, let them consider that they are not a few that band themselves against this truth, and do not stick to give out in all places; that there is not one of all those authors which I have alleged that makes anything against me, rather than *for me*. Now let the equal and able reader judge concerning these things.

liverance from sin, and a donation of grace, yet those professors censure them because they speak of those things as that which is to be expected in time to come, and not begun at the time of baptism. See the confessions of the remonstrance at large, cap.23 sect.3. And its censure, page 304, where speaking of the former part of the remonstrance's description of baptism, they use these words, Siquidem prior plane Socinianizat, quatenus baptismum hoc uli tantum definiunt, Quod hoc publico & sacro rutu saderati per solemem aqua ablutionem ecclesia inferuntur, & cultui divino initiantur. Similia habent Sociniani in catech: *Racoviensi, quod sit ritus exterior quo homnes e judaisme vel gentilism ad religionem Christianam accedentes, manifeste profite bantur se Christum pro suo domino agnoscere. Presse eos insequitur episcopius disputatione de baptis. Quod sit ceremonia & ritus NT qui quo ii ad religionem Christianam accedunt, & exxlesia Jesu Christi publice accensuri cupiunt, aqua abluuntur, ad testandum vita male anteacta derelictionem, & vita malioris inchoationem. Ita ut ex parte Dei, nullam illi gratiz Dei in baptizatis obsignationem agnoscant.* Unde & Socinius lib: de offic: hom. Christ. cont. *Evangelicos afferit, baptismi sinem non esse, gratia Dei de remissione peccatorum per sanguinem Christi obsign itionem, sed tantum significationem nec fidei nostra & gratia Dei confirmationem, sed tantum professionem.* Paria 2 Socino suo episcopius, Thes. *9 Effectus sive finis baptismi, non est realis alique gratia collatio, sed sola tantum divine gratia & professionis nostra significatio.* Prior itaq: illa remonstrantium definitio plane socinum exprimit. And in page 306 thus the professors to the latter part of their definition, wherein they mention an inward purgation and donation of grace and glory, they thus censure the remonstrance. *Quum vero usus illos futuro tempore enunciant, nempe purgandi, liberandi, donandi vocibus, fi futura de continua actione accipiant, recte, sane, etc.*

CHAPTER VIII. The Judgment of Some Divines of Special Note in Our Own Church.

What judicious Hooker, Mr. Thomas Rogers; Dr. Ames, Mr. Ainsworth, and the author of the English commentary upon Saint Paul's epistle to Titus, have written touching this point, I have already shown in the third and fourth chapters of this treatise. It is evident that I am not the first[179] that have set openly this doctrine in the Church of England, nor the first English man that hath published this point to the world; although it is my hard providence to be the first challenged for it. I will not in this place repeat what hath been formerly produced out of any of these, nor yet keep you with a large view of all those that, on further search, might be added to these, to witness the same truth with them. It shall suffice that I allege only these 6. *viz*. Bishop Jewel, Dr. Whitaker, Dr. Francis White, now Lord Bishop of Norwich, Dr. Davenant, now Lord Bishop of Salisbury, Dr. Fulke, and the learned author of the *Second Parallels.*

1. I begin with that rare and much honored and admired Bishop Jewel, the first champion of our English Church, since the last happy reformation, that, (both by public apology for our refusing to communicate any longer with the present Romish synagogue, and also by open challenge made to that side, for proving their principal tenets now in difference between us, to have been so much as known to the ancient Fathers for the doctrine of truth, within the first six hundred years after Christ;) entered the lists with that great Goliath, in the name of the Church of England, and came off so happily, that all that wish well to the truth, do, to this day, (and forever shall) call him *blessed*. What testimony and approbation this worthy man's works frequently received from our late learned Mr. James, they, who last published Bishop Jewel's works, in their epistle dedicatory, to give public witness; *viz*., "That they have long and frequently upon all occasions had a most singu-

[179] *Nam multi protestantes etsi non fidem actualem infantibus tribuunt, tamen inclinationes quasdam bonas, novosque motus in pueris esse dicunt cum baptizantur. Whitak. de sacram. cont. de bapt. quest.4 cap.5 in princ.*

lar testimony and approbation of his majesty for the most rare and admirable works that have been written in this last age of the world." And what general acceptance they find in the whole Church of England, is evident by this, that every parish in England is enjoined to buy them, and to have them open the parish Churches, for all that desire instruction in the truth, to read and peruse. And lastly, what extraordinary approbation he received from the most judicious and eminent divines beyond the seas, their frequent epistles and dedication of books unto him (of which we may read in the history of his life) amply declare. Therefore I think that what I allege out of him may be justly received (if not as the doctrine itself of the Church of England, yet) as that which no judicious son of this Church will refuse as dissonant from, much less repugnant to the public doctrine of our Church, but as most agreeable both to it, and unto the truth of God maintained in it.

This Chariot of Israel and Father of our Church, in his *Apology of the Church of England* (which was first written in Latin and translated almost into all languages, for the great esteem it received in all Churches of God,) speaking of the sacraments, and denying transubstantiation in the Lord's Supper, saith this, "And in speaking in this way we do not mean to abase the Lord's Supper, or to teach that it is but a cold ceremony only, and nothing to be wrought therein, (as many falsely slander us that we teach.) For we affirm that Christ doth truly and presently give himself in his Sacraments. In baptism that we may put him on and in his Supper that we may eat him by faith and Spirit, and may have everlasting life by his cross and blood. And we say not, this is done slightly or coldly, but effectually and truly."[180] Now, in this passage this renowned prelate makes no difference between the efficacy of the sacraments; he allows of a presence of Christ in the one, as well as in the other: he professeth that in baptism Christ is as truly put on, as he is fed upon in the Supper: and when he saith

[180] *Nec tamen cum ista dicimus, extenuamus coenam Domini, aut eam frigidam tantum ceremoniam esse dicimus, ut in ea nihil fieri, quod multi nos docere calumniantur. Christum enim asserimus vere sese praesentem exhibere in sacramentis suis: in baptismo, ut eum induamus; in coena, ut eum fide et spiritu comedamus, et de eius cruce ac sanguine habeamus vitam aeternam; idque dicimus non perfunctorie et frigide, sed re ipsa et vere fieri.* In Bishop Jewel's works last set forth, you shall find this in English in the Defence of the Apology, cap. 14, divis. 1, page 269.

that in the Supper he is fed upon by faith and the Spirit, saying no such thing of the necessity of faith for *putting on of Christ in baptism*, when an infant is baptized: he plainly yields that in the baptism of infants that truly and indeed belong to God, Christ is *truly and indeed put on*, although they are not endowed with actual faith, which is required of persons grown to years of discretion. And when M. Harding quarreled him for this, and charged him of error, "in making the presence of Christ in baptism, like to his presence in the Supper." He answers in this way,[181] "Here is one error more than any of the learned Catholic Fathers ever noted." Saint Chrysostom saith, "In the sacrament of baptism we are made flesh of Christ's flesh, and bone of his bones." Saint Bernard saith, *Lavemur in sanguine eius*, "Let us be washed in his blood." Leo saith: *Christi sanguine rigaris quando in mortem ipsius baptizaris*, "Thou art washed in the blood of Christ, when thou art baptized into his death." By these few it may appear that Christ is present at the sacrament of baptism, as he is present at the holy supper; "unless ye will say, we may be made flesh of Christ's flesh, and be washed in his blood, and be partakers of him, and have him present without his presence." Therefore Chrysostom, when he had spoken vehemently of the Sacrament of the Supper, he concludes in this way, *Sic & in baptismo*, "even so it is also in the sacrament of baptism. The body of Christ is likewise present in them both." And for that cause Beda saith (and he saith it out of Saint Augustine,) *nulli est aliquatenus ambigendum, tunc unumquemque fidelium corporis sanguinisque Dominici participem fieri, quando in baptismate membrum Christi efficitur*, "No man may doubt, but every faithful man is then made partaker of the body and blood of Christ, when in baptism he is made the member of Christ." All this B. Jewel urgeth out of the Fathers, and by approving their doctrine, confounds his adversary. If any question is made of the word *faithful*, I have sufficiently showed how that is to be taken. And if Saint Augustine is not mistaken, he tells us that even, "Infants were reckoned among the faithful."[182] There is never any question among the Fathers in any age of the Church, but that

[181] *Defense of Apology, page 264. Chrysostom in Epistle ad Ephesians hom.20. Bernard, supermissus est. hom.3. Leo in serm. de 4 feria c.1.*

[182] Ubi ponis parvulos nonbaptizatos, profecto innumero credentium. De verb Apost. Serm.1.

elect infants received remission of sin, in baptism; and by consequent, regeneration, for as much as these two are inseparable. All this, that reverend Jewel, very well knows; yet is not afraid to subscribe to their doctrine. Yes, in the same apology, he particularly delivers his judgment concerning infants like this, "We say that baptism is a sacrament of the remission of sins, and of that washing which we have in the blood of Christ. And that no person that will profess Christ's name, ought to be restrained or kept back therefrom; no not the very babes of Christians, as they are born in sin, and do pertain unto the people of God."[183] I think his words are plain enough to prove that infants partake of remission of sin in baptism, because, he saith, "baptism is a sacrament of remission," and because infants are to be baptized on this ground, *viz*., (not only because they are part of God's heritage, but) upon this ground, that they are born in sin. Now, if they ought to be baptized to remission of sin, because they are born in sin, will any man, perfect in mind, conclude other than this; therefore they partake of remission of sin in baptism.

I imagine that some will be ready to pull me by the sleeve, and say, "I pray, Sir, look again," Bishop Jewel, "calls baptism the *sacrament of remission*, not remission itself. And this he may do, yet never hold remission of sins to be conferred in baptism of infants; but only that it is a seal of that grace hereafter to be conferred, when by faith they apply the same?"

Indeed so, Mr. Harding the papist[184] would needs understand him, charging him and the rest of the Protestants with speaking too slenderly of baptism, in that they call it a sacrament of remission. If you will believe him, they mean that it is only a sign or token, or at best only a seal of our new birth; and not believing with the Catholic Church, according to the Scriptures, "that in and by baptism sins are fully and truly remitted, and put away." All this Mr. Harding would father on our Church, but make a note here that Jewel puts in the margin (page 217) over against the calumny of Harding. *viz. untruth*. He uses the word because we do not say this and it is untrue.

[183] Defense chap.11 divis.3 pag.216.

[184] See in B. Jewel, Ibid page 217.

And where Mr. Harding is pleased to go on in his railing vein, professing that the Church believes that remission of sins is given in baptism,[185] and that, not, "through the faith only of the giver or receiver, or of any other, (though hereunto it be necessary in those that become to age of discretion;) but through the power and virtue of the sacrament, and God's promise." Bishop Jewel, to the word *faith*, gives this note in the margin, "This tale is needless, and out of season." As if he should say, in the baptism of infants, we do not require faith, but rely only on God's promise. For so, more at large in his answer to Harding, he explains himself. First, he grants it as a truth, "that the sacrament dependeth, neither of the minister, nor of the receiver, nor of any other: for though they are all children of sin, yet is baptism the sacrament of remission of sin." The place he quotes is out of Saint Augustine, which speaks his mind plainly, that he depends Upon Christ himself for the efficacy of baptism, and not on the faith of the receiver, if he is an infant, of which only the question between him and Harding was (by Harding himself) given, who chargeth the Protestants with denying the present efficacy of baptism unto remission of sins upon infants, for lack of actual faith.

Notwithstanding, because the adversary is so brag and confident that the Fathers did not stand upon faith in the baptizing of infants, the Bishop is pleased a little to take down his pride, and to discover his ignorance in the Fathers, and shows out of Saint Augustine and Saint Jerome, that to the intent baptism might be effectual unto infants, they thought it requisite that the faith of their parents should then be employed on their behalf, and be imputed to them. But yet, for his own part, he professes his dissent from that opinion, although, it might be further backed out of Justin Martyr, Saint Cyprian, and Saint Jerome. For thus they write, he saith, "How truly, I will not say. But their words are plain. The Prophet Habakkuk saith, *Justus ex fide vivet*, the just man shall live (not by the faith of his parents, but) by his own faith." Then he approveth a speech of Augustine more consonant to the truth, affirming that, "Infants have faith of their own, because they have baptism which is the sacrament of faith;"[186] for he saith*; quemad-*

[185] *Ibid.*

[186] Habent fidem propter fidei sacramentum. Epist.23 ad Bonif.

modum sacramentum corporis Christi, secundum quendam modum, corpus Christi est, ita sacramentum fidei fides est. As the sacrament of Christ's body (not verily and indeed, but) after a certain manner of speech, is Christ's body. So baptism *is* faith, because it is, "the sacrament of faith." Therefore Jewel saith Cardinal Caietane is worthily blamed by Catharinus, in that he saith, "An infant for that he lacketh instruction in faith, therefore hath not perfect baptism." Out of all which I can pick no other English but this: There is no necessity that we should hold a necessity of faith in infants. Yet, if they have any, it is but improperly so called, it is that, not which they have brought with them to the sacrament, but that which they are reputed to receive in the sacrament itself. And this, in effect, is the very doctrine of Calvin,[187] set forth at large in the former chapter*: viz*. that it is not requisite always that a Christian should bring grace to baptism, to make him capable of the grace of baptism; but he must come to baptism that there he may receive it, if he is not of years; as he that is of years, receives a confirmation of that which was wrought in him before. And so much is this same Bishop in his reply to Mr. Harding's answer*, article 1 div. 13* (of which place we shall perhaps have fitter occasion afterwards to speak) in effect declares this also.

For the present, you see, that whatever becomes of the faith of infants, he joins with Catharinus in condemning of Caietane denying, "infants to be perfectly baptized for lack of instruction in faith." Then, he expresses that, as the ancient Fathers did, so doth he hold baptism to be efficacious; yet not the outward element, but the Spirit of Christ doth the deed when it is effected. In brief, he doth not deny the thing to be conferred even on infants, but only the manner which the Romanists contend for. They say that the blood and Spirit of Christ is in the very outward element, by the consecration of the Priest, as the virtue of healing is natural in a medicine, and that *ex opere operato*, by virtue of the bare outward administration of that sacrament every one partakes certainly and indeed of the inward grace. This, the founding Fathers disclaimed, as we have proved at large, and this Bishop Jewel makes good out of them, against his adversary, that the inward grace comes from God immediately, and not from the water, or out-

[187] Instit lib.4 cap.16 sect.21 compared with other passages in the same chapter.

ward act of the minister. In sum, he in this way completes the whole matter, "As for that Mr. Harding here toucheth as an error defended by certain, I do not know by whom, that baptism giveth not full remission of sins, he may command it home again to Lovain amongst his fellows, and join it with others of his and their vanities. For it is no part, nor portion of our doctrine. We confess and have evermore taught that in the sacrament of baptism, by the death and blood of Christ is given remission of all manner of sins: and that not in half, or in part, or by way of imagination, or by fancy, but full, whole, and perfect of all together: so that now, as Saint Paul saith, "there is no condemnation to them that be in Christ Jesus."[188]

I hope no man duly considering the controversy between him and Harding will have the face to say that the Bishop doth not speak this of present efficacy of baptism, but of that which at actual conversion is to be expected. For, the thing of which Harding complains is this, that we deny the present efficacy of baptism, and make it, "only a sign, or at best but a seal," to confirm future grace until we have attained actual faith. And the answer, what it is, you now see*: viz*. that we allow and teach that in baptism is given full remission of all sins; which if the Bishop should not mean of the present effect of baptism, his adversary might justly complain for want of answer to his unjust complaint.

Thus much then, we have gained out of this judicious Father, that, at least, remission of sins is ordinarily communicated to infants, in their baptism, when it is administered. And, if remission of sins is then given, it must necessarily be yielded further, that he held that, the Spirit of God is communicated, then also, to infants, for the applying of that benefit unto them. Therefore in the very same place, he quoteth a passage of Cyprian to this purpose*; Remission peccatorum*, "The remission of sins, whether it be given by baptism or by any other sacraments, is indeed of the Holy Ghost: and to the same Holy Ghost only the privilege of this work doth appertain. The solemnity of the words and the invocation of God's holy name, and the outward signs appointed to the ministry of the priests, by the Apostolical institutions, work the visible outward sacrament, but touching on its

[188] Defense of Apology, page 219.

substance (which is the remission of sins) it is the Holy Ghost that worketh it.[189] Likewise, saith Saint Jerome, *Homo aquam tantum tribuit*, The minister being a man, giveth only the water, but God giveth the Holy Ghost, whereby the sins be washed away."[190]

If any passionate opposite should be so far transported, as to object, that all that have been here spoken out of Bishop Jewel, tends only to prove that remission of sin is given to infants in baptism, which is another thing from the present point of regeneration. Therefore you say that this is nothing to our purpose since he did not cover both topics?

I answer, first, that this objection is so silly that it deserves no answer; for what author ever taught plenary remission of all sins to be given to him, that doth not in some measure partake of the Spirit unto sanctification? Was it ever known that these two were separated? Why then is it required that our Author should in express terms affirm both; or else, be denied to allow of both, although he expressly proved it of the one of them? He had no occasion to speak directly touching regeneration, nor could he well do it, without digression. For the question between him and his antagonist was only touching the present efficacy of baptism unto the remission of sin. If therefore he should have fallen on the other, he should idly have run out of his way, and fallen upon another controversy not so much as named by the adverse party.

Notwithstanding, that I may not leave the least shadow of an argument unanswered, secondly, I add that, the same author, in his[191] *Treatise of the Sacrament*, affirms the efficacy of baptism unto regeneration also. For of baptism in particular, he thus speaks, "Baptism is our regeneration or new birth, by which we are born anew in Christ, and are made the sons of God, and heirs of the kingdom of heaven, it is the sacrament of the remission of sins, and of that washing which we have in the blood of Christ." And a little after, among other places of Holy Scripture by him alleged, for proof hereof, he brings that of our Savior in John 3, "Except a man be born of water and of the Spirit,

[189] Defense of Apology, page 218. De baptismo Christi.

[190] In Esaiam cap.4

[191] You shall find this treatise at the end of Bishop Jewel's work of the first edition from page 261 to the end.

he cannot enter into the kingdom of God;" and then addeth, "for this cause are infants baptized, because they are born in sin, and cannot become spiritual, but by this new birth of the water and the Spirit. They are heirs of the promise; the covenant of God's favor is made unto them."[192]

It is very true that in the very next page, he speaks of the necessity of faith in some that are baptized: for thus he saith,[193] "It is the Covenant and promise, and mercy of God, which clothed us with immortality, assureth our resurrection, by which we receive regeneration, forgiveness of sins, life, and salvation. His word declareth his love towards us. That word is sealed and made good by baptism. Our faith which are baptized, and our continuance in the profession which we have made, establisheth in us this grace which we receive, as it is said,[194] *Verus baptismus constat non tam*. True baptism doeth not stand so much in washing of the body, as in the faith of the heart. As the doctrine of the Apostles hath taught us saying; 'by faith purifying their hearts,' (Acts 15:9) and in another place; 'baptism saveth us, not the putting away the filth of the flesh, but the examining of a good conscience before God, by the resurrection of Jesus Christ,' (1 Pet. 3:21). Therefore Jerome saith; 'they that receive not baptism with perfect faith, receive the water, but the Holy Ghost they receive not.'"

But this no way is a good argument against our position touching the efficacy of baptism upon infants. For make a note, first, of whom he speaks those words; not universally of all that are baptized, but only of persons of years. For having in page 265 shown the efficacy of baptism upon infants, at the foot of that page he makes a transition of his speech from infants, and comes on to declare the efficacy it hath upon others also. His words are these, "And as the children of the faithful by right ought to be baptized: so such others also as were born of unbelieving parents, and were aliens from the commonwealth of Israel, and were strangers from the covenant of promise, and had no hope if they acknowledge the error in which they lived, and seek the forgiveness of their former sins, may well receive this sacrament

[192] Page 265.

[193] Page 266.

[194] De consecrat. dist. 4. Verus.

of their regeneration. So, when they which heard Peter, were pricked in their hearts, and said to Peter and the other Apostles: "Men and brethren what shall we do," Peter said unto them, "Amend your lives, and be baptized every one of you in the name of Jesus Christ for the remission of sins. They were buried with Christ by baptism into his death, and made partakers of his blood, and continued in the Apostle's doctrine and fellowship." Then he goes on with his discourse of these, in the words before cited out of the 266th page. Now in all this there is not one word of infants, of whom he had spoken before; and so that passage cannot be taken as a denial of the efficacy of baptism in any without faith, except only in persons of years. And if this were not in this way to be understood, he should directly contradict all that he had before spoken of the regeneration of infants, in whom there is no actual faith, by his own confession, in his defense against Harding, as I have shown before. And to make this yet more clear that he certainly believed that infants receive some principle of regeneration in baptism, although not actual renovation of the whole man, see what he saith afterwards in the same *Treatise of the Sacraments*, touching on the state of infants baptized, and of the care of parents in their education, "God saith, your children are my children. They are sons of God. They are born anew, and well shapen in beautiful proportion: do not make them monsters. He is a monster whosoever doth not know God. By you they are born into the world, be careful also that by your means they may be begotten unto God, you are careful to train them up in nature and comely behavior of the body, seek also to fashion their minds unto godliness. You have brought them to the fountain of baptism to receive the mark of Christ: bring them up in knowledge, and watch over them that they are not lost. So shall they be confirmed and will keep the promise they have made, and will grow up unto perfect age in Christ."[195] He saith, "they are born anew;" and yet bids parents to be careful that, "they may be begotten unto God." Therefore he well discerned the distinction of *initial* and *actual* regeneration. This is our first answer, and this is abundantly sufficient. However, secondly, I pray mark, in those words of his that are found in page 266, that even those that have faith, if they are such

[195] Page 282.

as were baptized in infancy, are not then said to receive the grace of baptism when they have faith, as if that were the first time of their reception of grace: but only then they come to be assured and confirmed sensibly and evidently in that which before, in their baptism, they received, for so he speaks in express terms, "Our faith which are baptized, and our continuance in the profession which we have made, establisheth in us this grace which we receive." And so in his reply to Harding, Article 1, division 13, page 27 to the same effects, he speaks of persons of years that, "their conjunction and incorporation into Christ is first begun and wrought by faith." And then, "the same incorporation is assured unto them and increased in baptism. But yet well knowing that it is otherwise with us that were baptized in our infancy, he presently remembers a place of Saint Augustine touching on the baptism of infants,[196] *Ad hoc baptisma valet*, "To this availeth baptism, that men being baptized may be incorporated into Christ and made his members.""Now this must necessarily be meant of such as are baptized in infancy, or else it were directly contrary to his own assertion immediately preceding, wherein he saith that some are, "incorporated by faith," and that, "incorporation is assured them afterwards in baptism:" and then produceth this of Augustine, which affirms us by baptism, "to be incorporated into Jesus Christ." Therefore he goes on to show of what use the other holy mysteries are unto us that were baptized in infancy, on this manner, "And for that we are very imperfect of ourselves, and therefore must daily proceed forward, that we may grow into a perfect man in Christ, therefore hath God appointed that the same incorporation should be often renewed and confirmed in us by the uses of the holy mysteries (which cannot be meant of baptism, for that may not be repeated). In which must be considered, that the said holy mysteries do not begin, but rather they continue and confirm this incorporation." All this which he speaks (of the use of the holy mysteries, after incorporation), not of baptism, as if either we were ordinarily, by means, first made members and then baptized. Or yet, were not members, although baptized, till by faith we actually apprehend Christ on our parts; (for then, woe to all infants that die in infancy) but he speaks directly of the Lord's Supper,

[196] Augustine, Baptismo par vul.

when he saith, "those mysteries do not begin, but rather continue and confirm this incorporation." And this is clear by the very next clause following: "First of all, we ourselves must be the body of Christ, and afterwards we must receive the sacrament of Christ's body: as it is well noted by Saint Augustine, *Corpus Christi si vis intelligere*, "If thou wilt understand the body of Christ, hear what Saint Paul saith to the faithful: Ye are the body and the members of Christ. Your mystery is set on the Lord's Table, ye receive the mystery of the Lord." To conclude then, the sum of all is but only this much. It is not the bare receiving of the Lord's Supper, as[197] Mr. Harding dreamed, that makes us members of Christ: but all that partake of that ordinance were first made members of Christ by faith, if they were such as were not baptized in their infancy, but converted first by the word from *Gentilism*, and then baptized; for to such baptism also is a confirmation of their incorporation. But unto all others, baptism is the first ordinary means that initiates us into Christ; and we, from that time, grow up to more and more perfection in his body; then we partake of the mystery of the Lord's Supper, in which we by it are yet further nourished and confirmed in the body of Christ. So as Mr. Harding shot beside the mark when he contends that the sacrament of the Lord's Supper first unites us unto Christ. And this is all that the Bishop aimed at in all these words.

In the next place, we come to Dr. Whitaker, whom none but a corrupt Barrowist or Thomsonian will refuse to honor among men of the greatest parts and highest worth. He in that learned *Treatise of the Sacraments* however, denies all manner of efficacy to be in the sacraments *ex opere operato*, by virtue of the mere external administration of the sacrament. Yet he everywhere disclaims as an intolerable calumny, that which Bellarmine and the rest of that crew do not cease to lay to our charge*: viz*. that we make the sacraments, and particularly baptism to be without all efficacy at the time of administration. Or that, "we will have sin to be only pared, and not wholly taken away in baptism in respect of the guilt of it. For sin is not only shaven or

[197] Mr. Harding pleaded that we are made one body with Christ, in the sacrament of the Lord's Supper; as appears in the place cited. This, Bishop Jewel denies, saying that some are engrafted first, by faith; others by baptizm, but none by the Lord's Supper. For they must be of his body before they can take of that sacrament.

clipped (as some young thing newly sprout up, which though it be cut, yet the root still stays behind and will presently spring up afresh again, may be said to be) as those absurd objectors imagine us to hold: but we obtain a double benefit in baptism: the first is remission of sins; the second is regeneration. Remission of sins is perfect: regeneration, in respect of the remainders of sins, and of original sin, that for substance still abideth in us, is then only inchoate, or but in the beginning."[198]

Nor doth he speak this only of persons of years, (that can have neither of these, without actual faith to apprehend them, as he proves strongly and at large, in the first part of that *Tractate*.[199] He affirms it also of infants, that some of them, *viz*. the elect, are partakers of these graces in their baptism; as may be seen in sundry passages of his book collated. For make note, when Bellarmine objecteth that some reap benefit by the sacrament without actual faith, and particularly, infants in their baptism, it is Doctor Whitaker's constant answer, not simply to deny that proposition, but to deny it in two respects only*: viz*. 1. If the proposition is understood of all infants, because all are not saved that are baptized. 2. If it is meant that they partake of these graces merely by virtue of the outward work done, or that the outward element should be thought to contain in it any efficacy to convey these graces to any infant at all. Then also he rejects it as false. But otherwise he admits it to be true. So doth he receive the Council of Nicaea,[200] so the Milevitan Council,[201] which speaks expressly of infants thus*: Little children who yet cannot commit any actual sins of their own, are therefore*

[198] *De sacram. Controv. de baptis. question 4, cap.1. Calumniatur ergo Ballarminus: & sic etiam patres tridentini qui aiunt nondicere, peccarum tantum radi in baptismo, non tolli: quod olim Augustino pelagiani obiicerunt, quorum ille calumniam diluit Non enim paccatum in baptismo tanquam novacula recatur, sic ut radex hareat, & statim renascatur quemadmodum isti insuksines sentire putant; sed nosia Baptismo dupiecem gratiam consequmum prima est remissio peccatorum secunda, regeneratio. Remissio est parecta regeneratio incoara propter peccati rebquias, & propter originate peccatum, quod in nobis perpetus quoad suam substantiam remanet.*

[199] De sacram in gener. question 4, cap.3

[200] *Ibid., cap. 2, page 72.*

[201] *Ibid., cap. 2, page 73. Tertium testimonium sumitur ex Concilio Milevitano. Parvuli qui nihil peccatorum in semetipsis adhuc committere potuerunt, ideo in remissionem peccatorum veraciter baptizantur; ut in eis regeneratione mundetur quod generatione traxerunt. Respondeo, baptismum esse sacramentum regenerationis, etiam in parvulis, non negamus, sed non ex opere operato. Deus operatur libere, et in baptismo sanctificat quos vult, &c.*

truly baptized for the remission of sins, that so that filth which they have contracted by generation, might be purged out by regeneration. True, he saith, we do not deny baptism to be the sacrament of regeneration even to infants, but not by virtue of the external work done. Yea, but (you will say) he denies this to be done in all infants? True; and so do I. But, of what sort are they that he admits to partake of the efficacy of baptism? Surely none but the elect. For so he saith*: In baptism, as God doth signify the remission of sins and salvation, so indeed He works the same. And the truth of the thing is entwined together with the sign, in the elect*. Again: Wherefore it is false that Bellarmine affirms that infants with us are baptized, only that they might become members of the visible Church, for neither were the infants of the Jews circumcised only for that reason; but that the sign of God's covenant might be stamped on them, which although it profit not such as are neither regenerated nor predestinated, notwithstanding it is available in the elect, in such manner as is well known to God. For such infants as being elected, do die in infancy, God renews by the power of His Spirit. But if it happens that they live, they are thereby the more incited to the study of renovation, the badge of which they then come to know that they received in infancy. Therefore although they are baptized infants, yet they will not always remain such, but at length, if they live, they will feel the force of that baptism, which in their infancy they did receive.[202] And yet again, to that objection of Bellarmine that, "infants are saved without actual faith, by baptism alone," he answers by denying that, "only baptism saves them; for," he saith, "many infants do perish that are baptized,"[203] and a littler after, "If that were true, which Bellarmine affirmeth that infants are saved only by baptism, then all that are bap-

[202] *Tum si verum sit quod Bellarminus ait, infantes per solum sacramentum servari, tum omnes qui baptizantur servarentur. Verum alia causa est, propter quam servantur infantes, nempe divina bonitas, gratia, electio, non solus baptismus. Ibid., quaest. 4, cap. 3, pages 88-89.*

[203] Thus Bernard made good against Hugo of St. Victor, under the person of another inquiring whether infants can be saved without baptism, Epistle 77. And even Gabriel Biel, in 4 Sent., dist. 4, quaest. 2, dub. 2, was not afraid to affirm as much, although a popish schoolman, saying: *Voluit* (Deus) *itaque remedia instituere contra morbum peccati in Ecclesia, per sacramenta dispensanda, his qui noti esse poterant Ecclesiae. Eorum vero qui nondum in lucem notitiae prodierunt remedia in sua potestate sola constituit; quos cum voluerit sine exteriori remedio et sanctificare et salvare potest, sicut factum de quibusdam scriptura testatur. Insuper quod paucis in privilegium factum est, potest quibuscumque voluit impartiri, qui potentiam suam sacramentis non alligavit.*

tized should be saved. But there is another cause also of the salvation of infants, *viz*., God's goodness, grace, and election." By all which is evident that Dr. Whitaker, ever restrained the efficacy of baptism to the elect only, and unto them he never denied it.

And that he meant some present work of the Spirit to be wrought upon elect infants in the act of baptism, will appear further by his approving of all that the ancient Fathers have spoken touching this point. Now, we know that they were all for a present efficacy of baptism even upon infants as well as others, as before hath been declared. I will not repeat what I have there alleged; only I will add one place more out of St. Augustine. "It is no fable that we say remission of sins is given in the baptism, even of infants, nor is it said only to make a show, but it is truly done."

This is not disliked, but both this and all the speeches of the Fathers produced by Bellarmine, are approved by our author, being rightly understood, *viz*., not as if they held that the outward elements could convey this to every infant by virtue of the outward work done; but that the grace of baptism comes immediately from God, and is wrought by the Spirit, as he declareth out of Basil. Yes, he is not afraid to add, that, "however Calvin and Luther were pleased to say that some things were spoken by the Fathers hyperbolically, and that sometimes we shall meet with advancing of the sacraments beyond measure, in their writings, which no doubt they took liberty to do, merely to preserve them from contempt, and to prefer them before the sacraments of the Jews, notwithstanding to say the truth, there is not one of all those places quoted by Bellarmine, but will admit of a good construction, without any hyperbole at all".[204] So he saith. And if we observe how, everywhere, he expounds them, we shall find him in this way to describe them; *viz*., that what they say must be not taken as intending to place any efficacy in the outward element; nor, that grace is given to any but to the elect; and to them, not by virtue of the outward baptism outwardly administered, but the immediate operation of the Spirit, in that ordinance, as both the places already

[204] *Et quanquam Lutherus et Calvinus scribunt, quaedam dici a Patribus* ὑπερβολικῶς, *et esse immodica quaedam apud illos encomia sacramentorum, ut sic non esse contemnenda, et esse Iudaicis meliora docerent: tamen re vera nullum est ex omnibus testimoniis, quae Bellarminus offert, quod non satis commode sine hyperbole exponi potest. Ibid., ut immediate supra, page 74.*

alleged, together with many more, too long to recite in this place, do sufficiently prove.

Moreover, when he comes professedly to treat of the efficacy of baptism, and of the faith of infants, he first avoucheth that, "many Protestant Divines, however they do not ascribe actual faith to infants, yet they affirm that certain good inclinations and new motions are wrought in them, when they are baptized."[205] Which opinion he doth not, I confess, take into his protection, because he hath afterwards occasion given him to disclaim that imputation cast on Protestants by Bellarmine, that they ascribe actual faith to infants (which, he acknowledges, to have once unadvisedly fallen from Luther;) and to make it good that infants do not receive so much as the *habit* of that or any other particular grace, in baptism, as the Papists contend. Howbeit, in that very passage he declares enough to clear me of novelty, for as much as many Divines have gone further than I have done. For they that affirm that in baptism, there are some good inclinations and new motions in infants, must necessarily acknowledge the reception of the Spirit, by which those motions are infused; and so they affirm all that I do, and so much more. And thus that mirror of learning, Philip Melanchthon, held, in his *Common Place of Baptism*, as our author also hath observed before me. And this those Divines use to term *seminal* or *potential grace.*

But why should I stand beating of many bushes? In the chapter now last cited, Dr. Whitaker speaks plainly enough, for having spoken somewhat of Calvin's opinion touching the work of grace in infants, he proceeds to Peter Martyr, whose opinion he first briefly, yet fully, sets down, then, explains it and embraceth it as the truth. In substance he writes,[206] "Peter Martyr, a man of most profound judgment,

[205] *Nam multi Protestantes, etsi non fidem actualem infantibus tribuunt, tamen inclinationes quasdam bonas, novosque motus in pueris esse dicunt, cum baptizantur. De Sacram. Controv. Bapt. Quaest. 4, cap. 5.*

[206] *Petrus Martyr vir gravissimi iudicii ait se non audere eorum sententiam amplecti, qui fidem tribuunt infantibus; non quin Deus iis infundere fidem possit, si velit, et rationem producere in eorum mentibus ante naturae tempus, et efficere, ut quanquam ipsi non intelligant neque cognoscant quae creduntur, tamen spiritus sanctus in iis apprehendat illa et illis consentiat; ut dicitur idem spiritus nobis nescientibus intercedere pro nobis et orare quemadmodum oportet, et Deum, cum noverit eius sensum, illum audire. Tamen cum scriptura non dicat parvulos credere, neque hoc videat esse necessarium ad salutem, satis esse indicat, ut dicamus eos qui servantur, cum sint de peculio Domini per praedestinationem et electionem, spiritu sancto perfundi, qui radix est fidei, spei*

saith, he doth not dare embrace their opinion, that ascribe faith to infants; not but that God can if He will, infuse faith into them, and enable them to reason before the ordinary time; and cause, that though they do neither understand, nor know the things which are to be believed, notwithstanding the Spirit, in them, may apprehend and give consent to those things, for them, as the Spirit is said to make intercession for us to God, even when we do not know what to pray for, as we ought; and then God, who knows the mind of the spirit, hears the same. However, seeing the Scriptures do not say that infants do believe, nor doth this seem necessary to them unto salvation, he thinks it sufficient that we say that they who are saved, (for as much as they are part of God's peculiar by predestination and election;) are endowed with the Holy Ghost, who is the root of faith, hope, and charity, and all other virtues which afterward he produceth and declares in God's children, when they come to years." In this way he vouches the words of Peter Martyr; then he goes on in his own words to illustrate the same, "They may therefore be called faithful, or believers, as they may be said to be reasonable creatures. For, although infants cannot rationally discourse, yet they have a soul, whereby, when they come to some years, they may be able to discourse. So that, they are called reasonable creatures, not because they have present use of their reasonable faculty, but by reason of the principle of reason in them; in other words, the reasonable soul, which is capable of all arts and sciences. Therefore, (we say) express faith is required in all of years, but in infants, only faith begun or in his first principle or root, namely the Holy Ghost, with which they are endowed, and from whom faith and other graces, in due time, do flow and issue forth. For infants are purged by the Spirit, seeing they are in the Church, and of the Church. Christ sanctified His Church, purging it in the laver of water through

et charitatis, et omnium virtutum, quas postea exerit et declarat in filiis Dei, cum per aetatem licet. Posse ergo sic dici fideles, ut dicuntur rationales. Nam etsi non possunt infantes ratiocinari, tamen animam habent ea facultate praeditam, ut possint, cum aetas accesserit, ratiocinari; ergo rationales dicuntur, non propter praesentem usum rationis, sed propter insitum principium rationis, nempe animam, quae artium et doctrinarum omnium capax est. Fidem igitur expressam requiri in adultis; in parvulis sufficere fidem inchoatam in suo principio et radice, id est spiritu sancto, quo praediti sunt, ex quo fides suo tempore et virtutes aliae manant; nam infantes a spiritu purgari, cum sint in Ecclesia, et ad Ecclesiam pertineant; Ecclesiam autem Christus sanctificavit, mundans eam lavacro aquae per verbum. Si ad Ecclesiam pertinent, spiritu ornantur; si in caelum recipiuntur, a peccato purgantur, et cetera.

the Word. If then they belong to the Church, they are adorned with the Spirit; if they are received up into heaven, they are then purged by the Spirit."

The former passage is abundantly sufficient both to prove that I have not abused Peter Martyr and that Dr. Whitaker is fully of the same judgment with him. Yet let me have leave (since I promised much out of this author) to allege a place or two more to the same purpose. In the[207] next page following what we last cited, answering that of Bellarmine, who objecteth that Christ is said to dwell in infants by faith, and therefore they must necessarily have the habit of faith. He answers, "But this may as well be understood of actual faith (which Bellarmine denies to be in them) as of the habit (which the Jesuits say they have). And what if we should say that Christ dwells in none, but such as actually believe? (He means, what would Bellarmine have to plead against it, seeing he maintains habitual faith). But even infants have both the act and the habit of faith in its seed; that is to say, in the Holy Ghost, as we before spoke.

Lastly, the Jesuit saith, that Augustine teacheth that there is a secret grace infused into infants when they are baptized? I answer, so say we too, but Augustine saith not say *the habit of faith is infused*; but *grace*, and Bellarmine doth not know what to make of this grace, whether he should call it charity, joined with faith and hope, or any other quality with which all these graces are perpetually linked. But who ever heard of such a quality which is neither faith, hope nor love, and yet hath all these conjoined with it? Grace may be infused without either the act or habit of any of these. Saint Augustine seems to be of this opinion, that this grace is the Holy Ghost which indeed works faith, but not instantly, in infants.

[207] *Page 286. Sed ait Christum habitare in infantibus per fidem; ergo habere eos fidem, saltem quoad habitum? Respondeo. At hoc non minus de actu quam de habitu intelligitur. Quid si enim dicamus in nullis Christum habitare, nisi qui actu credunt? Et pueri habent tum actum tum habitum fidei in suo semine, id est, in spiritu sancto, ut antea diximus. Postremo ait, infundi parvulis occultam gratiam, cum baptizentur, idque Augustinum docere. Respondeo, Id nos quoque dicimus. Sed Augustinus non ait habitum fidei infundi, sed gratiam, et Bellarminus nescit an haec gratia sit charitas cum fide et spe, an qualitas alia, cum qua tres illae virtutes perpetuo sunt coniunctae. Quis unquam de eiusmodi qualitate audivit, quae nec spes, nec charitas, nec fides est, sed has secum coniunctas habet? Infundi gratia potest sine harum virtutum aut actu, aut habitu. Videtur Augustinus id sensisse, hanc gratiam esse spiritum sanctum qui efficit fidem, licet non statim in infantibus.*

I will now in the next chapter,[208] press Dr. Whitaker to lay open the doctrine of the Fathers, touching on the faith by which infants are partakers of the grace of baptism, and are saved, if they die in infancy. It is very loath to declare himself against that charitable concept of antiquity, *viz*. that for as much as infants having in them no sin, that is, every way their own, but original, which is done away in baptism, if any faith is further required to bring them to heaven, in case they then depart this life, they may be saved by the faith of their parents. But he doth this as admitting this rather than the other touching on actual or habitual faith of their own. In the ordinary course of the argument, he thinks (as all other judicious divines ever do, and ever did) to be very incongruous and absurd, whether we consider the nature of grace, or the capacity of nature in an infant for reception of such grace. But, for a conclusion (however he, following the judgment of many more in the ancient schools of the Papists themselves, will not hear of any infusion of so much as of the habit of faith in infants;) he comes back to his former position, in which we saw his agreement with Peter Martyr, and St. Augustine, and shuts up all, in this way, "But although infants do not have habitual faith, yet we say that they are purged by the Holy Ghost, and made new creatures, for as much as flesh and blood shall not inherit the kingdom of heaven, and unless they be born again of water and of the Spirit, they cannot enter into the kingdom of God. Therefore we conclude that the Spirit of God works in them in such a manner as cannot by us be expressed."[210] I willingly admit that this purging and renewing of infants, which he speaks of, is to be understood of the works of the Spirit in such as die in infancy, and are saved. However, he yields the Spirit to be in all the rest that belong to God's election, although the same effects are not produced until they come to age, as those two plain and pregnant places alleged but now out of his fifth chapter, concerning the efficacy of baptism, clearly and fully proclaim to all the world. And so I am done with him also.

[208] *Ibid.*, chap. 6.

[210] *Sed etsi infantes non habere fidem habitualem, tamen a spiritu sancto purgari dicimus, et fieri novas creaturas, quia caro et sanguis regnum caelorum non possidebunt, et nisi ex aqua et spiritu sancto renati fuerint, non possunt intrare in regnum caelorum: ergo in eis operari spiritum sanctum ineffabiliter dicimus. Controv. de Bapt., quaest. 4, cap. 6, in conclus.*

Our next witness is that learned Doctor Francis White, now Bishop of Norwich, in his *Answer* to Fisher the Jesuit, whom though I have alleged before, and might therefore well be excused if I should pass him over here. Yet because some that are resolved never to assent to this truth, when they see or hear any testimony produced out of any good author that is clearly for me, they used to shift it off, among those that either cannot, or will not, examine the authors themselves, with this aspersion cast upon me. It is true, they say, that he makes a noise with quotations out of many authors; but how? He catches up here and there a word, or a sentence that seems to make for his purpose, and useth them quite the contrary to the author's meanings, as would easily appear by examination of what goeth before and follows after, in those authors. I am therefore constrained to be tedious, in many things, not only to others, but to myself also, in being larger than I intended at the first, merely to vindicate myself from that, which I am afraid they too well know that they unjustly lay to my charge, upon all occasions. And for this reason I am compelled to repeat what formerly I alleged out of this author, and to add to it all that he hath spoken of the point; that it may be manifest that I have not wronged him, as some give out to their disciples.

The charge which Fisher cometh on with it, on all Protestants at once, is this*: Their errors against baptism, the gate and entrance into Christian life, of which they deny the virtue to sanctify men, and the necessity thereof for infants, to whom they grant salvation without baptism*. In which complaint the Jesuit would gladly persuade, that Protestants deny both the *efficacy* and the *necessity* of baptism. Our author answers him to both particulars. We have here to deal only with the former, touching on which the whole passage runs in this way, *viz.*

> "Although some persons have been Christians before their baptism, as St. Augustine saith of Cornelius.[211] Even as in Abraham the justice of faith was precedent, and the seal of circumcision followed after; so likewise in Cornelius, spiritual sanctification, by the gift of the Holy Ghost, went before, and the sacrament of regeneration in the laver of baptism succeeded; yet notwithstanding, the ordinary gate and entrance into Christian life is

[211] Page 175, 176.

baptism. (St. Ambrose, *Prosper* d. vocat, Gent. Li. 1 ca. 5). The beginning of true life and righteousness, is laid in the Sacrament of regeneration, that looks where man is newly born, there also the verity of virtues themselves may spring.

Neither do Protestants deny the virtue and efficacy of baptism, to sanctify men; but according to the Holy Scriptures, Eph. 5:26; Titus 3:5; Gal. 3:27; 1 Pet. 3:21; Acts 22:16; Rom. 6:3. And the ancient church, they teach and maintain that this sacrament is an instrument of sanctification, and remission of sins. The liturgy of the Church of England, in the form of administration of baptism, hath these words: Seeing now D.B. that these children are regenerate, *etc*., we yield Thee hearty thanks most merciful Father, that it hath pleased Thee to regenerate this infant with Thy Holy Ghost, to receive him for Thine own child by adoption, etc. And Master Hooker saith, "Baptism is a sacrament which God hath instituted in His Church, to the end that they which receive the same, might be incorporated into Christ, and so through His most precious merit, obtain as well that saving grace of imputation, which takes away all former guiltiness, and also that infused divine virtue of the Holy Ghost, which gives to the powers of the soul their first disposition toward future newness of life." Zanchius hath these words, when the Minister baptizeth, "I believe that Christ with His hand reached as it were from heaven, besprinkleth the child baptized with water, with His blood, to remission of sins." And in another place, "The Holy Ghost moves upon the water of baptism, and sanctifies the same, making it to be a laver of regeneration." Calvin saith, *"Per baptismum Christus nos mortis suae participes facit, ut in eam inferamur*, By baptism Christ hath made us partakers of His death, that we may be ingrafted into it." And in another place, "If any demand, how can infants which want understanding be regenerate? I answer: Although we are not able to fathom or unfold the manner of this work of God, yet it doth not follow from Hence, that the same is not done."

> And the same author, with others of his part maintain the former doctrine concerning the efficacy of the sacrament of baptism, and they differ only from Lutherans and Pontificians. First, in that they restrain the grace of sanctification only to the elect. Secondly, in that they deny external baptism to be always effectual, at the very instant time it is administered. Thus far our author, word for word."

I forbear to add his marginal notes, because I am here to use his words, not his authors, from whom he had them. We see that, in the name of all sound Protestants, he professeth an efficacy of baptism even in infants elected; and this, he tells us, is the doctrine of our Church, of antiquity both in respect of particular Fathers, and of whole counsels also; and this is the professed doctrine of Mr. Hooker, Zanchius, Calvin, and of all others that are not Lutherans and Papists. So as now, our author must by all men be confessed to be a Lutheran and a Papist, (from both which, in that whole work, he sufficiently clears himself) or else to be directly, fully, and every way of the same opinion with our Church in this point, touching on the efficacy of baptism in and upon the elect only.

Fourthly, I produce that learned and worthy successor of Bishop Jewel in Salisbury, Dr. Davenant, now Bishop of Sarum, whose worth is so well known, that no man that knows a profound scholar and sound divine, but will yield him to be of the highest form. He, in his excellent commentary that he lately put forth in Latin, on the Epistle to the Colossians, saith this, (on those words of the Apostle, Col. 2:12, *buried with him in baptism, in which also ye are risen with him through the faith of the operation of God, etc*. Not only in the person of Christ, but also in our own selves our sins are said to be buried in baptism; because that mortification and burial of sin is performed not only sacramentally in the very moment of baptism, but also really, by the Spirit of grace received in baptism throughout the whole life of a Christian.[212] And a little after, when he speaks of mortification as a grace actually

[212] *Non solum in persona Christi, sed in nobismetipsis etiam sepulta dicuntur peccata in baptismo: quia illa mortificatio & sepultura peccati non solum sacramentaliter uno momento peragitur in actione baptismi, sed realiter etiam per spiritum gratiæ in baptismo acceptum, per totam vitam Christianam protenditur.*

wrought, he saith that,[213] "it is rather a thing not yet begun, than in the actual work done in our baptism." And afterwards, in exposition of that clause, in whom also ye are risen by the faith of the operation of God, he in this way explains its meaning.[214] "The Apostle doth not in vain require faith, to the end we may obtain the benefit of a spiritual resurrection. For as in the baptism of those of years, precedent faith is required, according to that of our Saviour, Mark 16:16. *He that believes, and is baptized shall be saved*; so, of those that are baptized in infancy, future faith is required; which if they do not perform, they retain only the external sanctification of baptism, not having its inward effects." Again, speaking of the faith of infants, he determines that doubt, "It is sufficient that they have mortification and faith, not actually declaring itself by any act of theirs, but included in the habitual principle of grace. And that the Spirit of Christ both can and ordinarily doth work this habitual principle of grace in them, no man well in his wits will deny." Now in these four passages, who doth not see these six things? 1. That infants do not only partake of an external washing, or obsignation, in baptism, but they then receive the Holy Ghost. 2. That though they then receive the Holy Ghost, yet He doth not presently regenerate actually, for then, the work is rather in *fiery* than in *facto esse*, as a thing not yet begun, rather than for the present, done. 3. That all that are outwardly baptized, if they live, must attain actual faith, before their baptism will appear effectual to them. 4. That there are some who do partake only of the outward laver, without the inward effects; else, their faith would spring and show itself, when they come to years. 5. That it is ordinary with the Holy Ghost to work seminal grace in those infants that belong indeed to God's election. 6. That they savor of cracked brains who deny it. I am afraid the reader will be impatient to be kept longer in a point so plain; I will therefore add only one testimony more out of Dr. Fulke, and another out of Dr. Featly, who, understanding from myself how I stated my

[213] *In fieri, non in facto esse.*

[214] *Non frustra est quod exigitur fides ab Apostolo, ut beneficium spiritualis resurrectionis obtineamus. Nam ut in baptismo adultorum requiritur fides praevia, iuxta dictum Salvatoris Mark 16:16, qui crediderit et baptizatus fuerit, salvus fuerit; sic ab illis qui baptizantur cum iam infantes sint requiritur fides subsequens: quam si non praestiterint postea, retinent externam tantummodo baptismi sanctificationem: interna sanctificationis effecta non habent.*

position, gave this answer*: neminem habebis adversarium; sure you will have no adversary.*

Judicious and industrious Dr. Fulke, in his *Answer to the Rhemist Annotations* upon the New Testament, saith this, "Neither is baptism an efficient cause of salvation unto infants, but a seal of God's Spirit regenerating them to eternal life." Where he doth not more deny the excess which Papists unjustly attribute to baptism, then he willingly acknowledges what is due unto it*; viz.*, that it is outwardly a seal of God's Spirit, which the Spirit inwardly regenerates to eternal life. So then Doctor Fulke could also discern the Spirit in the baptism of those ordained to life.

Lastly, that learned and nimble author[215] of the *Second Parallel*, (who is thought to make against me, because in page 89 he saith, as I also ever said from the beginning*, viz. that all that are regenerated sacramentally, are not necessarily and infallibly regenerated spiritually*;) is clear of this opinion, page 90.[216] *Although the inward grace ordinarily accompany the outward sign, and we ought to believe, by the judgment of charity, that all who are baptized are truly regenerate; yet indicio veritatis* as *Junius distinguisheth, that is; by the judgment of precise and infallible truth, all are not so*, as the Fathers speak roundly and plainly. In which words we see, first a concession of that we contend for*, viz.* that *the inward grace ordinarily, accompanies the outward sign*. Secondly, that yet this is not always; for it is not done at all, in the baptism of some. But who are those some? They that are not elected; for he denies it of all that fall away and perish, as the main substance and drift of that discourse declares. Thus you see that many English divines of best note, speak clearly and fully to this point, as well as I that alone am singled out, and attacked by passionate and heady men.

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[215] Dr. Featly.

[216] I was at first pressed greatly with the authority of the author of the perpetuity of the regenerate man's estate. But he that shall peruse pages 353-354 of his book in the first edition, shall find that still he runs on these two points: 1. That not all, but only the elect receive any kind of regeneration at all in baptism. 2. That the elect do receive a cleansing and washing from the guilt of original sin, so as if they die in their infancy, before their ACTUAL regeneration, and real conversion to God, they shall be saved. And all this he says is done by the Spirit. Which is as much for me as I can desire. If my adversaries have no worse weapons to beat me with, I shall never complain at their blows.

CHAPTER IX. Six Objections Against the Main Position Answered.

I have at length gotten through all those particulars propounded in the end of the second chapter of this treatise. And I hope I have made it evident to judicious and impartial readers, that, (in the judgment of our Church, according to the Scriptures, as they have been understood by the ancient Fathers, by the present Churches of Christ beyond the seas, and by particular divines of chiefest note, both foreign and domestical.*) All elect infants do ordinarily receive from Christ, in baptism, the Spirit of regeneration, as the soul and first principle of spiritual life, for the first solemn initiation into Christ, and for their future actual renovation, in God's good time*. I have also given answers to all such objections as might occasionally fall in against my arguments brought for confirmation of the point. Now it remains that I add *answers* to all such *objections* as either have been made by others, or conceived by myself as likely to be urged by others, against the main *assertion* itself, which I have labored all this while to prove and make good by so many witnesses.

In the performance of this, I shall endeavor to deal as clearly and plainly as possibly I can, although I am by this constrained to use more words than may be needful (or perhaps grateful) to more acute capacities. I do not wish to be thought to darken my meaning on purpose in the fogs of needless terms of art not generally understood which might give ordinary readers cause to complain of obscurity or sophistry. And to ordinary readers I must premise one advertisement which others do not need to know*: viz*. That in this part they expect no further corroboration of the main conclusion, but only, a manifestation of the impertinency and weakness of their arguments that object against it. If I can, in that which remains, make it appear that*, nothing of all that hath been, or can be said, against my position, is able to overthrow it, but that it is possible for the point to stand whole and unbroken, notwithstanding all their battery*. I have done enough no matter how weak it may be on my own grounds on which I have here built, so that such

things may be shown incorrect to those that proclaim me a dreamer and a broacher of a gross and pestilent error.

1. Objection. Christians are regenerated by the Word (James 1:18; 1 Peter 1:23), therefore not by baptism, in their infancy.

Answer. The antecedent proposition is granted, being understood by actual regeneration of persons of years, as it Importeth an actual and thorough change of the whole man, upon their effectual vocation, inwardly by the Spirit, and outwardly by the Word, in ordinary course. And of this only, those places are to be expounded. For, the words are spoken only of the work of the Word in and on aged persons called either from Judaism, or Gentilism, by the preaching of the Gospel; who, as Lydia (Acts 16:14) had their hearts opened by the Spirit to understand and receive the things preached unto them, and so were begotten anew unto God; that is, made new men in Christ, to perform new obedience actually to God, contrary to their former course in the state of corrupt nature.

In this actual conversion and renovation, the Spirit is the efficient cause, and the Word is only an instrument that He pleases to make use of. Not as if He could not dispatch this work without it, but this is that which He hath sanctified, and commanded us to attend on, as soon as we are able by accession of years to understand its use, for conversion in the ordinary course of it. Now, mark here the weakness and imperfection of this argument. St. James and St. Peter both affirm that the persons to whom they wrote, being persons of years, were actually renewed by the Word. The objection is phrased like this concerning them, "Therefore, it is false that elect infants do receive the Spirit in baptism for their initiation into Christ, and as the soul and principle of after actual renovation by the Word." This is all the strength that this objection hath in it, when they have improved it to the utmost. And, how weak this strength is, who doth not see? It doth not reach home so much as to touch on (much less to pierce) the point in question. For, the Apostles speak of persons of years; we speak of infants. They, of actual renovation; we, of initial regeneration only. They, of such as are able to make use of the Word; we, of such as are not capable of any speech. Those places therefore, do prove well that which

I do not deny, *viz*. that actual regeneration[217] in persons of years is usually worked into them by the Word; but they do not restrain regeneration either only to people of years, or, only to this means; nor deny the Spirit to be given to infants before they can come to make use of the Word for their first ingrafting into Christ, and as the first principle of the new creature.

If any shall doubt whether I am right in expounding the places alleged, and suppose that the words do not only affirm the Word to be the ordinary means of regeneration, but the *only* means also of regenerating all that are regenerated, in any kind or degree whatsoever;[218] let them be pleased to consult Mr. Calvin, who interprets St. Peter, (that saith the same with St. James), in the very same sense that I do, in his answer to the Anabaptists, who were the first Fathers of this objection, and of all that follow, against this point. So, he saith, "Whereas they object, that the Spirit of God in the Scriptures, doth acknowledge no regeneration at all, but that which is by the incorruptible seed of the Word; they do most absurdly interpret that place of Peter; wherein the Apostle only comprehends such as had been taught and instructed by the preaching of the Gospel. Unto such, we confess the Word of God is the seed, and the only seed of spiritual regeneration; but we deny that from them may be gathered, that God by His power cannot regenerate infants without it; which to him is as easy and ordinary; as it is to us incomprehensible and admirable." The same he saith, in the particular of *faith*, in the very next section, as there more at large appears. Nor did this speech fall from him only once, or unadvisedly; but it was the constant answer he ever gave to this objection, as he himself professes in his *Answer to Servetus*, touching on the same subject of the baptism of infants as

[217] Let the reader observe that whereas I often use this phrase, my meaning is not at any time to understand by it any other thing than what in the stating of the question that I have expressed; *viz.* such a work of the Spirit as does actually renew a man and makes him a new man in Christ by effectual conversion in which he receives the habits of all saving graces by the Spirit.

[218] *"Quod contra objectant, Spiritum in Scripturis nullam nisi ex incorruptibili semine, id est, Dei verbo regenerationem agnoscere: perperam illam Petri sententiam interpretantur (I. ep. 1, 23.), qua fideles modo comprehendit, qui Evangelii praedicatione edocti fuerant. Talibus quidem fatemur, verbum Domini spiritualis esse regenerationis semen unicum: sed ex eo negamus colligendum, non posse Dei virtute regenerari infantes: quae illi tam facilis et prompta est, quam nobis incomprehensa et admirabilis. Institutes, Book 4, chapter 16, section 18.*

may be seen in the end oft the same chapter last cited. For, to Servetus objecting that,[219] "Infants cannot be thought new men, because they are not regenerated by the Word," Calvin makes this answer, "I have said often, and I now repeat it, that, the Word is the incorruptible seed of regeneration unto us, provided that we are capable of it; but where infancy makes incapable instruction by that means, God doth retain His course of working some degrees of regeneration without it." If it is replied, Calvin speaks what may be, and what, in some extraordinary cases, sometimes happens, but not what is usually done in the baptism of the elect? I rejoin that, if Calvin meant only so much, his *Answer* could not satisfy the Anabaptists, who therefore deny baptism to infants, because they are not then capable of regeneration and faith; and he on the contrary, saith they are capable of some regeneration, and therefore ought to be baptized. If he did not mean baptismal regeneration, how can their possibility of regeneration be a warrant for baptism, seeing they have, or may have that, without baptism? Lastly, if it were not ordinary with God to regenerate elect infants in baptism, his answer would fall short too. For they might justly reply, that an ordinary practice, "of baptizing all infants is not to be warranted from some extraordinary cases. If you confess that it is not ordinary that elect infants are regenerated in baptism, what reason have you to tie all men to that, in which you cannot promise them the grace that is represented thereby, and promised to all that use it with understanding and faith." This, and much more might be unanswerably returned upon Calvin by Servetus and his clients if they had understood him to deny initial regeneration of elect infants to be ordinarily communicated to them in baptism. I conclude therefore, *with* judicious Calvin. However it is true, which the Scriptures speak of the actual regeneration of persons of years, that they are regenerated by the Word; yet elect infants may be, and are, for all appears, in either of the places of Scripture objected to the contrary, partakers of *initial* regeneration, by the Spirit, *in their baptism*. And so this objection doth our position no harm.

[219] *"Obiicit rursum infantes non posse novos homines censeri: quia non gignuntur per sermonem. Ego vero, quod saepius iam dixi nunc quoque repeto, ad nos regenerandos doctrinam semen esse incorruptibile, siquidem ad eam percipiendam sumus idonei; ubi vero nondum per aetatem nobis inest docilitas, Deum tenere suos regenerandi gradus." Institutes, Book 4, chapter 16, section 31.*

2. *Objection*. But there is no such thing as *initial* regeneration, distinct from *actual*, as here is supposed. Wherever the Spirit is infused to regenerate, He doth, in the first instance, actually regenerate. Therefore there being, by your own confession (they say), no actual regeneration in any infant ordinarily, at his baptism, there is then no regeneration at all. This distinction of initial and actual regeneration is but a toy and a new device without warrant from the Scripture.

Answer. If this objection contains a truth without equivocation, I confess the position to be a toy indeed. But there may be some ambiguity in the terms of *initial* and *actual*, which being cleared, the objection may perhaps not appear as weak as they declare themselves rash and uncharitable who took on them to confute that distinction, which they never understood, nor would ever grant so much as to hear explained by myself, either in public or private.

Touching on the distinction of *initial* and *actual* regeneration, I have sufficiently declared before, in my second chapter, in what sense I use it. I will therefore forbear to repeat what there I have written. The reader may view it at his pleasure. If any man demands expressed Scriptures for the very terms, he will sooner declare of what spirit he is. But if by sufficient consequence the distinction is not clearly deduced thence, he shall then have cause to complain. Let him view the foundation on which it is built, and afterwards tell me his mind, if he remains unsatisfied. In the meantime, I shall only add this much: that by *initial* and *actual* regeneration, I do not mean to insinuate two several *kinds* of spiritual life. I acknowledge, there is no footing here in Scripture. But I understand only two distinct *considerations* in respect of the *degrees* of spiritual life in the same subject, which the places of Scripture before alleged in chapter 2 sufficiently warrant. For, by *life*, in Scripture, is sometimes meant *the soul infused as the principle of life*; sometimes the *very actual being and enlivening of the subject by that soul*, making it actually to produce the actions of life. Hence I distinguish of life into *initial* and *actual*. Not as if the Spirit were not actually communicated, or did not actually work, or actually begin, from the very first instant, to dispose and prepare the soul to future actual newness of life, by infusing some *potential* and *seminal* grace. My meaning is that,

the Spirit doth not at that time, ordinarily, so plenarily change and renew the whole man, as to work in him either actual faith, hope, or love, *etc*.; or so much as the habits of these or other particular graces for the present as afterward He doth. This is instead something the Spirit doth from His first entrance toward actual regeneration, therefore we call that first work, *initial*, by it understanding the first disposition to, or degree of actual regeneration. But for as much as that first work doth not (for all we know) extend to a present actual change of the whole man in the same manner and degree, that afterwards is worked in him at his *effectual* calling, therefore we call that latter work, *actual regeneration*.

This ought not to seem strange to any, for just so it is the course of nature. So as soon as the reasonable soul is infused, there is in some sense, (not every way, in respect of degrees) a rational life.[220] But how? The soul is there, and in that soul are included all the principles of reason; but the soul doth not send forth those principles unto action (unless in some insensible manner little by little preparing the infant to human actions) until afterwards that the senses begin to act. Before that time, the reasonable life cannot wholly be denied to be in an infant, because the rational soul is actually in his body; yet for as much as the infant doth not have at that time the actual use of reason, for this cause we call the further perfection of his natural principles by tract of time attained, when reason puts itself into act, *actual rational life*; and we term the same life, in respect of the first degree and principles thereof, which together with the reasonable soul, in its first infusion, it received, *initial* life.

This is no more, in substance, than what we have learned from St. Augustine, Calvin, Peter Martyr, Junius, Daneus, Dr. Whitaker, Zanchius, and sundry others, whose judgments have been at large set down in this treatise in sundry places upon sundry occasions. And shall any man think it nothing in a magisterial humor, to trample so many worthies under his feet, at once, as if he were wiser than all oth-

[220] *Ipse* (Deus scilicet) *itaque animae humanae mentem dedit, ubi ratio et intelligentia in infante sopita est quodammodo, quasi nulla sit, excitanda scilicet atque exercenda aetatis accessu, qua sit scientiae capax atque doctrinae et habilis perceptioni veritatis et amoris boni.* Augustine, *De Civitate Dei*, Book 22, chapter 24. To the same purpose also he writeth in Book 2, *De Peccat. Mer. et Remiss.*, chapter 25, and elsewhere.

ers? If it is only the terms that displease him, because, perhaps, the same are not found in any of these authors, he shall but show himself a cavalier to quarrel with them; unless he can show that the terms are used to signify that which, in substance, these authors do not allow and teach. Briefly then, this objection is grounded upon a false information and supposition; for it supposes me to use the terms of *initial* and *actual* regeneration, as intending thereby to teach that there are two distinct *species* or *kinds* of regeneration; whereas my meaning is only to speak of the same spiritual life, in two *distinct considerations*, in respect of *degrees*. And so the objection fights with a shadow, and not with me.

But it will be replied that, "in regeneration there are no degrees, but that it is performed and dispatched at an instant, as natural generation is. It is true, they say, that there are degrees in renovation,"[221] which noteth a growth in sanctification, in a man regenerated. But regeneration, "is never taken for any other than for the first act of the Spirit entering into a Christian, and begetting him a new man in Christ, in the very first moment of his entrance. Therefore the distinction of actual and initial regeneration cannot be admitted in any sense."[222]

I answer, that those two words, *regeneration*, and *renovation*, may perhaps, by some, Ye used, the one to signify the first infusion of grace making a man actually a new creature in all parts at once; and the other to note the continual growth of a Christian in grace infused. If men will give notice of their meaning before and for the more clear expression of themselves, will say, when I speak of the first infusion of grace, I will use the word *regeneration* to express it, and when I speak of continual growth from one degree unto another, I will always call that *renovation*. Men may, if they please, make use of words as they do of counters in casting of accounts, wherein, of the same set and value, some counters are made to stand for dollars, some for quarters, and some for pennies. And yet, as those counters which stand for pennies might as well have stood for dollars, as those that do stand for dollars, if it had pleased him that set them to have so disposed them. So

[221] ἀνακαίνωσις.

[222] Παλιγγενεσία.

men may put words of the same value and native signification, to signify diverse things, by a liberty justifiable enough in use of speech. And yet those words may without wrong, be used by others to signify other things, always provided that when a man uses a word in a sense different either from the prime signification of it, or from the common acceptation of it, he gives warning that, wherever he used such a word, he would be understood in such or such a sense, and not according to the etymology of it, nor according to the common use of it. And so I grant, that if it please any divine to say that he will ever restrain *regeneration* to note the first infusion of grace, and by *renovation* signify a daily increase of grace, in all his speeches or writings, for want of more fit terms to express himself in, he may do it.

But if any man shall say that, "the proper meaning of the word *regeneration* and of that which the Scriptures call παλιγγενεσία, is the first infusion of the Spirit actually to make a man a new creature in all parts at once, so as in this there can be no degrees," and affirm that, so the Scriptures do ever use that word, and also add that, "by *renovation*, the Scripture never means the same thing that it intends by *regeneration*, but that ἀνακαίνωσις or renovation is ever put for another thing, in other words, for continual growth in grace once infused." If they think this, then I must desire to leave and dissent from him, and to deny his assertion. For, neither is there any such difference in the proper signification of these words, but that they may both signify one and the same thing. Nor is the Scripture so nice as to observe such a difference between them, as the objectors would persuade us.

That in the proper signification, there is nothing either why *regeneration* should signify only the first infusion of grace; or rather this than its daily growth; nor, why *renovation* should not signify the first beginnings of the new creature, as well as its growth, those that are skillful in the tongues, will easily bear me witness; and I take them that make this nice distinction between these two words, to be better skilled than to say that these words in their proper signification, will justify this conceit. Therefore they must of necessity fly to the Scriptures, and prove there, παλιγγενεσία, usually translated *regeneration*, is ever so restrained as that it always signifies the first infusion of grace, and not that further work of the Spirit which admitteth of degrees

and is ever expressed by ἀνακαίνωσις, or *renovation*, or else their conceit will prove but a fancy too weak to ruin the distinction of *initial* and *actual* regeneration.

But the Holy Ghost in the Scriptures doth not observe this nicety of words. For sometimes we shall find *regeneration*, put for *sanctification* expressed by obedience to Christ and His Gospel, or else for the beginning of glory, and not for the first infusion of grace only. So this is true in Matthew 19:28. Our Saviour in this way gives answer to Peter demanding of him what they should have, who had forsaken all to follow Him; "Verily I say unto you that ye which have followed Me, [ἐν τῇ παλιγγενεσίᾳ], in the regeneration, when the son of man shall sit in the throne of His glory, ye also shall sit upon twelve thrones, *etc*.," where the word *regeneration* cannot be taken for the first infusion of grace only, because it notes such a thing as Christ's disciples did actually exercise and express in receiving of His Gospel. Or else, as Beza rather thinks, it signifies the very state of glory wherewith they shall be invested at the latter day, and the words ought to be read in this way, "Ye that have followed Me, *(placing the comma in that spot*), in the regeneration when the son of man shall sit in the throne of His glory, ye shall sit, *etc*." That is, you that follow me now, shall hereafter, when the elect, being perfectly sanctified, begin their kingdom of glory, namely at the latter day, when I shall come again in glory, then shall you sit on twelve thrones. And so did Saint Augustine[223] long before expound that text. Therefore the word is not restrained only to signify the first infusion of the Spirit and of grace by the Spirit. Again, sometimes we shall find παλιγγενεσία and *ἀνακαίνωσις*, *regeneration* and *renovation* put one for another, the one to explicate the other; for so Zanchius saith expressly in his commentary on Ephesians 5. And he saith the truth, for so the Apostle uses them, Titus 3:5, *according to his mercy He saved us, διὰ λουτροῦ παλιγγενεσίας καὶ ἀνακαινώσεως πνεύματος ἁγίου, by the laver of regeneration and renewing of the Holy Ghost*, where the Apostle uses those two words of *regeneration* and *renovation* not only to signify two things; but the latter declares the meaning of the former, as

[223] *Augustine, De peccatorum meritis et remissione, Book 2, chapter 7.*

Beza teaches as well.[224] Wherefore I conclude that, for as much as the Holy Scripture doth not restrain the word *regeneration*, to the first infusion of the Spirit, or of grace by the Spirit, in which there are no degrees, but extends it further, even to that further work of the Spirit, in which (as all grant) there are degrees. The distinction of regeneration into *initial* and *actual* still stands upright without battering by this second objection, that will admit of no degrees in that, which the Scripture everywhere calleth by the name of *regeneration.*

3. *Objection. The Apostle expressly ascribeth the conferring of the Spirit, to the word of faith preached. Galatians 3:2. Therefore the Spirit is not given in baptism.*

Answer. Consider the quality of the persons spoken of by the Apostle, and compare them with those of whom we speak in the present question, and then the objection will fall to the ground of itself. If we should consider those Galatians only as persons of age and understanding, that would, in Calvin's judgment, so much alter the case, (if the same words should be used to deny the communication of the Spirit unto infants in baptism) as would give just occasion to deny the consequence of that proposition. For so Calvin to Servetus objecting that, "No man is made our brother but by the Spirit of adoption which is conferred only by the hearing of faith; gives this answer: He ever falls into the same sophism, because preposterously he draws that to infants which is spoken only of persons of years. Paul in that place teacheth that the hearing of faith is God's ordinary way of calling, by which He brings on His elect unto faith, raising them up to be faithful teachers in whose ministry He reacheth out His hand to them. Now, who shall dare to set such a law to God, that He should not by some other secret way ingraft infants into Christ?"[225]

But there is more in that case of the Galatians, and so in that of Cornelius' company, Acts 10:44, then this, that they were persons of

[224] *Ipsa vero regeneratio & renovatio non sunt duo diversa. Sed haec est illius declaratio, Beza in loc.*

[225] *Addit postea, neminem fieri fratrem nostrum, nisi per Spiritum adoptionis, qui tantum ex auditu fidei confertur. Respondeo, semper in eundem relabi paralogismum: quia praepostere ad infantes trahit, quod de solis adultis dictum est: docet illic Paulus hunc esse Deo ordinarium vocationis modum, ut electos suos ad fidem adducat, dum illis suscitat fidei doctores, quorum ministerio et opera manum porrigit. Quis inde legem imponere ei audeat, quominus arcane alia ratione infantes Christo inserat? – Institutes, Book 4, chapter 16, section 31. Resp. ad objectionem 15 tam Serveti.*

years, when, in hearing the Word preached, they received the Holy Ghost. They were, until that time, no part of the visible Church and flock of Christ, but Gentiles and mere aliens from Him and all his ordinances until the Gospel was preached to them. And it is one thing to be a Gentile without the Church that hath nothing to do with Christ or His Spirit till he hears Him published in the preaching of the Gospel, which is the first ordinance of Christ that he partakes of. For first, Christ is preached unto him; then, believing, he is to be baptized. And it is another thing to be born of parents that are visible members of a settled and established Church, so as the party so borne is to be held and reputed for one of the faithful even from the womb. It is no wonder if the former sort receive the Spirit in the hearing of the Word. How else should they come by it in the ordinary course of dispensation by means? But it cannot be wondered that any should infer that elect infants born and baptized in the Church, should not, ordinarily, partake of the Spirit, before they come to age sufficient to be capable of the Word preached on this ground that the Galatians and others mentioned in Scripture, that were converted by the Word, from paganism, did not receive the Spirit before they heard the Gospel preached. I shall not need to spend time and paper to prove that the Apostle speaks of only the former sort, and not of the latter. Therefore this objection doth not at all touch the point in hand.

4. *Objection. If the Spirit is given in baptism, then baptism can save without actual regeneration, which is confessed to be wrought by the Word. But baptism, without actual regeneration cannot save any, as appears by that in 1 Peter 3:21. Therefore the Spirit is not given in baptism.*

Answer. This is a feeble argument. Nevertheless let us examine it. I answer therefore both to the *major* and to the *minor* also.

1. To the *major*, I answer by denying the sequel. For, in the case of infants dying in infancy, the Spirit *can*, and (no doubt*) doth* actually regenerate them, *without* the preached Word. How else should they enter into the kingdom of heaven? In what manner the Spirit doth regenerate such, is to us unknown. Nor will I take upon me to determine that which the Scripture is silent in. They that deny all actual regeneration till the Word comes, without exception of such as dying in infancy, do conclude all infants dying be-

fore they are able to make use of the Word, to be damned. This is a damnable conclusion not to be endured in the tongue or pen of any sober Christian. Thus we see in few words that the *consequence* of the *major*, is an idle *non sequitur*; grounded on a false supposition. For, although we say that, actual regeneration is not wrought but by the Word, yet we do not grant this universally of all, but only of persons of years.

2. To the *minor*, I answer this way,

1. I deny that the Apostle, in that place, speaks of *regeneration wrought by the Word*; for he doth not speak at all either of regeneration strictly and formally so called, but only of an act which supposes regeneration; nor, of that act, as worked by the Word, but of an act worked without declaring by what means, it is wrought. So as, for that which appears in the text to the contrary, it may be worked on in baptism, as well as by any other means. Therefore in this respect, the proposition is weak and lame, because I may as well draw it to my purpose, and say that baptism hath such efficacy in it as to enable a Christian to *make answer unto God*, because the Apostle saith that *baptism* (although not the outward washing yet the inward grace*), Saveth*, as others may urge it against me, by inferring thence that, baptism cannot save without the Word. For, there is not, in that place, any mention or so much as the least insinuation of the *Word*, but only of baptism.
2. I add that expositors do not agree in the exposition of that text; and yet notwithstanding their disagreement, there is nothing to be drawn either from the exposition of any one of them, or from all of them together, that concludes anything against this position. Expositors do not agree in the rendering of the text, it is evident by their different renderings of the word ἐπερώτημα, (which in our last translation is rendered *the answer of a good conscience, etc*.) in which word lies all the difficulty of the whole passage.
    1. Some would not have it translated *the answer of a good conscience*; but *the request or confident demand* made by a good conscience to God. So, the old translators say this as well as Mister Cartwright

in his answer to the Rhemists on Matthew 3:11.[226] But what the conscience makes *request for*, these authors speak no syllable of. And how a *request made to God* should be the inward part of baptism here opposed to the *outward washing which purges the filthiness of the flesh*, is beyond my capacity to comprehend. But I let that pass wishing they had more clearly explained themselves.

2. Some take it for an allusion to the usual *interrogatories* in baptism, and to the *stipulation* made by the party baptized, to perform the conditions tendered unto him, and accepted by him, in his baptism. This stipulation he must answer and make good, before he can expect that his baptism should save him. So Beza took it, Dr. Fulke saith on that place. Yes, and so also Mr. Cartwright did when he writes on that text and to vindicate it from Rhemish falsifications. But he adds that those questions were made to persons of years, and unto such the Apostle writes and so this, in his judgment, doth not belong to infants; nor is spoken touching the efficacy of baptism on infants. However, he doth not deny the Spirit to be given to infants. For elsewhere,[227] he saith this, "I will not deny but that children have the Spirit of God, which worketh in them after a wonderful fashion." But this is all said "by the way." All that may by this exposition be concluded here is this, *That baptism saves none of years, no not as an instrument, until there is a faithful performance of the covenant on their parts*. But in the case of infants the matter is far otherwise, since they cannot, ordinarily, actually believe or repent. So Dr. Fulke saith, "Stipulation and solemn promises are necessary to be acknowledged, that baptism may be effectual to them that are of age."

3. Some, as Oecumenius, and others interpret the word somewhat otherwise. Oecumenius, who should best know the force of the Greek phrase, expounds ἐπερώτημα, by three other words, ἀρραβών, ἐνέχυρον, ἀπόδειξις, an *earnest*, a *pledge*, and a *demonstration*, using so many words not to signify diverse things, but

[226] Matthew 3:11.

[227] Thomas Cartwright against Dr. Whitgift, touching interrogatories in baptism, p. 134, the last section.

more fully to set forth the force of that one word, which he could not sufficiently express by one. But what he means by this *earnest pledge*, and *demonstration*, he leaves to his readers to divine this on their own. I think it can be understood of nothing else but the inward grace signified by the outward washing; in other words, the *blood* and *Spirit* of Christ given to a Christian in his baptism, as a *seal* and *pledge* and *demonstrative evidence* both of the *remission* of his sins by the *blood* of Christ, and also of *regeneration* by the *Spirit* of Christ, whereby the conscience is purged from dead works, and sanctified that a man doth now *answer and make good* his promise and vow in baptism. This now is not as a cause, but as a means instituted by Christ to seal to him justification by the *blood*, and *sanctification* by the Spirit of Christ, and this is said to save him. So Basil saith this,[228] "If there be any grace (or virtue) in the water, it is not from the nature of the water, but from the presence of the Spirit; for baptism is not the deposition of the filth of the flesh, but the answer of a good conscience unto God." Upon these words of Basil, Chamier[229] in this way explains, "You see that the power of purging the conscience, is denied to the water, and affirmed to be in the Spirit there present, and this he proves by an argument drawn from the words of Peter." And in the same manner judicious Whitaker[230] understands and approves that of Basil.

Bullinger is of the same judgment; for in this way Marlorat[231] quotes him on this place. "Lest any man should understand him to speak those words of the naked sign of baptism, he adds these, that baptism saves not, which purges the outward filth of the flesh; but by baptism I understand that efficacy of faith, the Spirit and power of Christ (which, as Marlorat adds, is joined with the outward sign) whereby it comes to pass that the conscience being pacified, it may

[228] Περὶ τοῦ Ἁγίου Πνεύματος, κ. 10.

[229] Vides um purgandi denegariaque, afferi spiritui sancto praesenti; & quidem argument a verbis Petri. De Sacram, Book 2, chapter 9, paragraph 11.

[230] De Sacram. *In genere* quaest. 4, chapter 2, page 73.

[231] *Augustin Marlorat, In 1 Peter 3:21, Ne quis praecedentia de nudo baptismi signo intelligeret, hoc addit: non is quidem baptismus nos salvat. Quo abluimus (ordes externas humani corporis sed per baptismi s intelligo illam vim fidei, illam spiritum & virtutem Christi (qua cum externo signo conjuncta est) qua sit ut conscientia nostra pacata secure agat coram oculis Dei.*

confidently appear and plead before the Lord." To the same purpose the English note in our old Bibles speaks, which understands it as, "Christ's inward virtue, which the outward baptism shadows." The purpose of the Apostle here is only to teach what is in baptism that is so efficacious, as to save a man; namely, not the outward element, or washing with that element; but the inward grace signified by it. This grace is here set forth by its effect in such as are of years, which is, the enabling of them with a good conscience to make good their vows, as also confidently to depend upon God through Christ for their salvation. Bucer[232] is long winded in the explication of this text; his conclusion is this, "Baptism saves none of years but believers. Indeed salvation is offered in baptism unto all, but none of years receive it, but by faith. As for infants, they are saved by the secret operation of the Spirit, which sanctifies them unto eternal life."

Now, take the words which soever any of these worthies have expounded there, what do they make, when they are cleared, so much as in the show, against the present position that elect infants do ordinarily receive the Spirit in baptism, as the first efficient principle of future actual regeneration? For, let any man frame an argument from this place (though he makes the best improvement at any exposition of it will yield) he cannot make a more forcible than this, *viz*., "Saint Peter saith that baptism is effectual to none of years, unless they partake of the inward grace of the Spirit and blood of Christ by faith, that may both assure then on Christ's part that they are ingrafted into Him, have their sins pardoned, and the old man in them buried, and also enable them to keep close to Christ actually on their parts in all such things as they promised. Therefore elect infants do not receive the Spirit in baptism, to beget faith and other graces in them afterwards, by the Word, when they come to years." Would not such a kind of arguing seem very ridiculous? It is just as if one should dispute against the flowing of the water at London Bridge, at any time except only about three o'clock, in this way. It is never high water at London Bridge about three o'clock, but when the moon is either at

[232] *Neque enim servat baptisma adultos nisi credentes. Salus quidem baptismate offertur omnibus; recipiunt autem illam adulti non nisi per fidem: infantes per arcanam Spiritus Sancti operationem, qua ad vitam aeternam sanctificantur. In script. Anglic. de vi & effic. Bapt. in calce.*

the full, or at the change; therefore there is not the least beginning of any new flood, ordinarily at all, until either it is about three o'clock, or until the moon is full. So persons of ripe age, the argument would go, shows that baptism doth not save, without faith, therefore, it will not save infants. yea, therefore, there can be no seed of grace, no Spirit of grace communicated to infants, until they do in fact come to years; as if there could be no beginning of a following of the water, till it is high tide. This and no other is the force of the objection founded on this place; so that now I appeal to any ordinary capacity, whether our position have any cause to fear the least shaking by it, I have been larger in answer of this objection than the strength of it deserves, because I was willing to clear the text, which hath some difficulty in it.

5. *Objection*. Wheresoever the Spirit is, He worketh faith and regeneration; otherwise it would follow that the Spirit would be idle, which would be a little less than blasphemy to affirm. But in elect infants, ordinarily, no such work appears, rather on the contrary, many of them show manifestly opposition to all grace and goodness for many years together, notwithstanding their baptism. Therefore, we must conclude that either they lose the Spirit received in baptism, so soon as they are able to commit actual sin, or else that they do not ordinarily receive Him in their baptism.

Answer. This is the argument which of all others is thought to have in its greatest strength, and is supposed to be impregnable. Wherefore I must endeavor to give it a full and satisfactory answer, or else I shall lose all my labor in answering of all the rest. And here before I begin to answer to either proposition, I must entreat the reader to take notice that, this argument would draw the matter unto an *impossibility* that any such thing as the conferring of the Spirit on infants in baptism, should ordinarily be; because of the gross absurdities that thence there follow*; viz*. that, then the Spirit must either be confessed to be idle; which is no better than blasphemy to affirm; or else, that the Spirit of sanctification and adoption may be wholly lost, so as a man once truly regenerate, may totally lose all regeneration and be in the same state in which he was before his baptism, which is flat Pop-

ery to maintain.[233] If therefore, I can clear the point from both these absurdities which are thought to lay an impossibility on it, and make it appear that, "it is possible for the Spirit to be in an elect infant from the time of his baptism unto his actual conversion many years after, although no manifest sign of grace, but rather the contrary doth to us appear in him." I shall sufficiently quit myself of this objection. And this I will now do, by answering distinctly to both propositions in order.

1. Then let us examine their *major proposition*, which hath in it two parts, which we may call the *antecedent*, and the *consequent*. The antecedent or the main body of the proposition is this, *whersoever the Spirit is, He works actual faith and regeneration*. This is the consequence, or *else the Spirit is idle*. To both these parts I answer in this *way:*

1. I deny the former part, if it is taken *universally*. For it is not necessary that the Spirit, from the very first time of His entrance, should work *actual faith and regeneration* (in the sense before expressed) in all in whom He may be said to be, as hath been sufficiently proved, in the case of infants, of whom only we treat. I have made it manifest by a comparison of the reasonable soul with the heavenly Spirit, as many others have done before me.

The reasonable soul is infused as soon as the body of an infant is organized and made capable of such an inhabitant; yet it doth not presently act, or enable the infant to act *rationally*, as soon as it is infused. But it will be said, that as soon as the soul comes into the

[233] The whole company of Remonstrants convented at the Synod of Dort in their declaration touching on the fifth article set forth by themselves do, with one consent, disclaim such a falling from grace, as renders him to his former estate before grace, so as he should need any new total and universal regeneration in all parts of his soul. They (as they well saw) it would follow that such a man must be rebaptized, otherwise he could be again regenerated by the ordinary way. Therefore they say, he is only set out of the state of grace (that is, out of the favor of God so as then it does not shine on him. They cannot mean it of grace in the person himself, because they confess, he has not wholly lost all grace, so as to need a new regeneration) until he recovers it again by repentance. For see what they write, a little before the middle of that declaration, circa 5. Art. de Preface. *Ex quo consequitur cum, qui a veri fide deficit, non protinus in eundem illum statum dehabi, in quo erat antequam ad fidem focaretur, ac proinde totali & universali regeneratione quoad omnes animae patres opus non habere, neq, ut novo baptism rebaptizetur necession esse, sed tantum extra statum gratia, collocari, quamdia ad statum illum a quo defecit, non revertitur.*

body, the body is quickened, and stirs even in the womb. True, but that motion is not *rational*, but only *animal*. Even after the infant is born, it cannot move itself *rationally*, till the senses are first able to exercise themselves, and be actually conversant about and Upon their proper objects, and present the same to the understanding faculty by the imagination and common sense. So it is in the spiritual being. Therefore it doth not follow that infants must be presently made believers and regenerate actually, so as to move spiritually, as soon as the Spirit is given to them.

This is the answer, not only as Saint Augustine in his 57 *Epistle ad Dandanum*, as I have shown before in the fifth chapter, but also of Peter Martyr, Dr. Whitaker, and others which I will not here repeat, having already set down their words at large. So also Daneus saith this, not only on Saint Augustine's *Enchiridion*, but also in his *Treatise of the Sacraments*, where he saith that, "look what efficacy baptism hath in persons of years, the same it hath upon infants, although infants do not manifest the same, nor bring forth the fruits thereof, as those of years do, but yet afterwards they do it, when they come to age of discretion." Mister Aynsworth, in his *Censure of the dialogue of the Anabaptists*, is copious in this exact particular. See page 44. He saith, "If we cannot justly object against God's work in nature, but do believe that our infants are reasonable creatures, and are not borne brute beasts but men; though actually they can manifest no reason or understanding no more than beasts (yes, a young lamb knoweth and discerneth his mother sooner, than an infant knoweth his mother) then neither can we justly object, against God's work in grace, but are to believe that our infants are sanctified creatures, *etc*." And again, page 45, answering that cavil of theirs, that if infants have any grace, it would appear by the acts and exercise of it. He saith the following,

> "They reason ignorantly and perversely not only against the light of God's Word, but of nature. As if some brutish person should plead thus: A man is a living creature that hath a reasonable soul, and the proper affections of a man, as he is a man, are the faculty of understanding, of thinking, capableness of learning, of remembering, reasoning, judging, and discerning true and false, good and evil, etc. Now let them which affirm infants are born

men, as Christ doth (Job 16:21) prove that infants do understand, think, remember, judge, discern good and evil, approve, will, speak, etc., or else they say nothing. Were not such a disputer worthy to be laughed and hissed at, who requires the actual use and manifestation of human affections and faculties in infants, which are in them but potentially and in the seed and beginning. And because they cannot declare these things by their works, therefore he denieth them to be of the generation of mankind, or born men into the world, or that they have the faculties of men in them, any manner of way. Even such is the argumentation of these erroneous spirits against the truth of religion."

So he speaks this in that manner.

By this little, so much is gotten that, if all the divines who have professedly entered into the particular consideration of this point, are not out, and, if the Anabaptists are not right, *there is a possibility for the Spirit to be in an infant, and yet not presently manifest His presence by any work of grace actually, so as it may be seen and known either by the infant himself, or by the beholders.*

2. Wherefore in the next place I say, that since the Spirit may be in an infant, and yet not work actual faith and regeneration, therefore the consequence of this proposition that concludes *the Spirit to be idle if He works not such grace*, must necessarily be false also. Must He necessarily be *idle*, and doth not always let us see His work? Shall we conclude He doth nothing, because He will not tell us what He doth? Hath He no work but one, in an infant? Do we know all the works of God? Or shall we deny all that we do not know? This is a bold speech to say, either the Spirit must work this or that particular work in an infant, which He usually worketh in all persons of years where He pleases to dwell, or else He is idle. Was great Basil a blasphemer when he affirmed[234] that, "like as art is in the artificer, so is the Spirit in him that hath received him; he is always present, but doth not always work. For art is always

[234] De Spiritu Sancto, chapter 26: κα ς τεκν η ν τ ναλαβόντ ι α τή ν, ο τωὶῳ ᾗ ἐ ᾧᾷ ὐ ὗ ς ᾗ χάρι ς το Πνε ύμ ατο ς ν τ ῦ ἐ ᾧὐ π οδεξ αμ έν ω, ε μ ν σ υ μ π αρο σ α, ο χᾷὶ ὲ ῦ ὐ δ κα νεργο σ α διηνεκ. π ε κα τέκν η δυν άμ ε ι μ ν ν τ ὶ ὲ ὶὲ ῦ ῶς ἐ ὶ ὶῆ ὲ ἐ ᾧ τεκνίτ η στί ν, νεργεί α δ τότ ε, τα ν κα τ ′ α τ ν νεργ. ο τ ω κα τ Πνε μα ἐ ἐ ὲ ὅ ὐὴ ἐ ᾗ ὗ ὶ ὸ ῦ ᾷε μ ν σ υ μ π άρεστ ι το ς ξίοι ς, νεργε δ κα τ α τ ν χρεία ν, etc.ὶ ὲ ῖ ὰ ἑ ῖ ὲ ὴ

in the artificer potentially, but then it is said to be in him, actually, when he exerciseth it; so the Spirit is always present to such as are worthy, but He works only as their benefit and necessity may require?" To such therefore as are ready to say to me of the work of the Spirit, as Thomas of Christ, *except I see and feel, I will not believe*. I can do no more than the disciples did to Thomas; *viz*. let them alone, until the Spirit Himself doth bid them feel and see, by persuading them to believe this truth. For however I cannot demonstrate in what manner the Spirit initially worketh in an infant, the first principles of regeneration, because the work is secret, and both the work and manner of working are hidden from us.[235] Yet I answer such as put me to it, as Calvin did the Anabaptists,[236] "There is a work of the Spirit in them; although we cannot comprehend what it is, yet we must not therefore conclude that there is no work at all;" and (as Dr. Whitaker determined the question of the work of grace in infants for a close of his disputation touching that subject)[237] *We say that the Holy Ghost works in them, in a manner to us inexplicable*. Both Calvin, and Peter Martyr, and Doctor Whitaker, are all clear of opinion that there is some work of the Spirit in an infant, and yet not any of them apart, nor all of them together, dare to determine what that work is. Calvin saith, it is certain there is *some work*; Peter Martyr saith, *it is enough that we believe they have the Spirit, the root and principle of future grace, and that if they die in infancy, they are saved*. Dr. Whitaker comes after, and saith the very same, illustrates his and Peter Martyr's opinion by the former comparison of the *reasonable soul*, commends Calvin for his modesty, and professes that he would *most willingly be his scholar that could take off all difficulties from this point*. It is therefore an unreasonable and captious demand of the adversaries to this position, to require of me to show what the Spirit doth in an in-

[235] *Ille in quo omnes vivificabuntur, praeterquam quod se ad iustitiam exemplum imitantibus praebuit, dat etiam sui spiritus occultissimam fidelibus gratiam, quam latenter infundit et parvulis.* Augustine, *De Peccatorum Meritis et Remissione*, Book 1, chapter 9.

[236] *At quomodo, inquiunt, regenerantur infantes, nec boni nec mali cognitione praediti? Nos autem respondemus, opus Dei, etiamsi captui nostro non sbiaceat, non tamen esse nullum. - Institutes, Book 4, chapter 16, section 17.*

[237] *In eis operari Spiritum Sanctum ineffabiliter dicimus. De Sacr. Controv. de Bapt. Quaest. 4, cap. 6.*

fant, or else to confess that He is idle, or rather not there at all. So much for an answer to the *major*, which would conclude from a false ground, and groundless position, that the Spirit cannot be in infants, because where He is, He cannot be idle, and, He cannot but be idle, if He doth not work in them *actual* grace.

2. I come now to the *minor proposition*, which was this*: But in elect infants, ordinarily, no such work doth appear; rather on the contrary, many of them show manifest opposition to all grace and goodness, for many years together, notwithstanding their baptism*. And to this I give a threefold answer.

1. That although no such work doth appear in them,[238] yet this doth not prove that no such work is begun secretly in the soul, as I have before showed, in answer to the former proposition. Nor is it impossible that even actual grace should lie hidden, so as neither others, nor the party himself in whom that grace is, can discern the same at all times, as after shall be declared.

2. That I never affirmed any actual change of the soul, in the baptism of infants that afterwards live to years of discretion; no, nor so much as any particular habits of particular graces, answerable to those that are usually wrought in others at the time of their actual conversion. Yea so far have I been from affirming of it, that I have always on all occasions disclaimed it. But I only say that, the Spirit is given to elect infants, in baptism, ordinarily, (pardon my so often repetition of the substance of the position, which the adversaries so often forget) to be the first principle of regeneration in them, and as the first seed, by which the heart is seized upon for Christ, and the whole man taken up for his use, and made in a secret manner capable of a further work, in God's good time. This Spirit is, to such, in the room of grace, as Peter Martyr affirms,[239]

[238] Calvin in Matthew 19:14, *Talium est regnum Dei.* Thus he writes of infants: *Quod poenitentiam vitaeque novitatem simul illic figurari abiciunt, facilis solutio est, renovari Dei spiritu pro aetatis modulo, donec per gradus suo tempore quae in illis occulta est virtus augescat, et palam refulgeat.* That infants do cast off all repentance and newness of life that are jointly figured in baptism, the answer (to such as object this against the baptizing of infants) is easy: that they are renewed by the Spirit of God according to the capacity of their age, until by degrees that efficacy or virtue which lies hid in them do in due season increase, and openly sparkle and shine forth.

[239] Loc. Com. class. 4, cap. 8, sect. 14.

and the root also out of which all grace in due time flows, in all God's children, as the same author (who is also seconded by Dr. Whitaker) further speaketh; and as Calvin had done, before him. This principle of grace lies hid, as seed underground; as wheat under chaff; as fire under the ashes; as the faculty of reason seems to lie asleep, until a child is grown up to some capacity; and as the Spirit of God moved on the waters before the several creatures were actually produced by the word of His power.

By this we may discern what answer to give to that dilemma, urged by some to this effect*: viz.*, "If the Spirit is given to an infant in baptism, either the infant is alive or dead, regenerate or unregenerate? Regenerate he is not, because there is in him no actual change; and how can the Spirit of regeneration abide in him that is unregenerate for a long space after the Spirit first entereth into him?" To this I say, that the infant is alive and regenerate *seminally*, and *initially*, in respect of the root and principle of life, but not *actually* in respect of the particular habits actually wrought in him. An infant may be said to be alive as soon as he hath received a soul; yet he cannot be said to be alive actually in respect of a rational life until the soul is able to act in a rational manner. Of such a one we cannot say he is not alive, because he hath in him the reasonable soul the principle of life. Nor yet can we say that he lives a rational life, until his reasonable soul doth put itself forth to rational actions. Therefore, all men conclude such an infant to be alive *potentially*, and not *actually*, in respect of that *rational* life of which we now speak. The same distinction will solve the present argument, and so is it resolved by all that touch upon the point, as I have often shown. That which I have urged out of St. Augustine, Calvin, Peter Martyr, Dr. Whitaker, and Daneus, I will not rehearse in this place, which yet I might do in a large treatise, for their sakes that cannot easily carry all with them. Only I will add one passage more of Daneus, not before mentioned, "Infants by baptism are ingrafted into Christ, for as much as by nature they are aliens from God. And they are baptized, not that they should presently express the fruits of their regeneration in Christ, which might be conspicuous to us, but that in the mean season until they come to years being confirmed with the seal of the covenant, and given to God, they might

be preserved and remain to His use. For when the time shall be accomplished they will bring forth the same fruits that they do who are baptized in riper age." There is then in them a seed of grace however, it doth not presently spring up and bear fruit; and in respect of that seed we say they are not wholly without life and regeneration; as the smoking flax, as soon as it begins to smoke, is not wholly without fire in it, although as yet it is not wholly kindled by that fire.

This is, I confess, a great secret, a deep mystery of God whose works are unsearchable, and his ways, past finding out. However, the incomprehensibleness of it must not make us to deny it; unless we resolve to believe no more than we see, or can fathom with the short line of our weak reason, which were a sinful resolution that would breed many errors[240] both in judgment and practice, of dangerous and desperate consequence. There are works as strange in nature, yet no man makes doubt of their truth because he cannot come to see how they are done. Therefore, we must take heed how we deny the Spirit to be in infants to work in such a strange manner, forasmuch as the works of grace are more strange and admirable than any work in nature. The wise king wisely gives a check to their curiosity, that are too bold in prying into the secrets of God, and that by posing them in a point of natural philosophy. "As you know not what is the way of the Spirit, nor how the bones do grow in the womb of her that is with child; even so you know not the works of God who maketh all," (Ecclesiastes 11:5).

3. I answer that however I will not affirm any actual grace to be, ordinarily, in infants; yet we may oftentimes see strange and admirable sparks of grace, and footsteps of the Spirit, in diverse infants, long before they come to any ability of discourse. So as for all we know, the elect might ordinarily attain to actual regeneration much sooner than many of them do, if there were that care taken of them by parents, that ought to be, in *catechizing and training them up in their infancy, in the way that they should walk; for so, would they*

[240] Augustine, *De Peccatorum Meritis et Remissione*, Book 3, chapter 8: *Ecce unde plerumque convalescit error, cum homines idonei sunt his rebus interrogandis, quibus intelligendis non sunt idonei.* Idem, *De Bono Perseverantiae*, chapter 14: *Nunquid ideo negandum est quod apertum est, quia comprehendi non potest quod occultum est? Nunquid, inquam, propterea dicturi sumus quod ita esse perspicimus non ita esse, quoniam cur ita sit non possumus invenire?*

not forget it when they are old, if Solomon did not mistake this. (And how could he mistake in that, which the Spirit Himself dictated unto him?) that part therefore of the objection which saith that, *for many years they make opposition to all grace, etc*., however it makes a great noise, and seems to aggravate the matter much against this position, yet it hath in it more sound than weight. For the reason why so many stand out so long, is not always or ordinarily from the want of efficacy in their baptism, but from defect of education. Either they did not live under careful, faithful, religious parents that would have been diligent with all their might to teach them the fear of the Lord, by all ways and means of instruction and good example, to pray continually for them, to watch over them narrowly to keep them from evil company and evil practices; or else, they lacked a powerful ministry, or both. And if they lack either, the other, for the most part, doth little good. Cast your eyes upon such as have not lacked for either of the former helps, and tell me how many you can find of those that ever come to good at all (in respect of the best good,) who do not, ordinarily, take in religion and grace insensibly even from their tender youth, so as many of them cannot, with their best search, find out directly, the time of their conversion, although they cannot (when they are themselves, free from temptation) deny themselves to be converted. As for such as have enjoyed the former means, and yet fly out into debauched courses, they seldom or never return to God at all; and therefore do not marvel if they stand out long, notwithstanding the helps afforded; for they, by this, did not declare themselves to be of the number of God's elect; and so, not of those in whom baptism is so efficacious as here we affirm it to be. And as for such as stand out longest and come in at the end, you shall, ordinarily, observe them to be such as had ungodly or careless parents; or, no sound and powerful ministry; or had the reins too soon let loose to them; or were poisoned with bad examples of parents, governors, or companions, or were not instantly plucked out of some delightful sins, before they were rooted in their wickedness, by some type of long example, *etc*. And then, what a wonder it is if they live many years without actual conversion and actual re-

generation. Notwithstanding, if you ask some of these, after they are converted, whether in the time of their rebellion, they did not have sometimes strong conflicts in themselves to break off their wickedness, and to come in, and whether they did not sometimes find inward risings of heart against their secret sins, even for the very filthiness of them, as well as for the danger and they will, for the most part, answer, *yea, if they had had the grace to accept and follow those good motions within them; but they found the contrary, that after such inward stirrings to conversion, their lusts have presently raged and burst out more strongly, than at other times*. This is the confession, in substance of many of them, which shows them not to be wholly destitute of the Spirit, even when the flesh was most violent and insolent in them, before actual conversion. And this observation (seconded by others of far greater experience) is mentioned here merely to still their cry which tell us that, "many are unconverted thirty, forty, fifty years; and is it likely, they say, the Spirit should be all that while in them, and never actually convert them unto God?" Although He can work without means, yet that He might grace those of His own institution, He doth not, usually work without them, when He granteth them. And when He uses them He doth not always perform the work at the first, or second, or many assays of His ministers; because He would have us to know upon Whom, after *Paul hath planted and Apollos watered, the increase depended.*

By all that hath been spoken, we now see that it is not universally true; which the major proposition supposes, *viz*. that *the Spirit must either work actual faith and regeneration, or else be confessed to be idle*; and that it is of no validity which the *minor* assumes and affirms, *viz. that in infants ordinarily no such work appeareth, but rather the contrary for many years after baptism*. For it is possible for the Spirit to work, although He doth not work actual grace; nor is it material, that such grace doth not appear because there is no necessity that any particular habit of grace should be at that time in them at all. And therefore I conclude that this objection is of no strength, forasmuch as it concludes nothing against the point in question, the premises being thus examined and searched to the bottom.

6. Objection. The very seed of grace cannot be in the same subject in whom there is reigning sin, as is plain by that of the Apostle, 1 John 3:10, "Whosoever is born of God sins not, for His seed remains in him, and he cannot sin, because he is born of God." *But in infants baptized, till they are actually regenerated, sin reigneth. Therefore the Spirit is not given unto them as the seed of after grace?*

Answer. 1. To the major proposition, I answer it in three ways.

1. There is an ambiguity in the word, *seed*. For, *seed* may be taken two ways, *actively*, and *passively*. 1. *Actively* for some actual efficient principle of grace going before both the acts and habits of particular graces; which, (as in the natural, so in the spiritual seed) we may term *seed seeding*. Even as those first plants or herbs, in the creation, were termed herbs[241] *seeding seed*. (Gen. 1:29). 2. *Passively*, for that yield, or fruit which is produced by its active principle, which may be called *seed seeded*, as in the former place of Genesis 1 may also be seen. Now, when, with other divines, I say that the Spirit is given to elect infants as the *seed* of future actual grace, I do not speak of a seed *passive*, or *produced*; but of the seed as *active* or *producing* a further seed in due time and season. But contrarily, the Apostle St. John speaks of seed in the other sense, which imports at least the particular habits of sanctifying and saving grace infused by this *seeding seed* of which we treat. This is manifested in the words of the text*: Whosoever is born of God, sinneth not*. That is, whosoever is actually regenerated, doth not commit sin, as all expound the place, and the reason is given, *because His seed abides in him*, which is no other than the *habits of grace* infused by the Spirit, as all acknowledge. Therefore this proposition doth not speak to the point, because it understands by *seed*, another thing from that which we mean in our assertion. I do not speak of seed in the *ear*, but of the corn's seed cast into the ground, that afterwards yields and brings forth the blade, the stalk, the ear, and all that grows upon it.
2. I answer that I cannot see what absurdity would follow by granting that *initial regeneration* may stand with actual reigning sin, because however a man hath by the first principle of regeneration

[241] זרע זרע, Seminificantem semen, ut vertit, Arias Montanus.

a possibility of making opposition against sin when that possibility comes into act; yet he is not by that possibility alone enabled for the present actually to resist sin, (which resistance is a fruit of actual conversion), no more than a man is enabled actually to reason and discourse as soon as the reasonable soul is infused, before his senses do actually exercise themselves upon their proper objects, and thereby give occasion to the rational faculty to exercise itself. Therefore, as in an infant which may afterwards prove a very wise man, the principle of reason may and doth consist with actual folly, until that child hath his senses exercised to discern between good and evil; so, in the same infant, the first principle of regeneration (which we term *initial* or *potential*[242] regeneration) may stand with such sins that in outward appearance (for all any man can discern) are none other than reigning sins, which a man gives himself up to the commission of, without reluctance or fear. The ground we had but now. No man either doth or can make actual opposition against any sin, as sin, from any inward principle of grace, till he is actually a new creature, endowed with habitual and actual graces of the Spirit; as appears by that very text now urged against me. For, who is he that doth not give himself to sin, but he that is born of God?

3. I add further, that if this objection were of force against infants, it would be much more such against persons of years actually converted. For, it would prove that they do not have the Spirit constantly abiding in them, because it doth not, in great falls, evidently show itself at all; but sin seems to prevail so far, as that (for all any onlookers, or themselves, can judge) the flesh hath gotten full dominion over them. For, they often sin without any apparent reluctance at all. Where was any appearance of the Spirit in Peter when through the strength of fear, and weakness of faith, he not only denied his Master and Saviour again and again, against his conscience, but, thinking by it to better save himself, took liberty to show himself in that exigent a man of another stamp and disposition, than Christ and his disciples were of, and fell to raging, to swearing and cursing; when as no man, or thing (unless his

[242] I call initial regeneration potential, in respect of the habits and acts of particular graces.

own fear and cowardice) urged him to it? You will say, that was a sudden unexpected surprise, and so could not be a premeditated sin; and, he was no sooner down, but he got up again. True; but this doth not satisfy. For, in the carriage of that business, as short as that time was, what grace appeared? What degree of evil was lacking to make that, in all outward appearance, a *reigning sin*? You will say (which indeed is the truth, if St. Augustine, Chrysostom, and Theophilact, (as Bellarmine[243] himself shall witness) the Spirit at that time suspended the act of grace, and lay as it were eclipsed in him, to make him (who beforehand boasted so much of his valor,) better to know himself. This I acknowledge to be true; but this will not serve their point, who must ever see the fruits of the Spirit, or deny him to be there.

If this of Peter will not serve for a sufficient example to show that sin may (as far as men can judge by looking on) so far prevail, as that it may seem to the beholder, to reign in some that are (questionless) actually regenerated and renewed, because that was but a sudden assault, and lasted but for a small space, then what do you say to David? For, however his adultery grew from a sudden temptation occasionally objected, yet his sending for Uriah, the making of him drunk, the murdering of him in the battle, and the drawing of Joab into the conspiracy, were deep premeditated plots; and he wallowed in all this mire and blood (as most divines think) for the space of almost a year before he recovered himself, and ere the Spirit stirred in him, sensibly, to any purpose again. What shows of the Spirit here? What opposition? What was here lacking of reigning sin? You will say, *There might be inward combats*? I do not deny what *might* be, but yet show me what appeared. If no work appeared in all that time, it is then possible that the Spirit may lie hid, and that for a long time together, in some persons actually converted, and not be discerned. I know David had the Spirit all the while, as appears by that prayer of his, *take not thy Holy Ghost from me*. (Psalm 51:11). But I deny any sensible working of it that was able to difference *David*, by any outward carriage, in any man's apprehension (I do not except his own) from a mere carnal man that

[243] De Pontif. Rom. lib. 4, cap. 3.

ever made any formal show of religion, in the interim between his fall and recovery.

If any man replies, "It is perhaps true that David lay in that miserable estate, for so long a time as you mention; but what is that to so many years as even the elect lie in sin, before their actual conversion?" To this I must answer, 1. That if the Spirit lie hid a year, a week, or but an hour, He may (possibly) lie hid twenty years. That which the objection drives at is, to prove that such a thing is *not possible to be done at all*; for that which is possible to be, for a short time, is not impossible for a longer space. 2. It is more for the Spirit to lie hid in a person actually converted for the space of a year together, than for Him to lie hid in any other, forty years, as it is more for a wise man to play the fool once, then for a child, or a fool, to do nothing else. 3. If you think the instance of David doth not come home close enough, then (to close) take also that of Solomon, his son. He lay for many years before he repented. He fell from God to flat idolatry, and that not suddenly, but by slow degrees; when he was in it, he laid still for long continuance, in so much that some make a doubt whether ever he recovered. Yet those men that do oppose this position will not, I think, deny Solomon to be regenerated by the Spirit before that fall, or to have the Spirit still abiding in him in all that time of his fall, to restore him again. Therefore it cannot reasonably be denied that, forasmuch as the Spirit may and sometimes doth lie hid in persons actually regenerate, for a long time together not showing itself apparently in opposition against great and scandalous sins, it is not impossible for the Spirit to be in an infant elected from the time of his baptism until his actual conversion without any such manifest opposition against sin, as may give the person in whom He is, any ground to believe that the dominion of sin is taken away from out of his soul. So much, in answer to the *major.*

2. To the *minor proposition* (that, *in infants sin reigns, till they are actually regenerated*) I answer that there is a *dominion* in the full strength, and a dominion that is in the progressive decrease, like that of a prince who yet is possessed of his kingdom which daily becometh (like the house of Saul) weaker and weaker. There is a dominion which is more *intense*, and in the highest degree; and there is a

dominion which is more *remiss*, and improperly so called. This distinction hath footing in the Scripture, which saith of some that *sin shall not have dominion over them*; and the reason is added, because they *are under grace* (Romans 6:14). This is a dominion in the highest degree. It saith to others, *let not sin reign in your mortal bodies* (Romans 6:12). This is a dominion in a more *remiss* degree, as sin is taken for a masterly tyrant that hath, by lack of vigilance in a Christian, gotten the upper hand in some particular. Unto this, they to whom he wrote were subject, if they did not look better about them. For the Apostle himself, even after his actual regeneration, complains that sin was yet a, "law in his members, warring against the law of his mind, and bringing him into captivity to the law of sin," (Romans 7:23). Now, in that he calls the power of sin by the name of a *law*, that did captivate him, he plainly intended to give us notice of some kind of sovereignty which sin, at some times, exercised over him, after his conversion. This will appear by comparing this phrase with the very same in verses 1 and 2. "The Law hath dominion over a man as long as he liveth. For the woman which hath a husband is bound by the law to her husband so long as he liveth; but if her husband is dead, she is loosed from the law of her husband." That is, from the power and sovereign authority, which in the family her husband did exercise over her. So that where there is a law in force, and exercising itself, there is a kind of dominion; for none can set up a law, and give such life to it, but such as have sovereign authority. And if it might be like this in Paul, then much more in the Romans to whom he wrote. Therefore he bids them to take heed and not to let it reign that they should obey it in its lusts. And yet they were regenerated, for he saith, *they were under grace* (verse 14), and so under grace, that he assures them, *sin should not have dominion over them*; as there he speaketh. That is, not an *absolute and complete dominion*, which cannot stand with saving grace; although they were in danger to be under some kind of dominion of it, notwithstanding grace. So then, there is an *absolute dominion* which cannot consist with saving grace, and there is an *improper* and more *remiss dominion*, which may be for a while, in the same subject, with saving

grace. If any man asks me, what that *absolute dominion* is, in a word I conceive it to be this, *viz. Such a complete sovereignty over the whole man as makes him to be totus, totum, in toto peccato, whole, wholly, in the whole sin he gives himself up to, wittingly, willingly, willfully, desiring he may ever lie in that sin and enjoy his fill of it, that there were no law forbidding it, nor God to punish it; and, although there are both, yet he will follow it still, and cannot for his heart so much as get free of the love of it and desire after it, but will part with anything rather than with his sin*. This, in Scripture, is called *presumptuous sin*, (Psalm 19). But this no man can warrantably affirm to be in elect persons after their baptism, even before their actual regeneration. And I think if I should deny the proposition, they that frame it have need to take enough time to prove it. For to tell me that they commit many gross and scandalous sins, that they are (as Paul was*) persecutors and blasphemers*, doth not sufficiently prove that sin hath any *absolute* dominion over them*, ordinarily*, although, in respect of their outward carriage, no man can discern their sins to be other than *reigning sins*, for so, you know, people do many sins committed by such as are actually renewed. Therefore their outward carriage alone is not enough to warrant such a censure of them. That sin reigneth and domineereth as a tyrant over them in a more remiss degree than it doth in reprobates, is too, too evident by daily leading them into captivity to the law of sin. This is not denied. But for any man to say that the elect, after their baptism until their actual conversion and regeneration, are under that absolute and complete dominion of sin that the devils and reprobates are, is a thing which may be said, but will never be proved. For, suppose the Spirit did not work any general dispositions and inclinations unto grace in infants (which yet the soundest divines affirm) yet it is something that there is that is in them which will so far abate the edge of the malice of sin that they cannot sin that great sin against the Holy Ghost. No elect person can (according to the principle which the adversaries to this point and I agree in,) sin that sin against the Holy Ghost, as the opposites will freely confess. For, if he could, how would it be possible for him to be at all converted and saved? And if, notwithstanding, his lack of *actual* regenera-

tion, he cannot sin against the Holy Ghost; I demand then, what is it that keeps him from that sin? Is it not the Spirit that restrains and curbs the malice of his corruption against God and His grace? But you will say, this restraint is common to reprobates as well as to the elect, for the most part; and therefore I may (you say) as well prove the Spirit to be in the one, as in the other, if this is all the ground I have for it. To which I rejoin that there is a main difference between the elect and the reprobate, *viz*. that the elect not only *do not*, but *cannot* commit that sin. For the Spirit keeps him that he may be a vessel of grace and honor. But the reprobates are restrained, not by the Spirit of Christ, but rather by the powerful providence of God merely that they might not hurt the elect, as otherwise they would do. And yet notwithstanding that restraint, they are never converted nor saved, which shows that they never had the Spirit of Christ. Nor are there in the elect such near approaches to that sin, as there are in reprobates. But of this I shall have some occasion to speak more afterwards. Therefore I spare to add more thereof this here, praying the reader to remember that I have various other grounds besides this, so as, whatever becomes of this, the point itself cannot suffer by it, so long as the other stand *unbattered*. And thus much of this sixth objection.

CHAPTER X. Six Objections More Against the Main Position Answered.

I have in the former chapter given answer to such objections as are thought to be of chiefest rank, and to make most strongly against the main tenet here discussed. In performance of which, I have not (God is witness) strained my wits to set a show upon any one passage which hath not substance in it, so far as I am able to judge between substance and shadows. Rather, I have dealt candidly and sincerely throughout, to the full satisfaction of my own conscience, and I hope to the content of others also that are not studious of parts, but of the truth. I might therefore justly demand my *quietus est*, and crave a discharge here, because the main work is over, and those objections that follow after are of less weight. But, because I am willing to give every man an answer to the least appearance of an argument against this position, as well as to those of more strength and substance, I will in this chapter add answers to all the rest that ever I could yet see, or read, or hear of, so as no man shall have cause either to complain that I have slighted him by not giving answer to his objections, or to triumph over my silence, as if, in that, I did acknowledge his reasons to be unanswerable.

7. *Objection. What circumcision was to the believing Jews, that baptism is now to elect Christians, since baptism succeeds in the room of circumcision. But in circumcision the Spirit was not given ordinarily, to the elect themselves, as appears in the Apostle Saint Paul himself, who long after his circumcision thus Complaineth, I am carnal, sold under sin* (Romans 7:14*) I was a blasphemer, a persecutor, and injurious* (1 Timothy 1:13) and in Titus 3:3 *he puts himself among the sort of unhallowed persons. For we ourselves, he saith, were sometimes foolish, disobedient, serving diverse lusts and pleasures, living in malice and envy, hateful and hating one another. Therefore, the Spirit is not, ordinarily, given in baptism, no not to the elect.*

I *answer*. 1. To the *major*; then, to the *minor* proposition in order, thus.

1. To the *major*; that it may be understood three ways, and it holds true but only in one of the three. For *circumcision* may be said to be the

same with baptism, either in respect of the *substance* which both do lead to, *viz. Christ's blood and Spirit*, or in respect of the manner of representation; or lastly, in respect of the *measure* of grace conferred. The proposition holds true only in the first of these three. And even in that, it must be considered that, the Apostle calls *circumcision a seal of the righteousness which is by faith*. (Romans 4:11); that is, of that righteousness which the Gospel proclaims, and not of that which is expected by the *law*. Now, the *seal of righteousness* to the *elect*, is not the outward ceremony alone, but the inward grace annexed thereunto, and exhibited and conferred therewith. And the *seal* by which they are sealed, is *the earnest of the Spirit in their hearts* (2 Cor. 1:22). If therefore the *elect* were *sealed* in circumcision, it follows that they received the *Spirit*. As for the manner of representing the inward grace of the sacrament, and for the *measure* of grace conferred in the sacrament, I do not doubt to say with judicious Calvin,[244] (forasmuch as Dr. Whitaker[245] hath so answered before me, and calls Calvin a most complete divine, for so saying), "The sacraments of the Old Testament were called shadows, not because they did not at all represent Christ; but because they did it less clearly and significantly, than ours do, and because there is a more plentiful measure of grace of the Spirit conferred in ours, than was in them." The *major* proposition then comes short of what it should; because it ought to affirm that, *there is no more efficacy in baptism, in respect of the measure of grace conferred, than was of old, in circumcision*; which both Mr. Calvin and Dr. Whitaker deny. That proposition therefore doth not prove anything of worth.

2. I deny the *minor; viz*. that, *in circumcision the Spirit was not ordinarily given to the elect*, notwithstanding the instance of blessed Paul, *for:*

1. It is not good arguing to say *Paul did not have the Spirit, in circumcision; therefore none of the elect did ordinarily then receive it*. They that deny our main position, will not deny that any at all do receive the Spirit. The only thing they take offence at is, that I say, *this is ordi-*

[244] Institutes, Book 4, chapter 14, section 22. Nec non in Antidoto.

[245] *Cum Calvino integerrimo Theolog. Respondeo: vetera sacramenta umbras dici, non quod non omnio, Christum representarent, sed quod minus clare & significanter id facerent, quam nostra, & quod in, nostris uberior spiritus gratia se proferat quam in illis. Whitaker, de Sacram in gene. – Question 5, chapter 2.*

nary in the baptism of the elect. For, they say, some particular cases do not prove an ordinary practice. Now then, I retort their own rule upon them. What if Paul did not have the Spirit? Doth this prove that none at all have Him? He that saith the Spirit is *ordinarily* given, but not *always*, may say true, notwithstanding one or two instances, in which it falls out otherwise. If they do not like that, I should from the particular instance of John the Baptist, infer that *all are sanctified in the womb*. What reason have they to conclude from one example that the thing is not ordinarily done at all*? Viz*. Paul did not have it; therefore, ordinarily, none have it. This is but trifling and unequal dealing.

2. I say, that I will not doubt to maintain that Paul (who saith of himself that*, God separated him from his mother's womb*, Gal. 1:15), received the Spirit in circumcision, notwithstanding anything to the contrary in any of those places alleged for confirmation of the *minor* proposition. For, let us examine them, and we shall find that they fall short of proving that which they are produced for.

1. That place in Romans 7 *(I am carnal and sold under sin*;) is confessed by all orthodox divines to be spoken in the person of a man actually *regenerated*; to show what he is, in part, even after his regeneration in respect of the flesh lusting against the Spirit, and leading him oftentimes *into captivity to the Law of sin*. And so this confirms what I formerly affirmed in answer to the sixth objection, touching on some kind of *reigning* sin that the regenerate are not wholly freed from.[246] For, in respect of the victory of sin over them, at some times, in some particulars, sin may be said to reign; because it hath so gotten the upper hand, that it leads them captive. Yet it doth not *absolutely reign*, because they do not freely and wholly give themselves up unto it, without any desire to change Lords. They *are sold under sin*, but yet they do not, as Ahab*, sell themselves*

[246] The dominion of sin in the regenerate (which is but improperly called a dominion) may be distinguished from the proper dominion of sin in reprobates, by the instance in two men swimming in a strong tide, one swimming against the tide, the other with it. They are both carried down the stream by the strength of the water, but one strives against it even when he is most violently carried away with it, the other is carried away and never strives but puts out all his strength to swim along with the tide willingly and willfully, with delight and desperate resolution.

to work wickedness. They are overcome, yet they obey not willingly, but only unwillingly suffer, in respect of the part regenerate. In the same sense also, the same Apostle calls them *carnal* (1 Cor. 3:3), whom but a little before (verse 1) he had pronounced *babes in Christ*. This place therefore doth not prove Paul to be without the Spirit, in his circumcision, no more than it proves him to be destitute of it even after his actual regeneration. Wherefore, now I turn this weapon back on the objectors themselves, and urge it in this way against them. If the Spirit may be in such as are *carnal, and sold under sin*, then He may be in elect infants, although carnal and sold under sin. For if he may be yet in part carnal, whom no man will deny to have the Spirit, the Spirit may be in elect infants that are not, after baptism, under an *absolute* dominion of sin, as hath been before proved. So far as there is any flesh not totally subdued, so far there is a want of the Spirit even in a person regenerated. Therefore, so far as there is the least abatement of the *absolute* dominion of sin, there is the Spirit notwithstanding that the party is yet so far *carnal*, as that he is *sold under sin*, and *led captive to the law of sin* in the general course of his conversation, till actual regeneration is worked within him.

2. That place in 1 Timothy 1:13 (where Paul saith, *I was a blasphemer, a persecutor, and injurious*,) doth not prove Paul to be utterly void of the Spirit, until his actual regeneration. For if it did, it must be either because the facts were so heinous as cannot agree to a regenerate man, or because he committed them with such a witting malice as cannot subsist with the Spirit of God in the same subject.

1. For the quality of the *facts*: David, after his conversion, committed as great sins, both in kind and heinousness, as ever Paul did in his kind, before his conversion. What greater sin did Paul commit, than adultery, drunkenness, and murder committed by David? Now, if the Spirit was in David notwithstanding so many sins that cried out at once (especially in a time of war, when, above all other times, he should have kept himself from every wicked thing (Deut. 3:9), why might He not be in Paul? If you say that, to kill a Christian as a Christian, that is, because he is a Christian, is a greater sin than to commit any other murder, I answer that it is

so, indeed, if the persecutor willingly murders a Christian, knowing him to be such, and doing it out of malice to Christ and His religion; otherwise, not. Let us therefore search a little further into the particular of Paul, and we shall find the following:

2. That Paul did not commit those sins out of malice to Christ and goodness, nor so much as out of knowledge; but only out of ignorance, that the *way* which he *blasphemed* and *persecuted*, was the truth. He made conscience of the Law of God, so far forth as he knew it to be the Law (Phil. 3:6), and was zealous towards God (Acts 22:3), even before his conversion. It was a blind zeal of the Law that made him to persecute the Gospel which he did not understand; and not any malice to God. So it follows in that very text now urged against me, *but I obtained mercy, because I did it ignorantly*. Yes further he professeth that he did no more than what he thought himself bound in conscience to do, merely in obedience unto God. For, he saith, "I verily thought with myself that I ought to do many things contrary to the name of Jesus of Nazareth," (Acts 26:9). And on this ground, he did all those things, with which he so deeply charges himself. Now, if David that committed as great sins for kind and greater, in regard of circumstances, (for he did it wittingly, willingly, with premeditation, knowing very well that he ought not to have done anything of that which he did), shall be allowed to have the Spirit, even at that very time, then with what reason can we deny the Spirit to St. Paul when he did those things, which in that text of 1 Timothy 1:13, he so much bewaileth and condemneth in himself? For as much as he protests that all this was but through ignorance of the truth, doing nothing wittingly either against God or his conscience, but only that which he erroneously supposed would be acceptable unto God. All this therefore, makes for me, and no way against me.

3. As for that place in Titus 3:3, which is thought to make strongest against me, it is as weak as those other two already examined. *We were sometimes foolish, etc*., the Apostle saith. When was that? After circumcision, say some. But how doth that appear? Those to whom he writes were never circumcised, for they were Gentiles. Nor is there one syllable of his own circumcision, nor any circum-

stance of the text that requires us so to understand it. But, he himself was circumcised? True, yet there is no mention in that place, that he was such after circumcision, as that he could not have the Spirit at all in him. He only shows what he, and they, and all men are by nature, before their effectual calling, or rather before their first initiation into Christ.

It will be replied, that this place shows what he was even after circumcision, for it contains a confession of various *actual sins* which must needs be committed after his circumcision, because he was circumcised the eighth day after his birth, at which age he could not commit those actual sins? To this I answer that he might be guilty of committing all those sins there reckoned up, and yet not wholly destitute of the Spirit, as hath been proved before. If the Spirit may be in such as are not actually converted, they may commit many gross sins, in their course of life. And in such he may be, notwithstanding the commission of such sins, since they may sometimes commit as gross sins who are actually converted, as we saw but now in the instance of David and others. I never affirmed (as the objection drawn from this text would suppose) that the Spirit is so given either in circumcision, or in baptism, as to keep the elect from actual sins. It is enough that the Spirit takes off that extremity of malice which is to be found in the sins of such as are not elected.

But haply, there may be more pregnant evidence in the words following*: viz*., in verses 4-7. I am content to join issue here also. The words are these. *But after that the love and kindness of God our Saviour toward man appeared, not by works of righteousness which we have done, but according to his mercy he saved us*. By what*? By the laver of regeneration and renewing of the Holy Ghost, which he shed on us abundantly through Jesus Christ our Saviour, that being justified freely by his grace, we should be made heirs according to the hope of eternal life*. And what of all this? Doth any of this prove that Paul did not have the Spirit in his circumcision? Yes, you will say, it doth. For Paul herein declares *how*, and *when*, he and the rest of whom he there speaks, were regenerated*; viz*., in their baptism, of which they were partakers, not until they were of ripe age, so as by faith they apprehended the inward grace, and so came to be partakers of the Spirit. But doth this place prove that Paul did not have

the Spirit before his baptism? I do not make this point for men saying that faith to apprehend the grace of his baptism did not work in him previously. Rather therefore it proves the contrary, that he received it in his circumcision; for it is plain, he had it before. And if he had it before, why not in his circumcision? "No, may some man say, not so, for in Acts 9:17, Ananias deals with him as with a mere carnal man wholly destitute of grace, and tells him that God had sent him to him that, *he might be filled with the Holy Ghost*; and, it follows in the next place, that, *he was baptized*, which shows that he did not have the Holy Ghost before that time." But to this I answer briefly that, this doth not prove that he did not have the Spirit, in any measure, before that time; for, it is not said, that God had sent Ananias unto him that he might *receive* the Holy Ghost; but *that* he might be *filled* with the Holy Ghost; and that not only to sanctification but to the performance of an Apostolical function. For it is afterward added, *that straightaway he preached Christ in the Synagogue* (verse 20). Now, although he received the Spirit in his circumcision, yet he was not *filled* with the Spirit, nor was he filled with the Spirit in the first instance of his reception of it, for the Spirit doth not work all His graces at once, but by degrees. It may here be remembered what hath been formerly spoken upon that place in Acts 2:39. Saint Peter bids those that *were pricked at their hearts, to repent and be baptized*; telling them that, so they *should receive the gift of the Holy Ghost*. Now if they must *repent*, certainly they must have the Holy Ghost to enable them to do this, otherwise they could not repent. Therefore, it must be confessed that their receiving of the Spirit in baptism was not a sufficient proof that they were baptized. Before they received Him, but more secretly and sparingly, now they received Him again, but more solemnly and plentifully. And thus we see that none of these places apart or together, even when they are closely compared, have in them any solid proof to make good the *minor* proposition, that *the Spirit was not given in circumcision*. And so we have overthrown this argument also without the least prejudice to our position.

8. Objection. Those places of Scripture that speak of baptism, do usually speak of the Spirit given before baptism; as that in Acts 10:44, "The Holy Ghost fell on them that heard the Word"; and then afterward it fol-

loweth in verse 47, "Can any man forbid water, that these should not be baptized that have received the Holy Ghost as well as we?" *or else they speak of faith or repentance going before baptism, which is equivalent to the former speech. For it supposeth a rejection of the Spirit before baptism. Therefore, baptism was not intended for the conferring of the Spirit, nor can the places of Scripture, brought to prove it, be sufficient proof of it, but rather of the contrary.*

Answer. 1. I confess it to be very true that some places speak of the giving of the Spirit before baptism. However that place in Acts 10 is improperly alleged for it; because it speaks of an extraordinary bestowing of the Spirit on such as Peter preached unto, in respect of the gift of tongues, as appears in verses 45-46, where it is said that, "They of the circumcision which believed, were astonished, as many as came with Peter, because that on the gentiles also was poured out the gift of the Holy Ghost; for they heard them speak with tongues, and magnified God." Notwithstanding, I say, it is manifested that faith and repentance were to precede the baptism of such as were of years, at least the public and solemn profession of those graces was to be made by them, before they were baptized. Yet, as not only Saint Ambrose, and Saint Augustine, and after them Calvin well speaketh, they received the Spirit in baptism *more solemnly*, which they had received *more secretly* before. They being of years, ought to express their faith, therefore there was a necessity of their receiving of the Spirit before baptism. But this doth not conclude that, *therefore it must necessarily be so in infants also*; forasmuch as in them *actual* faith is not required; nor yet that, *therefore elect infants do not receive the Spirit in baptism*; because there is no need of faith to receive the Spirit, but only need of the Spirit to work faith in due time.

2. I say that however some places do suppose the Spirit to be given before baptism, yet that doth not prove that therefore those places of Scripture which I have alleged, do prove no such thing as I would infer from here, because I have not brought one of those places for a proof, which mention *actual* faith and repentance, forasmuch as they concern persons of years only. Now this objection would have the world believe that I have taken up some of those places, for my use, which speak clearly of faith and repentance going be-

fore baptism, which is not so. And so it doth cast an unjust aspersion upon me, and not give any blow to the point itself.

3. I never affirmed that infants do not at all receive the Spirit before their baptism, but only that, baptism is the first instrument or means applied for their first solemn receipt of the Spirit, that may be taken notice of by us; as also for their first manifested initiation and engrafting into the body of Christ. Admit that they had the Spirit before, yet it doth not follow that they did not receive Him also in baptism, in respect of its confirmation, if not in respect of a further degree and measure of His grace. The Holy Ghost descended on Christ in His baptism, yet no man will say Christ did not have the Spirit before He was baptized. They, in Acts 2 before mentioned, were bid to *repent* before they were baptized, and no doubt they did so, which yet could not be without the Spirit, as I have often said. And yet for all that, the Apostle assured them that in baptism they should *receive the Holy Ghost*. What teaches us then, why elect infants should not do so too? I conclude therefore that, in persons of years the Spirit must go before, to qualify them with actual grace to make them capable of the inward grace of baptism, and to elect infants also, the Spirit may be given before baptism, but yet both to the one and to the other He is given again in baptism, in respect of the more solemn confirmation of it to them, so as those places of Scripture that prove the Spirit to be given before baptism, do not disprove him that saith, *the Spirit is given in baptism.*

9. *Objection. If there is no difference between an heir and a servant, an elect child and one not elected, until they come to years, and are effectually called by the Word, then the Spirit is not given to elect infants, in their baptism. But the antecedent is true, for Saint Paul saith it in express terms*. Gal. 4:1, "Now I say, That the heir, as long as he is a child, differeth nothing from a servant, though he be lord of all; but is under tutors and governors until the time appointed of the Father." *Therefore the consequence that the Spirit is not given to elect infants, in their baptism, is true also.*

Answer. 1. I grant the *major*, if it can be proved that there is no difference at all between one elected and a reprobate, either inwardly

or outwardly. But there may be a difference *inwardly* by some secret work of the Spirit, although no outward work appears, as hath been proved before.

2. I deny the *minor*, for, between the elect and reprobate there may be an inward difference, notwithstanding the place brought to confirm it. For that text is so miserably drawn awry, that anyone may discern it at the first calling of his eye upon that which followeth in the same place, so as I do not hold this argument high enough to give an answer. The Apostle doth not intend there to show the difference between the elect and reprobate, in their infancy, nor to declare that, they differ when they come to age, by the actual conversion of the one, and the final impenitency of the other. But, as Mr. Perkins on this place saith very well, "The Apostle uses a similitude borrowed from the civil law, and it may be framed thus, 'Heirs in their minority live in subjection to tutors and governors; but when they are of riper years, at the appointment of their parents, they are at liberty. Even so the people of God, before Christ, were in their infancy, under the law, as under a tutor. But when the fullness of time was come, which God had appointed, they entered into the fruition of their liberty." And Perkins speaks truly and pertinently. For, let any man view the place well, and he shall find the Apostle to have no other purpose at all, than to prove Christian liberty from Mosaical ceremonies of the Law, by the coming of Christ in the flesh, who was the body and substance of all those shadows. And that until this time, even the true heirs by virtue of God's election were as much bound to the observance of those legal rights as any others whatsoever, but now were freed from them, *in the fullness of time*, by the coming of Christ. Here is not one syllable touching our present argument. Therefore, for pity's sake, I will lay aside this *objection* and go on to the next.

10. *Objection. That position that ties the Spirit of God to means, can neither be safe nor true, for as much as God's Spirit is not tied but bloweth where it wisheth* (John 3*). But such is this. Therefore, it cannot be true?*

Answer. If we distinguish of the *major*, we shall find that it doth our assertion no hurt, and that we shall have cause to deny the *minor*. That position which ties the Spirit of God to means, where God hath

not first tied and engaged Himself, can neither be safe nor true. God is a free agent, and cannot be tied by any creature; and so I admit of that place in John 3, although, to speak properly and precisely, it is to be understood, rather of the freedom that God's Spirit takes to work *where* and in what persons He pleases; then, of the time *when* He worketh in those persons. For however this last, in some sense, is true too, yet it may well be the true meaning of that text. But admit this also, yet I say, what formerly I have said in chapter 3, that there is no danger to say that God is tied, so far forth as He hath granted to promise to be present in His own ordinance, ordinarily; nor is it untrue to say so, nor unwarrantable to expect it, yes and (in a humble manner) to require it of Him. Whatsoever God hath promised, we may safely say, He is tied to perform, for He is tied by that which cannot but hold Him, *viz*. His own *fidelity*. Therefore the Psalmist challengeth God as engaged to Him, Psa. 119:49, "Remember Thy promise unto Thy servant, in which Thou hast caused me to put my trust." And God bids His children do it, yes, to command Him in Isa. 45:11, "Thus saith the Lord, the Holy One of Israel and his Maker, Ask of Me things to come concerning My sons, and concerning the work of My hands COMMAND ye me." That is, whatever I have promised, require it, spare not, so they do it in a humble manner. Now that position which only affirms God to be present ordinarily, where He by virtue of His promise hath engaged Himself to be, doth not lay any unwarrantable tie upon God, but rather gives Him the honor of His fidelity, and puts comfort into His people, by giving them assurance of it.

Thus having distinguished of the *major* and made it appear that there may be an affirmation safe and true, which saith, *God is tied or engaged to some things*, so long as any promise going before can be found to engage Him, I come now to deny the *minor*, because however that position which ties God where He hath not tied Himself must necessarily be not only false, but full of presumption also, yet this position is no way guilty of any such thing. For God hath made a *promise* to show Himself thus gracious in the ordinance of baptism, ordinarily, when it is administered to elect infants, as the learned author of the Commentary upon the Epistle to Titus expressly avouches, saying, "here by virtue of His promise we may expect it, here we may

and ought to send out the prayer of faith for it." If any man shall doubt hereof, and demand where any such promise is to be found, I would refer him to Zech. 13:1, to Matt. 3, as also to the *institution* of baptism, in which a promise is involved; to Titus 3:5, in which a promise is supposed; and to various other places. If the doubting party doth not rest satisfied with these, then I refer him to the author himself, who surely can name some promise for it, else he would never have set down so much under his hand. He is still alive, and hath engaged himself both privately and publicly to make good anything written in that Commentary touching this point. Therefore I leave this work to him, and hasten to another objection, after I have added one short advertisement to such as will not be satisfied either by me, or by him, or by any man else, with any reason. There are some who complain that, however many Scriptures have been alleged by me and others, to prove that the Spirit is given in baptism, yet they cannot see any one place of Scripture that saith directly and in express terms, that, *the Spirit is given to elect infants in baptism*. Show them that what they have said, this they have actually done. But if they are such as allow of the baptism of infants, let them satisfy me in another thing, and I will soon give content to them in their demand. Let them show me where the Scripture speaks in express terms, of the baptism of infants by name, and I will show them an express text for the communication of the Spirit unto *elect infants* by name, in their baptism. Here I know they will say that it is not necessary to bring express words of Scripture that say the same thing in so many syllables, but it is enough if it is concluded from there by sound consequence; and herein they say the truth. Now, if they require that, all Anabaptists should forever lay their hands upon their mouths (that have been opened so freely and erroneously to plead against the baptism of infants) because however the Scripture doth not say, in so many words, *let infants be baptized*, yet the thing is grounded on the Scriptures, and may by sound consequence be sufficiently proved thence. Let them forbear to press me, or any man else to produce an express text that names *elect infants*, so long as the thing is made good by undoubted and impregnable consequence from many Scriptures alleged for this purpose. And if either

I or the author last above named, in this kind of proof have failed, let them show us our error, and they shall not find us to be heretics.

11. *Objection: That position which offensively trenches too near upon Popish error and absurdity, ought not to be taught and published by faithful ministers of the Gospel, although the point should not be altogether untrue. But so doth this, for it seems to ascribe too much to the outward work done, and is of mere affinity with that absurd fancy of the indelible character which Papists talk so much of, and affirm to be imprinted in baptism. Therefore, whether the point is true or false, it was ill done to publish it in such a manner.*

Answer. This objection comes double charged, for it doth not fail only upon the point itself, obliquely charging it with Popery, but upon me also, for publishing of that which, if it is not Popery, yet comes too near Popery, and so should have been buried in silence. I answer therefore:

1. To the *major*, two ways. 1. By way of protestation. 2. By way of distinction. First, I *protest* (although I think I am so well known to all those that take offence at this particular, that I do not need to make such a solemn protestation) that I do utterly from my heart abhor and renounce all points of Popery whatsoever, and that, as I have done, so I shall ever endeavor to confute them, by all the ways and means that possibly I can, on all occasions. Secondly, I *distinguish* of the present proposition, that some things do, truly and indeed, trench too near on Popish absurdity, and have such affinity with them, as that whosoever venteth them, shall give just occasion of suspicion that he hath a Pope in his belly, whatever he hath in his mouth, or pen. And these things, by whosoever they are vented and published, do give just occasion of offense, and so do argue great indiscretion, if not a false heart to the truth, in him that publishes them. There are other things which do only *seem* to trench too near upon Popery, in the opinions of those that hear or read them, either because they do not, or cannot, or will not understand the difference between those and Popish absurdities. And these again, are either *positions* or *actions*. As for *actions* done, which actions have in them no small appearance of evil, in that (in every man's judgment, that is a looker on) they symbolize with Popish

> superstition and no course being taken to explain and declare, in what sense they are done, and how they differ from their practice who use the self-same actions in an unlawful manner, I ingenuously confess that it should be a fault in him that should so near trench on Popery, as to use those actions in such a manner because the Apostle gives charge, "…abstain from all appearance of evil," (1 Thess. 5:22). And the same Apostle professes in the particular of meats offered unto idols, that, "He would eat no flesh while the world stands, whereby he might make his brother to offend," (1 Cor. 8:13).

But as for *positions*, in which the truth is explained, and the contrary disclaimed, I must crave leave to be of another opinion. For I cannot be of their mind who hold that nothing must be delivered which may seem to some hearers or readers to trench too near on Popish absurdity, so long as it is not indeed a popish absurdity, but the truth; and that the difference between that truth, and the popish absurdity, to which it is supposed to lean, is so fully manifested and cleared, as all that are capable of truth and willing to receive the same, may discern it, if they please. I do not like that vain conceit (which hath drawn after it many absurdities indeed; and those, of dangerous consequence) that we should, in all points, go as far from Papists and other heretics, as possibly we can. This is that which never did good, ever did, and will do hurt, when men will take that to be the truth only which standeth in most direct opposition to that which is known and confessed to be a gross error, for, as in some persons, it is only a *degree* of heat or cold over and above the just temper, that makes them of such a poisonous quality, (so as if they are corrected by some other ingredient) they may not only prove safe, but very useful to the party to whom they are administered; so it is in many propositions, which, as they are propounded, may contain some falsehood in them; yet may be so qualified and bounded as that a small addition, or subtraction might make them pass current, by drawing out all that venom of falsehood contained in them when they stand without those qualifications added to them.

If we go any one step, in any one point, from the grossest heretics in the world further than mere necessity of truth compels, they will soon

(and that justly) open their mouths against us, and complain that, we study, not so much to maintain the truth as to cross them; and, that it is enough for us to disclaim any truth, because they hold it. What can follow here but extreme obstinacy in such as are out of the way, (and under obloquy for it) when they shall discern and be able to plead that, we do hold that, a direct opposition to them in all things, is the best and safest rule to walk by; where they, in the meantime, can make it appear that, however they may be wide in some degrees from the truth, yet not so many degrees as we would make the world believe, for in such and such particulars they can prove it to all men capable of understanding, that they do not err; and yet we will not consent unto them so far, as every ingenious man will confess them to have truth on their side? For my part, I will not give such an advantage to any adversary, but rather hold myself bound to assent to him, be he Papist, Familist, Turk, or Jew, in any truth whatsoever; so that I may have liberty to express myself clearly, how and to what end I hold that truth with him, and that I disclaim all such uses as he puts that truth abusively unto.

Nor do I take up this resolution without warrant, but have unquarrellable precedent for it. For mark, Saint Paul who professed that, in matter of *practice*, he would be careful not to offend a weaker brother, even in those things which are not in themselves simply unlawful, yet he would not, for any man's sake, refuse to declare his judgment concerning the lawfulness of the things that cannot be simply and absolutely condemned, how much so ever they have been, and perhaps still are unlawfully abused in their use. He gives instance in the matter of meats offered to idols, in that I Corinthians before mentioned. Some were of opinion that they might be lawfully eaten, being received with thanksgiving and prayer, and without reference to the idol, or doubting about it. Others held the contrary, and were so stiff in their opinion that they not only refused to eat thereof themselves, but took great offense at others, that on any reason whatsoever took more liberty in it, than they did. The Apostle comes in as an *umpire* between them. He concludes that for the matter of practice he would so far gratify the weak that he would forbear to eat of such meats; yet first protesting in that very place, that he could not suffer his judg-

ment to be so far captivated, nor the truth to be so much wronged, as not to hold the thing lawful in itself. Therefore in point of judgment he concurred with those that held the truth, but in matter of practice he professeth his dissent from them because they abused their liberty to the offense of the weak, and so did swerve from the rule of charity. By which we see that the abuse of any truth must not make any man unwilling to hold it even with those that do abuse it, so long as he abstains from the abuse of which they are guilty. Therefore, my discretion will not be much wounded by this objection; unless it can appear that this doth indeed, as well as in show, trench too near on Popish absurdities, as the *minor* affirms, which now I come to.

2. To the *minor* I answer, by *denying* it, and by *making good* my denial of it. 1. I *deny* that this assertion of *baptismal regeneration of elect infants*, as it hath been before *stated, and prosecuted*, doth trench upon any Popish absurdity at all. 2. I make my denial good in this way: If this assertion is in any way guilty of what it is charged with it, it must be either because it ascribes such a physical efficacy (as they term it) to the outward element of water, after consecration, that the very water should have force in it, *ipso facto* to confer the inward grace to every person baptized, at least, to the *elect*, so soon as they are sprinkled or washed with it in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost, by virtue of that external work done and performed outwardly by the Minister; or else because it lumps in with, or at least draws too near to that other absurdity of theirs, touching the impression of an *indelible character* upon the soul of everyone that is outwardly baptized, whether he is elected, or not.

1. Of the former it cannot be guilty, because, (as in my preaching of the point, all that heard me with attention and understanding; so in my publishing of it thus to the world) all that will grant to peruse and consider the second chapter of this treatise, cannot but bear me witness, that I do not hold, nor ever did affirm, that all that partake of the outward baptism, are also partakers of the Spirit, in it; nor that the elect themselves do partake of it by virtue of the outward work done; or that the water contains in it the Spirit, or hath in it any physical efficacy to convey the Spirit, as if the

water were as a channel or conduit pipe through which the Spirit passeth unto the souls of elect infants in that ordinance. But I say expressly that the Spirit is given immediately by Christ Himself at the same instant in which the Minister performeth the outward act of baptism. Now the Popish tenet is directly *contrary* to all this, as they well know that understand what the Papists hold in this particular. And it was but an unthrifty waste of time and paper, to set down the same more at large.

2. It is no less free from the other absurdity of the *indelible character*. This may be sufficiently evident, by showing their doctrine herein, and comparing it with the point in hand. It is very true that the popish schoolmen speak much and often of this supposed *character*, which everyone that is baptized, according to their fancy, receiveth in baptism; and this character, they say, can never be blotted out again, in any of those that have once received it. However, (as Soto, out of Scotus affirms and confesseth) this doctrine was never known to the Ancients, because neither Lombard nor Gratian, who took upon them to collect all that the Fathers had written touching baptism, make any mention of it. Therefore it appears to be a new device of the latter schoolmen, hatched after Lombard was dead and rotten. But that position which is here defended is of more antiquity in the Church of Christ, as appears by those testimonies of the Fathers before alleged, to which it were easy to add many more, if need required.

After that academic toy was set abroad in the schools there quickly grew as many different opinions about it, as there were authors and abettors of it. This is manifest to all that are conversant in their writings, of which the learned Chamier[247] among many others, have drawn a short survey. And as men differed about it when they were apart, so they were not able to compose the differences, when they met together in their Grand Council of Trent itself, where there was no small stir about it, as we are informed by the author of the *History of that Council*.[248] "It was worth the knowing, he saith, what thing they meant by it, and where situated, in such multiplicity of school

[247] De Sacram. lib. 2, cap. 12, &c.

[248] Page 239.

opinions. Some made it a quality, and among those were four opinions, according to the four kinds of qualities; some, a spiritual power; some, a habit or disposition; others, a spiritual figure; and the opinion that it was a sensible metaphorical quality, did not want abettors. Some would have it a real relation; some, a fabric of the mind, who had somewhat to do to declare how far it differed from nothing." "The same variety of opinions concerning the *subject*, was troublesome. Some placed it in the essence of the soul; some, in the understanding; some, in the will. And there did not lack anything, who gave it place in the hands and tongue. Hierom of Portugal, a Dominican friar, thought that the sacraments did imprint a spiritual quality before the coming of grace, and that it was of two sorts - one which can never be abolished; the other which may be lost and regained. The former was called a character; the latter, a certain ornament. The sacraments which give the first, cannot be reiterated, because their effect ever remains; the other may, when their effect is lost. This carried a fair show, but was not approved of by many, because there was no other author of that ornament, but their St. Thomas of Aquinas, who also, though he begat it, yet did not think it worthy of education."

In so much perplexed contrariety of opinions they durst not conclude expressly, what that *indelible character* was. Yet in their seventh Session, *Can*. 9, they boldly anathematized all that in baptism, confirmation, and orders, shall say no indelible character is imprinted upon the soul. Nor have their greatest champions, Vasquez, Suarez, Bellarmine, Valentian, and others, who have stood up in defence of that Council, been able to bring the point to any head; no, nor yet his Holiness himself, with all his infallibleship, hath granted to explain his Council, or to help out his vassals in defining precisely what that thing is. Surely, here is need of implicit faith indeed, when even the very greatest and most admired Grandees of the Church cannot yet tell what they hold and believe distinctly herein. It is not to be denied but that (with much labor) a man might find out those particulars in which they do in some sort agree. But they agree rather in declaring negatively what it is not, than in concluding positively and affirmatively what the thing is. This I shall be able to make good out of the

industrious collections of Chamier,[249] wherein we shall find that the Papals do agree in these things (if we may take Bellarmine's words for it*), viz.*,

1. In determining *what it is not, viz.*, that it is not any grace, but a thing distinct from it, which makes them disposed and capable to receive or administer things appertaining to Divine worship. They will not have it to be faith, justification, regeneration, or the gift of the Spirit Himself.
2. In determining *to whom it is given, viz.*, to all that receive the sacraments, whether worthily or unworthily, so as it is not anything peculiar to such as are saved, but common also to such as are damned, who do carry this indelible character with them to hell itself.
3. In determining *in what sacraments* the character is given, *viz.*, not only in baptism, but in confirmation, and in orders also, both of which they put into the number of their sacraments, as they do also marriage, penance, and extreme unction.
4. In determining *in what manner* it is conferred, *viz., ex opere operato*, merely by virtue of the external administration of those their sacraments, so as (if the Papists say true) no man can miss of that supposed character, so soon as he partakes of the outward part (I mean, the outward signs) of those[250] sacraments.

By all this it appears that there is a vast difference between that figment and Popish absurdity of the *indelible character*, and this position which is here defended. For, 1. They are yet to seek touching the very substance of the thing; and however in the general they hold it to be such as differs from all grace, and from the Spirit of grace. But I affirm clearly and roundly that, it is the Spirit of grace that is given in baptism, which they deny. 2. They teach that their *character* is given to all, without exception of any of the reprobates themselves. I affirm that the Spirit is given only unto the elect, and to them, ordinarily, not

[249] *Ibid.*

[250] Although I use their manner of speech, in calling confirmation and orders by the name of sacraments, as they do, yet I disclaim the error which allows of any sacraments of the New Testament properly so called, but only baptism and the Lord's Supper. I use their terms because I am speaking of their tenets.

always, but that some may and do receive the Spirit before baptism, some after it. 3. They teach that there is a *character* given in confirmation, and orders, as well as in baptism; I speak only of what is given in baptism. 4. They affirm their *character* to be given by virtue of the outward work done. I say the Spirit is given only by Christ Himself immediately.

Therefore, I conclude that this position doth in every way so far differ from that absurdity, that it hath no likeness in it, in any respect at all. I never taught other than that the Spirit is given ordinarily to elect infants in their baptism, to be the first principle of future grace, and in the meantime to seal them up for Christ. If any please to call this an *indelible character*, I would not be afraid to affirm that in baptism there is such a thing ordinarily, given in baptism to elect infants, who are sealed by the Holy Ghost to the day of redemption; which Spirit is also an Ointment, that shall abide with them forever.

12. *Objection*. This position will, by some, be taken to be of this ill consequence in carnal persons, (who naturally are ever apt thereunto) that thereby occasion will be taken of too great a reliance Upon, and vain opinion of that ordinance, with more neglect, or slight and perfunctory use of the means of grace and salvation; whereas the doctrine of baptism otherwise delivered would enforce the contrary care and diligence. Therefore, some say, it was very unadvisedly done, to publish such a doctrine unto the people.

Answer. Because it was a friend that made this objection, and because by his friendly letter I have been made acquainted with more objections against the point than otherwise I should have come to the knowledge of, (for which I truly profess myself beholding to him), I will purposely forbear to aggravate such slips as are made in some passages of the antecedent, *viz*., that baptism seems to be turned out of the society of the means of grace and salvation, and (which is insinuated further) that, for the ill consequences which, by accident, carnal persons may, haply, draw from it, I should rather have taught the contrary doctrine (as some others seem to do) or else have held my tongue, whatever the truth is in this point, and how deeply so ever I have been charged with error and heresy, in which cases no good

man ought to be so patient as not, in a fair manner, to clear himself, if he knows himself to be innocent. Forbearing, I say, all such aggravations, I deny the antecedent and render a reason of my denial, as follows. The bare and clear propoundings of this truth gives no occasion at all of any such corrupt deductions. If any such abuses follow, occasion, by accident, is taken up by them who are too apt and do too usually attempt to abuse all other ordinary means of salvation, to their own destruction, as well as this. This gives no more occasion of such ill consequences, than do the doctrines of God's free and absolute election of particular persons unto life and glory, and of the final perseverance of the saints. For whatever ill collection may be drawn from this position, may as well be drawn from either of those but now mentioned.

A carnal person, you say, when he hears it proved and so much inculcated that the elect do, ordinarily, receive the Spirit and first principle of grace in their baptism, will be ever apt to conclude there as followeth*: Why then, there is no such need of so much preaching, hearing, praying, fasting, etc. For if I belong to God, I have the Spirit in me already, how wicked so ever I appear to others to be; and I have had the Spirit ever since I was baptized, and, I cannot miss of grace and salvation of the Spirit, though I never hear sermons nor pray, all the days of my life, but follow my lusts as freely as any man.*

To this I say, that if a man will be so wicked, he may. But who is at fault but himself? May not he conclude as much from both the other? And is it not perpetually bawled by the Arminians, *viz*., "that the doctrine of God's absolute election taught by the Calvinists (as they please to nickname all maintainers thereof) doth make many men exceedingly presumptuous and secure; it occasioneth in them such desperate conclusions as these*: If I am elect, I shall certainly be saved, let me live as I want and do what I will; what need do I have for prayer, sermons, holiness of life, etc. If I shall be saved, I shall be saved; let me do what I will to hinder it. But if I am not elect, I shall be damned, let me do what I can to prevent it*. Again, how is the comfortable doctrine of final perseverance daily calumniated, as if it taught no less security and presumption than the former, "Will not this," saith the Arminian, "make men careless and impenitent, when they shall be told that, *let*

them do what they will, they cannot either finally or totally lose all grace, if ever they had any at all? Will not such persons conclude against any man that shall exhort them, on any falls into some gross sins, to speedy and serious repentance, that *he is much mistaken in them; they are sure that they had grace once, and they are taught by such and such Divines, that they can never lose all grace again, by any sins never so gross and scandalous. Therefore, no necessity of any such is required as he pretends. Their state is good and sure enough. They have that in them which cannot be lost, and that being not lost, they cannot miscarry."*

It may not be dissembled that such wicked conclusions may be made from those heavenly doctrines by hellish men. But yet we can find answers to all such objections, easily enough, and those are not shifts, but sufficient assertions of all such calumnies. We can tell such objectors, that the doctrines of election and perseverance do not, in themselves, lay any grounds for such devilish conclusions, (no more than good meat intends to yield matter of corrupt organs in a bad stomach) but do sufficiently declare and teach the contrary, and all that are under the one, and partakers of the other, do take out the contrary lesson from them. We can tell them that, they who are elected to the end are elected to the means and to a conscionable use of the means whereby the end may be attained. So also, the doctrine of perseverance teaches that, though perseverance is certain yet it is also of the nature of that grace in which men persevere, to make and keep them diligent in the use of all good means whereby they may and do persevere and work out their salvation with fear and trembling, according to that of Saint Peter (2 Peter 1:8*). If these things be in you and abound, they make you that ye shall never be barren nor unfruitful in the knowledge of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ*. Therefore, we usually add that if any shall or do make any other uses of these sweet and divine truths, by it to continue in sin, this is not to be imputed to the doctrines themselves, but to their wicked heads and hearts that dare to damnably draw them away. The Gospel, which is the wisdom of God and the power of God to salvation to all that are saved, is yet held for no better than foolishness to the rest of the foolish and unbelieving world. So the law which was ordained for the means of life, worketh death in all that abuse it. But neither the law nor Gospel are in fault of

this, nor must therefore be concealed and not taught and inculcated, because wicked men do daily wrest them to their own damnation.

And will not the same answer be good enough to uphold the point in hand against the same objection? And, if it will, why should it be held a greater indiscretion to publish this doctrine so daily useful, and so fully comfortable to all the elect, both parents and children, than to publish those other points before touched, as deeply charged with the same ill consequences as this is? When I say that, *In the baptism of elect infants, Christ doth, ordinarily, bestow His Spirit, I add withal that this is not sufficient for the salvation of such as live to years of discretion, but actual conversion and renovation is to be expected and labored for, in due and conscionable attendance on the use of all those further helps and means which God hath sanctified to that purpose*. For, so God grants to grace all His ordinances, that He will not have any of them despised nor neglected, by leaving either of them unuseful, through such an efficacy of any one that have gone before, as might leave nothing to be done by those that follow after. As he puts His Spirit in the hearts of the elect, in their baptism, so he afterwards puts power into His Word effectually to call them home to Himself. Then the same Spirit works mightily by that Word, and infuses the habits of faith and all sanctifying graces that do accompany salvation. The Word therefore, and the rest of God's ordinances must be carefully, humbly, and constantly attended upon, by all that expect any actual and sensible assurance, and comfortable feeling of the Spirit bestowed on them in their baptism. As for such as rely on baptism alone, making no conscience of the Word, and other means of grace ordained of Christ, but live securely in their sins, by it they give just cause of suspicion that they never were in the number of God's elect whose names are written in the book of life. If they will necessarily take offense at this doctrine, they take what was never given. The godly will employ it better, and for their sakes it ought to be not only sometimes taught, but often pressed to the uttermost, unless we should suppress every good and necessary truth of which wicked men will make an evil use.

Musculus on Matthew 19:14, *"Ratio humana non sustinet agnoscere gratiam Dei in hac re, sed putat ubique opus esse usu rationis & scientiae, alioqui nihil commerci posse homini infanti esse cum Deo. Videmus autem*

hic potiores esse in regno Dei infantes, tam abest ut non sint illius participes." [Human reason cannot endure to acknowledge the grace of God in this particular, but thinks that (without all difference) there is need of the use of reason and knowledge, or else that a man while he is an infant, can have no commerce with God. But by this text we see that infants rather than others have interest in the kingdom of God, so far are they from not being at all partakers of it.]

FINIS.